



HSBC Bank USA N.A. An Optimist's Guide to a Shifting Landscape

644 words

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Investment Weekly News

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English

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2024 SEP 28 (VerticalNews) -- By a News Reporter-Staff News Editor at Investment Weekly News -- In its Q4 2024 investment outlook, An Optimist's Guide to a Shifting Landscape, HSBC Global **Private Banking** indicates that while the U.S. economy is slowing, an imminent recession is not anticipated to be on the horizon. Investors continue to look for buying opportunities, supported by the prospect of rate cuts, potential corporate earnings improvement, nearshoring/re-industrialization and innovation boosting productivity and valuation opportunities. HSBC Global **Private Banking**'s four investment priorities are: Targeting earnings endurance: Companies have shown they can deliver strong earnings despite moderate global growth. While the technology sector continues to appeal, other sectors are proving attractive alternatives to the tech mega-caps. Putting cash to work: The global rate-cutting cycle is well under way, and cash is getting less attractive.

We recommend locking in bond yields on quality credit before they fall further, and using multi-asset strategies to tap into a broad opportunity set. Bridging uncertainty: The U.S. election, global monetary policy and geopolitical risks could trigger some market uncertainty in the coming months, but volatility strategies and hedge funds may protect against the downside while remaining invested. Diversifying in Asia: Asia's diverse and expanding capital markets offer attractive prospects for diversification, with promising opportunities from its resilient growth leaders and quality bonds, particularly in Japan, India and South Korea.

Willem Sels, Global Chief Investment Officer at HSBC Global **Private Banking** and Wealth, said: "It's easy to feel nervous about the markets, but we are optimistic that diversified portfolios will continue to do well. While the landscape is shifting, the opportunity set is rich and diverse. A global mind set and a multi-asset approach are the way to go." Jose Rasco, Chief Investment Officer for the Americas at HSBC Global **Private Banking** and Wealth, said: "Despite anticipated market volatility in the coming weeks, we are optimistic about the U.S. economy and believe we are in the early stages of a technology revolution, furthering our theme of staying invested." Notes to Editors About HSBC Global **Private Banking** HSBC Global **Private Banking** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com About HSBC Holdings plc HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 60 countries and territories. With assets of US\$2,975bn at 30 June 2024, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations. HSBC Bank USA, National Association (HSBC Bank USA, N.A.) serves customers through Wealth and Personal Banking, Commercial Banking, **Private Banking**, Global Banking, and Markets and Securities Services. Deposit products are offered by HSBC Bank USA, N.A., Member FDIC. It operates Wealth Centers in: California; Washington, D.C.; Florida; New Jersey; New York; Virginia; and Washington. HSBC Bank USA, N.A. is the principal subsidiary of HSBC USA Inc., a wholly-owned subsidiary of HSBC North America Holdings Inc. This document is for information purposes only. The material contained is not and should not be construed as an offer to sell, or solicitation of an offer to purchase or subscribe for any investment or service. For more information, visit: HSBC in the USA View source version on businesswire.com: <https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20240910716446/en/>

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Straits Times Breaking News

Business

DBS sees wealth management fees doubling by 2027 as rich shift more assets to Singapore and Asia.

673 words

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The Straits Times

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SINGAPORE - DBS Group Holdings aims to double fees from wealth management by 2027 as more of the world's affluent investors shift their assets to Singapore and Asia.

The bank handles a third of Singapore's 1,650 single **family offices**, said Shee Tse Koon, head of consumer and wealth banking at DBS.

It is now also the third-largest **private bank** in Asia, excluding China, only behind UBS Group and HSBC Holdings, according to rankings by Asian **Private Banker**.

DBS's income from servicing rich clients rose to more than \$2 billion last year, doubling from 2015. It expects the same pace of increase in half that period as well-heeled people and **family offices** from various parts of the world head to Asia to park their money, said Mr Shee.

"Given the trajectory and traction we have had over the past years, our aim going forward is that by 2027 we want to double our wealth fees," Mr Shee said in an interview with Bloomberg News this week.

Wealthy clients of South-east Asia's largest bank usually invest their cash to improve returns and many have also tapped DBS for their trust and legacy planning needs, he said.

Mr Shee's optimism underscores the significance of rising wealth fees that boosted DBS's income in recent years and will likely cushion its earnings as the US Federal Reserve and other central banks cut interest rates.

The assets of DBS clients, including those at the **private bank** and lower-rung tiers, reached \$396 billion as of June. That is set to exceed \$500 billion by 2027 with the number of clients investing and buying insurance products expected to quadruple, Mr Shee said without specifying the numbers.

Singapore saw a \$120 billion surge in financial assets booked from overseas last year, with China being the top source of new wealth in absolute terms, according to a Boston Consulting Group report published in July. Mr Shee said there's been "a good mix" of assets from North and South Asia, the Middle East and Europe with no particularly dominant region.

The bank has grown its relationship manager headcount by around 20 per cent since the middle of 2023, Mr Shee said, adding that hiring continues and that they're still working out future headcount. DBS had 730 relationship managers as of 2023, up 12 per cent from a year ago and the second highest in Asia, excluding China, according to Asian **Private Banker**.

DBS has two booking centres - Singapore and Hong Kong - for its wealthy clients across the regions. While the bank is seeing more traction from clients in Dubai, India and London, Mr Shee said there is "no compelling reason" for now to consider the United Arab Emirates city as its third booking hub.

DBS, like other banks, has grappled with ensuring that assets of its clients are clean. In Singapore, DBS had some \$100 million exposure to clients who were convicted this year in the city-state's largest money-laundering case where more than \$3 billion of assets were seized. In July, the bank was fined HK\$10 million (S\$1.7 million) by the Hong Kong Monetary Authority for lapses including failure to continuously monitor business relationships and to establish the source of wealth of high-risk customers between 2012 and 2019.

DBS is constantly investing in both technology and people to detect misconduct and illicit flows, Mr Shee said. It's also boosting its surveillance and monitoring systems to keep pace with emerging criminal trends, he added.

"The whole point is how you balance between being effective in anti-money laundering and risk management and yet remain efficient and open for business," he said. BLOOMBERG More On This Topic More of South-east Asia's super rich turn to **family offices** to manage wealth Opportunities for S'pore as **family offices** look to hire outside talent amid wealth transfer to heirs

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HSBC GPB ties up with iCapital for private markets in HK and SG

Priyanka Boghani

253 words

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HSBC Global **Private Banking** (GPB) has tied up with global fintech platform iCapital as a technology provider for private market investments in Hong Kong and Singapore.

The tech will be fully integrated into HSBC's platform to digitalise the private market investment experience for its relationship managers, investment counsellors and operations teams, according to a 16 Sept statement from iCapital. The tech platform will first be deployed in Hong Kong and Singapore, before it is rolled out globally.

iCapital's technology will allow the **private bank** to deliver portfolio of management capabilities for education, transactions, data flows, analytics, and client support. It will automate historically complex subscription, administration, operational and reporting processes. The tech will aim to improve the efficiency and client experience of those interested in the alternative investments universe.

Private banks have been seeing strong interest in private markets, with clients seeking to up exposure to uncorrelated asset classes.

With more opportunities to put cash to work in the second half of 2024, Willem Sels, the **private bank**'s global chief investment officer, advised clients about the multi-asset investment opportunities and benefits of tapping into private markets in the bank's latest fourth quarter investment outlook report.

'Through this collaboration with iCapital, we are poised to make a

broader range of alternative investment opportunities more accessible to our clients,' said Jan-Marc Fergg, global head of ESG and managed solutions, HSBC Global **Private Banking** and Wealth.

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Straits Times Breaking News

Business

Investors increasingly spreading their wealth amid global uncertainties: HSBC

Prisca Ang

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STIMES

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SINGAPORE - Investors are increasingly spreading their assets across various markets to reduce risk from global uncertainties, which presents more opportunities for banks to capture wealth flows, said two senior bankers from HSBC.

The next generation of business leaders are also thinking about what a sustainable future means for their firms, which has led to geographical diversification of not just their companies' operations but also their personal wealth.

Mr Tommy Leung, HSBC's head of global **private banking** for South Asia, encompassing South-east Asia and India, said patriarchs or matriarchs in wealthy families often kept to their core markets. "But now, the next gen is quite happy to look outside their core market."

HSBC can play a role by helping these clients look for target firms in renewable energy sectors, in places like Australia and China, he said.

Investors are also choosing to have "more pockets of wealth everywhere" rather than simply moving their wealth from one destination to another, he said.

"Historically, Hong Kong and Singapore have been the two most popular booking centres but, now, more and more clients are interested in Switzerland, in the UK, or even farther," he added.

"We are also seeing more North American, European and Middle East clients looking to place their assets in Hong Kong and Singapore to tap the opportunities in Asia. So we have seen diversification go both ways."

Separately, a McKinsey article on Sept 6 noted that wealth flowing into Hong Kong and Singapore is mainly coming from elsewhere in Asia, but there will likely be increased wealth flows from Europe and North America as many global investors see Asia as a safe haven for portfolio diversification.

In 2023, Hong Kong and Singapore each managed roughly US\$1.3 trillion (S\$1.7 trillion) in offshore assets - trailing only behind Switzerland's US\$2.5 trillion, added the management consulting firm.

HSBC's global **private banking** business in Asia saw US\$15 billion in net new invested assets in the first half of 2024. The unit contributed nearly half of such assets globally in the lender's wealth and personal banking business.

In Singapore, net new money inflows in the first half exceeded inflows for the whole of 2023, said HSBC, which counts the city-state and Hong Kong as its main booking centres that open accounts and serve clients. More On This Topic Singapore tycoons' wealth rises 10%, with Eduardo Saverin topping Forbes' rich list again Ultra-rich families set to control \$12 trillion by 2030

The lender is eyeing a larger wallet share of ultra-high net worth (UHNW) individuals, whom it defines as clients with total wealth of more than US\$200 million, or more than US\$50 million in their total portfolio with the bank.

UHNW clients in Singapore make up 10 per cent of the overall base of such customers in HSBC's global **private banking** business.

Wealth management fee income will help to drive growth at lenders like HSBC as high interest rates that have boosted earnings are cut.

Mr Leung said UHNW clients contribute a significant part of the bank's net new money and revenue. "We are very comfortable to say that we think we can grow at a faster rate than the market, well into the double-digit percentage for this client segment, for the near future."

Mr Lok Yim, regional head of global **private banking** for Asia-Pacific, said: "We've seen volumes increase across the board, whether that's in the net new money or even in the net new loans, or the trading, mandates or alternatives business."

Singapore and Hong Kong are just parts of the UHNW puzzle for HSBC, which has in recent years expanded its onshore **private banking** business in mainland China, where it has offices in six cities. The bank completed the acquisition of Citi's retail **wealth management** portfolio there in June.

It is tapping the wealth pools of the Indian diaspora, with the launch of its onshore business in the South Asian country in 2023.

HSBC also has an onshore presence in Thailand and the Philippines, and is growing its footprint in Taiwan as it hopes to capture the chip boom there. It has opened wealth centres in Taipei, Taoyuan and Taichung in recent years. More On This Topic South-east Asia super rich worry more about succession disputes than other regions: Poll More of South-east Asia's super rich turn to **family offices** to manage wealth

Asked about the impact of mainland China's economic slowdown, Mr Yim said wealth is still growing steadily, albeit at a slower pace than several years ago.

More clients are sending their children overseas for further education, which presents opportunities for the bank in areas such as new account openings and payments where HSBC can leverage its international network, he added.

"That is why we have to be both onshore and offshore, and we have to be connected with the retail, investment and commercial bank," said Mr Yim, who joined HSBC in late 2023 from Deutsche Bank.

Clients' onshore banking needs in mainland China and India are growing faster than the offshore business, he added. "The model is not to compete with a local bank. We are targeting clients with international needs and giving them connectivity."

HSBC's Asia-Pacific global **private banking** business saw a record volume of alternative investments by clients in the second quarter, with a large portion coming from the mainland China onshore business.

Open-ended funds, in particular, have become more popular as clients want greater liquidity, said Mr Leung, who was from UBS, and also joined HSBC in 2023.

The bank is leveraging technology to stress-test eligible clients' portfolios through its hybrid Prism Advisory service that combines expert guidance with data analytics, added the bankers.

When it comes to **family offices**, the bank's institutional **family office** service gives UHNW clients access to HSBC's investment bankers, without clients having to go through a separate onboarding process. It has a team to guide clients who are just starting a **family office**. More On This Topic Why is Singapore a magnet for Chinese billionaires? Wealthy Chinese nationals in Singapore: Tales of rags to riches and hard work

Amid growing demand for private credit, HSBC also allows **family offices** to invest in certain loans that the bank makes, said Mr Leung.

"I think this is something that these ultra-high net worth clients really want - unique, exclusive assets, and to be on the same side as the bank," he said.

Besides the super rich, HSBC is focusing on clients who are rapidly growing their wealth.

In Singapore, the global **private banking** business saw a double-digit year-on-year increase in clients with investable assets between US\$2 million and US\$10 million in the first half of 2024.

About 60 per cent of new **private banking** clients, who moved up from the retail segment, have significantly increased their assets under management with the bank.

HSBC joins other players who have seen increased inflows of wealth. Asia-Pacific's biggest **wealth manager** UBS saw US\$8.2 billion in second-quarter net new assets in the region, which was second only to Switzerland, following its acquisition of former rival Credit Suisse.

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Ex-UBS GWM Singapore and Malaysia market head joins StanChart

Priyanka Boghani

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A former market team head for Singapore and Malaysia at UBS Global Wealth Management has joined Standard Chartered.

Matthew Henderson is now a team leader for Singapore and Malaysia at the British lender, based in Singapore, according to his LinkedIn profile.

He will lead a team of client advisors, servicing family offices, ultra-high net worth and high net worth clients across the two countries.

A spokesperson for Standard Chartered confirmed Henderson's appointment.

Henderson spent more than two decades at UBS GWM, where he covered various roles and worked in different locations, including stints as a market team head and wealth management business manager for the Hong Kong market.

Standard Chartered Private Bank is also [slated](#) to recruit John George from Credit Suisse, now UBS, after almost 16 years with the Swiss bank.

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Business

Banking - DBS targets wealth management growth in Thailand

444 words

5 September 2024

Bangkok Post

BKPOST

English

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Consumer bank DBS Singapore is aggressively expanding its **wealth management** business in Thailand through subsidiary DBS Securities (Thailand), aiming to triple assets under management (AUM) here to 300 billion baht within two years.

Half of the targeted AUM should come from high net worth investors, said Edwin Tan, DBS market head for Thailand and the Philippines.

As of February, the company had 100 billion baht worth of AUM in Thailand.

Thailand has about 900 high net worth individuals, classified as having a net worth of US\$30 million or more, according to DBS. The number is expected to increase by 15% to more than 1,000 by 2029, said Mr Tan.

"Thailand has potential to grow in this segment, especially family businesses, entrepreneurs and the corporate sector," he said.

"An increasing wealthy segment is driving unprecedented demand for sophisticated wealth planning services, family governance, and the need for corporate financing."

Thailand is also a rapidly ageing economy on the brink of a third-generation wealth shift, said Mr Tan.

With the majority of the country's wealth generated from family-run businesses, there is a need to support entrepreneurial families in the region and beyond, partnering with them to navigate international boundaries, embrace new ventures and plan for their future generations, he said.

Wealthy individuals in Thailand have been relatively conservative with offshore investment, but that is starting to change as their personal wealth grows, said Mr Tan.

"This is driving demand for holistic **wealth management** services with global investment strategies," he said.

Investors are advised to diversify globally to capitalise on higher returns driven by interest rate differentials compared with the local stock market, while investing in secular trends such as US tech and artificial intelligence (AI), which have rallied strongly in 2024, according to DBS.

Shee Tse Koon, group executive head of consumer banking and **wealth management** and country head of DBS Singapore, said since February the company has invested in Thai franchises, offering the online trading platform mTrading in March.

"DBS is well-positioned to serve the growing pool of wealthy Thai clients through its pioneering one-stop onshore and offshore proposition. This is a swift response to strong demand for private assets this year," said Mr Tse.

DBS offers AI-powered digital and investment advisory capabilities that help retail customers better manage their money.

The bank has more than 2 million monthly active users, he said.

Thais are now allowed to invest directly in overseas markets, which is an opportunity for investors to diversify risk, and wealthy Thai groups have great growth potential compared with the surrounding region, Mr Tse said.

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Business Times Breaking News

HSBC Global **Private Bank** leverages global reach to grow ultra wealthy segment in Asia

Lee Kim Siang

1,254 words

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Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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The global **private banking** team operates in over 40 markets and 13 strategic booking centres

INTERNATIONAL connectivity has been a topic of growing importance amid geopolitical and economic uncertainties and the ultra wealthy are paying close attention to this. HSBC Global **Private Banking** – with its global network and full suite of banking capabilities – is building on its strengths to serve the needs of such clients with tailored solutions that meet diverse needs. The bank has delivered a strong performance in 2023 with invested assets for the Global **Private Bank** in Asia growing to US\$166 billion, a record high. The amount represents year-on-year growth of 18 per cent, with clients from the ultra high net worth segment contributing to over half of the growth. And HSBC Global **Private Banking** is looking to build on this momentum, with key hires joining the team to drive growth, with a focus on Asian and international clients as well as entrepreneurs. Tommy Leung joined HSBC last October and leads the Global **Private Banking** South Asia unit to support the ambitions of entrepreneurs, ultra-high-net-worth individuals and their families across the region and globally. The bank has also made other key senior appointments in recent months as it works to become the leading international wealth manager in the region. In March, HSBC appointed Kerri Lim as the head of ultra high net worth segment for Asia, and also named Pritash Mathur as head of **family office** coverage for Global India and Global South Asia. This is following the recent appointment of Edith Wong as head of ultra high net worth segment for North Asia. Leung said the ultra wealthy segment with investable assets over US\$ 30 million is a key focus for the bank. “The solutions and services such clients demand go beyond traditional **private banking**. This could encompass multi generational wealth planning as well as wealth preservation, along with international connectivity. These are key value propositions we have for them,” he said. Global reach with strong Asia footprint HSBC’s network covers more than 60 markets in Europe, the Middle East and Africa, North America and Latin America and of course Asia. Meanwhile, the global **private banking** team operates in over 40 markets and 13 strategic booking centres, with dedicated Asia coverage teams in key global wealth hubs. In Asia, HSBC Global **Private Bank** has presence in Singapore, Hong Kong, mainland China, Taiwan, India, Thailand and the Philippines. “In an uncertain world, clients want to diversify, not only from a financial assets point of view, but also in terms of where they book their assets,” Leung said. “It’s not uncommon for some of the big clients who have assets in Hong Kong, Singapore or other parts of the world to further spread out their wealth,” he added. “Our ability to support these clients with that global reach is another unique advantage that our bank has.” HSBC Global **Private Banking** has a global relationship manager model whereby a single contact point acts and coordinates with other divisions of the bank to deliver a seamless client service internationally. Indeed, the Global Entrepreneurial Wealth Report by HSBC Global **Private Banking** found that three quarters of the entrepreneurs have businesses operating outside of their home market. They’re driven by benefits for their business and in their personal lives and expect further opportunities to emerge in the coming years. With an international focus, many entrepreneurs value global connections and are keeping a close eye on their next move. Leung noted that this segment of clients typically has existing business outside their domestic borders and are very international. Entrepreneur clients also often have varied responsibilities, including being the head of the family as well as the head of the business. “They have many things on their mind, and they need support from a bank who can support them in these different roles,” Leung added. Universal bank One of HSBC’s strengths lies in its ability to provide diversified services, unlike a pure play **private bank**. “HSBC has a dominant commercial bank, a strong retail franchise, and of course, the life insurance as well as the asset management business,” Leung pointed out. “The scale and breadth of our capabilities enable us to offer a comprehensive one-stop banking experience for our clients.” Leung noted that an entrepreneur client would commonly have children attending schools or living elsewhere in the world. “There are a few basic things we can already do for them, such as opening a bank account and helping them get a credit card even before they arrive,” he said. Beyond retail banking needs for the family, HSBC can also deliver services for the operating business being run by the entrepreneur. Leung noted that this may span across financing commercial real estate, advising on merger and acquisitions, and providing services for operating companies. “Quite often, these entrepreneurs appreciate working with a universal bank with that international

presence,” he said. The global reach also means that clients have access to local expertise on exciting investment opportunities, allowing them to build diversification into their portfolios. “Historically, clients tend to have a home bias. If you’re based in Southeast Asia, your preference is to invest in Southeast Asia,” Leung noted. But in an uncertain world, clients have learnt the necessity of having a global portfolio for diversification. “Most clients don’t necessarily have the expertise in the US or Europe or different parts of the world, and that’s where we come in,” he said. Beyond geographical diversification, many are also exploring other asset classes to meet their investment objectives. HSBC has also seen a rise in interest in **family offices**, as clients want increased flexibility, oversight, and control over their wealth. Leung noted that some wealthy individuals that have moved over to Singapore have become interested in setting up their own **family office** in this part of the world. “We not only advise them on investments, but in the very early stage, also give them advice on how to structure a **family office**,” he said. “We have a dedicated team called **family office** advisory that supports clients in this situation.” Apart from ultra wealthy clients, the **private bank** is also keen to grow its relationship with those who are starting on their wealth journey. This involves clients with between US\$2 million to US\$10 million in investable assets, who are moving from the retail bank to the **private bank**. “We want to offer them experience and solutions that they normally do not get in the retail bank,” Leung said. Such solutions include discretionary portfolio management, wealth planning and trust services. As their wealth grows, they truly want a key partner to support them and work with them along this journey, he said. Key findings of HSBC Global Entrepreneurial Wealth report:

- Entrepreneurs live and work across borders.
- Three quarters have businesses operating outside of their home country or territory.
- Nearly 6 out of 10 Singapore-based entrepreneurs have an international footprint with family living across 2 – 5 markets.
- Few entrepreneurs are talking about their wealth succession plan. Nearly two thirds haven’t yet spoken to their family about their wealth succession plan.
- A third are considering a business exit within 5 years.

About the report: 973 current and former entrepreneurs were surveyed in nine markets (France, Hong Kong, India, mainland China, Singapore, Switzerland, the UAE, the UK and the US). Brought to you by left

Document STBT000020240904ek94000xd

Business

New HSBC boss starts role with branch visits

Mia Castagnone and Enoch Yiu

497 words

3 September 2024

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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Georges Elhedery, the new global CEO of HSBC, visited branches in Hong Kong geared towards wealth management, underscoring the focus of the biggest lender in the city and Europe.

Elhedery visited HSBC's Premier Banking branch on Des Voeux Road Central and stopped by its Wealth Centre at Hysan Place in Causeway Bay, where he interacted with customers, according to the bank's officials.

He said in an email memo to staff yesterday that he would spend his first few days on the job meeting staff, customers and financial regulators in Hong Kong, confirming a report by the Post on Friday.

Hong Kong "is an incredibly important market for us and Georges was keen to spend his first few days here", the bank said in a statement. "He will meet a range of customers, colleagues and government officials."

Elhedery and Luanne Lim, the bank's Hong Kong CEO, will host a Zoom meeting with all Hong Kong staff this afternoon, allowing the global boss to review the group's business and provide an outlook for the future, according to an HSBC employee, who did not want to be named.

At the two HSBC outlets, Elhedery got first-hand experience of the bank's operations. These branches are targeted at premium customers, highlighting the strategic importance of Hong Kong and the lender's Asia wealth proposition.

During the visits, staff showed him how they interacted with customers and talked him through the various services the bank offered, including digital solutions such as the PayMe app and features on the HSBC app.

Elhedery said in the memo he would like to meet "as many [staff] as possible" this week, encouraging them to share ideas with him on how to drive business.

The 50-year-old banker is no stranger to the city, having visited it multiple times in the past.

HSBC hopes to continue to strengthen its scale in its dual home markets of Hong Kong and Britain.

"We have the bulk of our capital and other resources deployed in our four scale activities: our two home markets of Hong Kong and the UK, our international wholesale bank underpinned by leading transaction banking capabilities, and our wealth proposition, particularly in Asia," Elhedery said in the email, which was seen by the Post.

"These are supported by the strengthening of our balance sheet, attracting an enviable deposit franchise and enabling a strong financing capability.

"However, the world around us is continuously changing and we need to be agile and willing to adapt to an evolving business environment whilst ensuring we organise ourselves optimally to deliver for our stakeholders."

HSBC's Hong Kong revenue, including that from Hang Seng Bank, for the first half of this year stood at US\$10.52 billion, while pre-tax profit came in at US\$6.12 billion, both representing 28 per cent of the group's results in the period.

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Standard Chartered wins Most Innovative Digital **Wealth Management Solutions – Bahrain 2024” award**

317 words

2 September 2024

Al-Bawaba News

ALBAWA

English

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Standard Chartered Bahrain has been awarded as the “Most Innovative Digital **Wealth Management** Solutions – Bahrain 2024” by the prestigious Global Business Outlook Awards. This accolade recognises the Bank’s exceptional performance, innovation and commitment to excellence in the banking industry.

The Global Business Outlook Awards recognise and rewards excellence in businesses around the world. Global Business Outlook Awards prides itself on an efficient, fair and prompt judicial process. Standard Chartered’s win in the “Most Innovative Digital **Wealth Management** Solutions” category is a recognition of its continued efforts to provide financial services of a global standard to clients locally in Bahrain.

Kunal Varma, Head, Wealth and Retail Banking (WRB), Bahrain at Standard Chartered, commented “Winning this award is a true honour and is a reflection of our efforts to deliver seamless and efficient banking services to our clients. We have been recognised for rendering the **wealth management** solutions to our affluent clients by understanding their unique needs and aspirations and providing tailored solutions that align with their long-term financial goals and values. With the Online Mutual Fund digital platform, the bank is at the forefront of the digital banking transformation, providing clients with convenient and secure ways to manage their finances.”

We look forward to continuing our journey towards excellence and making a positive impact on the industry and the communities we serve.

Standard Chartered is a leading international banking group, with a presence in 53 of the world’s most dynamic markets and serving clients in a further 64. The Bank’s purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through its unique diversity. Its heritage and values are expressed in its brand promise, here for good. The Bank has proudly had a presence in Bahrain for over 100 years.

For more information kindly call 17531532 or visit www.sc.com/bh.

[Kunal Varma](#)

Document ALBAWA0020240902ek920018k

BusinessWorld

Special Report

SPECIAL REPORT: Second Quarter Banking Report Capital Adequacy and Financial Ratios

3,035 words

2 September 2024

BusinessWorld

BSWRLD

S3/4

English

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FINANCIAL RATIOS

INTERMEDIATION RATIO		TOTAL LOANS/TOTAL DEPOSITS	
Q2' 24	Q1' 24	Q2' 23	

P100B AND OVER

BDO Unibank, Inc.	0.8049	0.8039	0.7846	
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.		0.6718	0.6635	0.6045
Land Bank of the Philippines		0.3991	0.4068	0.3944
Bank of the Philippine Islands		0.8454	0.8355	0.7979
China Banking Corp.	0.6353	0.6539	0.6479	
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.		0.6815	0.6583	0.6270
Philippine National Bank	0.6957	0.6925	0.6488	
Security Bank Corp.	0.8627	0.8625	0.9008	
Union Bank of the Philippines	0.7740	0.7562	0.7222	
Development Bank of the Philippines		0.6573	0.6568	0.6156
East West Banking Corp.	0.8498	0.8629	0.7892	
Asia United Bank Corp.	0.6751	0.6722	0.6982	
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The		0.4638	-	0.4571
Bank of Commerce	0.6959	0.6311	0.6523	
Philippine Trust Co.	0.1788	0.1811	0.1440	
Philippine Bank of Communications		0.8022	0.8191	0.7848
MUFG Bank Ltd.	0.4466	0.4283	0.3767	
Standard Chartered Bank	0.1792	0.1769	0.1864	
Maybank Philippines, Inc.	0.7909	0.7024	0.6420	
MEDIAN	0.6815	0.6679	0.6479	

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

Mizuho Bank Ltd.	0.3106	-	0.4157	
CTBC Bank	1.0237	1.0408	0.9054	
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	0.0133	0.0116	0.0065	
Philippine Veterans Bank	0.4422	0.4454	0.3665	
Bank of China Ltd.	1.1508	1.1436	1.0361	
Deutsche Bank AG	0.5180	-	0.4449	
MEDIAN	0.4801	0.7431	0.4303	

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	0.3603	0.3611	0.5381	
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	0.7110	-	0.6820	
ING Bank N.V.	1.1348	2.9951	1.6479	
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	0.3529	-	0.3621	
BDO Private Bank	0.0822	-	0.1471	
Bank of America NA	0.1351	0.1422	0.1209	
KEB Hana Bank	1.5081	1.6286	1.1287	

MEDIAN	0.3603	0.9949	0.5381
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P20B AND BELOW

Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	1.6333	1.6097	2.2705
Mega International Commercial Bank	1.0240	0.6656	0.6717
Shinhan Bank	1.3750	1.0656	1.3363
Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	1.6958	1.4174	3.9413
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	176.7730	139.4963	28.3900
Industrial Bank of Korea	3.8556	3.0292	2.6304
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	8.6581	11.1909	15.8968
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	208.4494	14,508.6186	23,490.2250
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	6.2361	3.8911	5.9085
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	6.2103	5.7723	3.4295
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	0.2968	0.3788	0.3021
Citibank NA	-	-	0.2672
Robinsons Bank Corp.	-	-	0.6951
MEDIAN	3.8556	3.0292	2.6304

GRAND MEDIAN	0.7110	0.7562	0.6717
TOTAL LOANS/TOTAL DEPOSITS	0.6805	0.6728	0.6459

SHAREHOLDER'S	EQUITY RATIO	STOCKHOLDERS	EQUITY/TOTAL ASSETS
Q2' 24	Q1' 24	Q2' 23	

P100B AND OVER

BDO Unibank, Inc.	0.1168	0.1169	0.1199
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	0.1040	0.0956	0.1120
Land Bank of the Philippines	0.0758	0.0843	0.0779
Bank of the Philippine Islands	0.1287	0.1301	0.1244
China Banking Corp.	0.0805	0.0851	0.0885
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	0.1094	0.1161	0.0965
Philippine National Bank	0.1562	0.1592	0.1492
Security Bank Corp.	0.1144	0.1258	0.1423
Union Bank of the Philippines	0.1608	0.1551	0.1526
Development Bank of the Philippines	0.0899	0.0887	0.0841
East West Banking Corp.	0.1385	0.1422	0.1469
Asia United Bank Corp.	0.1473	0.1455	0.1333
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	0.0607	-	0.0731
Bank of Commerce	0.1301	0.1303	0.1372
Philippine Trust Co.	0.1216	0.1238	0.1264
Philippine Bank of Communications	0.1292	0.1317	0.1320
MUFG Bank Ltd.	0.0940	0.0815	0.1064
Standard Chartered Bank	0.0690	0.0678	0.0731
Maybank Philippines, Inc.	0.1168	0.1200	0.1238
MEDIAN	0.1168	0.1219	0.1238

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

Mizuho Bank Ltd.	0.0950	0.1081	0.0998
CTBC Bank	0.1219	0.1295	0.1470
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	0.0965	0.0976	0.1188
Philippine Veterans Bank	0.0354	0.0368	0.0168
Bank of China Ltd.	0.1862	0.1728	0.1925
Deutsche Bank AG	0.0538	-	0.0547
MEDIAN	0.0958	0.1081	0.1093

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	0.2746	0.2561	0.3042
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	0.2133	-	0.2378
ING Bank N.V.	0.2201	0.3600	0.4965
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	0.1162	-	0.1282

BDO Private Bank	0.1926	-	0.1922
Bank of America NA	0.1547	0.1555	0.1753
KEB Hana Bank	0.2659	0.2611	0.3000
MEDIAN	0.2133	0.2586	0.2378

P20B AND BELOW

Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	0.5569	0.5202	0.5361
Mega International Commercial Bank	0.3181	0.2598	0.2906
Shinhan Bank	0.4489	0.4253	0.4416
Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	0.5347	0.3839	0.3609
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	0.2834	0.3222	0.3120
Industrial Bank of Korea	0.5251	0.5112	0.5432
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	0.7434	0.7548	0.8113
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	0.3872	0.4219	0.4908
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	0.4833	0.4545	0.5240
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	0.6531	0.6637	0.6667
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	0.0267	0.0598	0.0863
Citibank NA	-	0.0536	0.0579
Robinsons Bank Corp.	-	-	0.1062
MEDIAN	0.4833	0.4236	0.4416

GRAND MEDIAN	0.1301	0.1317	0.1372
TOTAL STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY/TOTAL ASSETS	0.1128	0.1136	0.1143

STOCKHOLDER EQUITY TO LOANS RATIO	STOCKHOLDERS EQUITY/TOTAL LOANS		
Q2' 24	Q1' 24	Q2' 23	

P100B AND OVER

BDO Unibank, Inc.	0.1801	0.1801	0.1895
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	0.2168	0.2177	0.2411
Land Bank of the Philippines	0.2135	0.2354	0.2231
Bank of the Philippine Islands	0.1950	0.1980	0.1954
China Banking Corp.	0.1817	0.1881	0.1873
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	0.2324	0.2377	0.2095
Philippine National Bank	0.2994	0.3021	0.3049
Security Bank Corp.	0.2330	0.2444	0.2725
Union Bank of the Philippines	0.3527	0.3397	0.3370
Development Bank of the Philippines	0.1787	0.1744	0.1734
East West Banking Corp.	0.2173	0.2218	0.2411
Asia United Bank Corp.	0.2707	0.2648	0.2318
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	0.2045	-	0.2230
Bank of Commerce	0.2415	0.2556	0.2648
Philippine Trust Co.	0.7819	0.7890	1.0115
Philippine Bank of Communications	0.2163	0.2179	0.2321
MUFG Bank Ltd.	0.2960	0.3029	0.3715
Standard Chartered Bank	0.5799	0.5879	0.6911
Maybank Philippines, Inc.	0.2133	0.2317	0.2964
MEDIAN	0.2173	0.2366	0.2411

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

Mizuho Bank Ltd.	0.3869	-	0.3145
CTBC Bank	0.2163	0.2205	0.2462
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	9.4514	11.6661	24.8626
Philippine Veterans Bank	0.0881	0.0898	0.0492
Bank of China Ltd.	0.2976	0.2795	0.3322
Deutsche Bank AG	0.1767	-	0.1976
MEDIAN	0.2570	0.2500	0.2803

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	1.1834	1.0533	0.8703
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CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	0.4979	-	0.5250
ING Bank N.V.	0.7325	0.8798	1.2050
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	0.6837	-	0.6374
BDO Private Bank	4.3491	-	2.0699
Bank of America NA	1.6080	1.5357	2.0230
KEB Hana Bank	0.3842	0.3764	0.4731
MEDIAN	0.7325	0.9665	0.8703

P20B AND BELOW

Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	0.9884	0.8516	0.7733
Mega International Commercial Bank	0.8612	0.9000	1.1710
Shinhan Bank	0.8421	0.7815	0.7059
Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	1.4903	0.9692	0.8009
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	0.5990	0.5950	0.6663
Industrial Bank of Korea	0.7993	0.8410	0.9726
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	1.3381	1.4007	1.1875
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	1.6043	1.6164	1.3302
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	0.5989	0.6185	0.6434
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	1.1346	1.0712	1.1099
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	0.1028	0.1924	0.3335
Citibank NA	-	-	0.4093
Robinsons Bank Corp.	-	-	0.1957
MEDIAN	0.8612	0.8516	0.7733

GRAND MEDIAN	0.3527	0.3029	0.3370
TOTAL STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY/TOTAL LOANS	0.2208	0.2252	0.2305

CAPITAL AND FINANCIAL RATIOS

CAPITAL ADEQUACY RATIO

LOCAL BANKS	2nd Qtr '24	1st Qtr '24	2nd Qt '23
Philippine Trust Co.	40.38%	41.13%	42.82%
BDO Private Bank	29.41%	33.07%	28.08%
Asia United Bank Corp.	18.57%	18.24%	15.78%
Bank of Commerce	17.97%	18.64%	19.42%
Philippine National Bank	17.04%	16.20%	14.41%
Union Bank of the Philippines	16.81%	14.42%	15.82%
Philippine Bank of Communications	16.39%	16.84%	17.27%
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	16.19%	16.08%	13.84%
China Banking Corp.	15.36%	16.30%	16.17%
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	15.32%	15.44%	16.15%
Land Bank of the Philippines	15.03%	16.85%	16.10%
Development Bank of the Philippines	14.77%	14.14%	13.74%
Bank of the Philippine Islands	14.36%	14.91%	15.71%
Security Bank Corp.	14.33%	14.82%	16.73%
BDO Unibank, Inc.	14.30%	14.32%	14.52%
East West Banking Corp.	13.08%	13.59%	13.64%
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	7.40%	13.52%	24.23%
Philippine Veterans Bank	4.14%	4.42%	0.37%
Robinsons Bank Corp.	-	-	14.56%
TOTAL / AVERAGE / MEDIAN	15.34%	15.76%	15.82%

FOREIGN BANKS

Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	108.02%	112.45%	126.93%
Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	97.90%	86.69%	65.67%
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	94.52%	89.07%	83.91%
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	68.95%	81.74%	85.11%
Bank of America NA	66.88%	70.28%	74.53%
Mega International Commercial Bank	64.94%	55.74%	62.83%

Industrial Bank of Korea	62.96%	64.56%	78.04%
Shinhan Bank	62.64%	58.46%	55.68%
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	57.10%	58.82%	58.68%
Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	56.27%	46.02%	45.24%
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	53.02%	67.23%	63.00%
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	47.45%	56.98%	45.08%
KEB Hana Bank	45.39%	44.06%	53.24%
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	44.71%	47.59%	45.15%
Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	31.19%	29.84%	27.12%
Bank of China (Hong Kong) Ltd.	30.49%	26.16%	28.00%
ING Bank N.V.	29.01%	35.77%	49.39%
Mizuho Bank Ltd.	26.78%	25.94%	27.62%
Deutsche Bank AG	21.82%	19.56%	24.81%
MUFG Bank Ltd.	18.80%	17.00%	20.20%
Standard Chartered Bank	18.61%	17.64%	16.17%
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	18.44%	19.71%	17.56%
Maybank Philippines, Inc.	15.64%	17.08%	19.16%
CTBC Bank	14.88%	15.91%	17.90%
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	13.01%	12.78%	12.52%
Citibank NA	-	-	21.75%
MEDIAN	45.39%	46.02%	45.20%

GRAND MEDIAN 18.80% 19.56% 21.75%

LIQUIDITY RATIO LIQUID ASSETS/TOTAL DEPOSITS

	Q2' 24	Q1' 24	Q2' 23
P100B AND OVER			
BDO Unibank, Inc.	0.2473	0.2453	0.2447
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	0.4517	0.4481	0.4087
Land Bank of the Philippines	0.4504	0.4434	0.4234
Bank of the Philippine Islands	0.2427	0.2472	0.2285
China Banking Corp.	0.2229	0.2189	0.2088
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	0.3220	0.3208	0.3694
Philippine National Bank	0.4805	0.4518	0.4273
Security Bank Corp.	0.3642	0.3553	0.4099
Union Bank of the Philippines	0.2726	0.2740	0.2318
Development Bank of the Philippines	0.3004	0.2750	0.2699
East West Banking Corp.	0.2101	0.2007	0.1866
Asia United Bank Corp.	0.5413	0.5279	0.4716
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	0.8178	-	0.7381
Bank of Commerce	0.2975	0.3000	0.2824
Philippine Trust Co.	0.2213	0.2320	0.2895
Philippine Bank of Communications	0.2465	0.2497	0.2160
MUFG Bank Ltd.	0.9340	1.1012	0.8753
Standard Chartered Bank	1.2037	1.1999	1.2631
Maybank Philippines, Inc.	0.3394	0.3917	0.5614
MEDIAN	0.3220	0.3104	0.3694

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

Mizuho Bank Ltd.	0.8018	1.2091	0.7324
CTBC Bank	0.2664	0.2597	0.2443
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	1.2761	1.3580	1.3111
Philippine Veterans Bank	0.4805	0.4609	0.3960
Bank of China Ltd.	0.6081	0.6418	0.6705
Deutsche Bank AG	1.1214	-	1.0782
MEDIAN	0.7050	0.6418	0.7014

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	1.1825	1.1151	0.9889
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	0.3469	-	0.3315
ING Bank N.V.	2.5885	4.2286	2.2651
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	1.6848	-	1.4204
BDO Private Bank	0.8528	-	0.6342
Bank of America NA	1.2649	1.2553	1.2667
KEB Hana Bank	0.6599	0.7067	0.6431
MEDIAN	1.1825	1.1852	0.9889

P20B AND BELOW

Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	1.4217	1.1558	0.9195
Mega International Commercial Bank	1.6190	1.5520	1.8633
Shinhan Bank	0.3599	0.3633	0.3265
Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	0.4822	0.7239	0.6312
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	46.1725	24.1818	10.5145
Industrial Bank of Korea	1.9708	1.9184	2.0363
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	5.6892	7.9362	5.7848
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	542.3245	35,610.0605	35,209.0406
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	1.4020	1.3465	1.2162
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	2.2900	1.5274	1.4869
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	0.6388	0.5675	0.6193
Citibank NA	-	1.1289	1.3750
Robinsons Bank Corp.	-	-	0.2941
MEDIAN	1.6190	1.4370	1.3750

GRAND MEDIAN	0.6081	0.5675	0.6312
TOTAL LIQUID ASSETS/TOTAL DEPOSITS	0.3583	0.3562	0.3509

LOANS TO ASSETS RATIO

TOTAL LOANS/TOTAL ASSETS		
Q2' 24	Q1' 24	Q2' 23

P100B AND OVER

BDO Unibank, Inc.	0.6485	0.6492	0.6328
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	0.4797	0.4393	0.4643
Land Bank of the Philippines	0.3549	0.3583	0.3493
Bank of the Philippine Islands	0.6601	0.6573	0.6369
China Banking Corp.	0.4433	0.4522	0.4722
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	0.4706	0.4884	0.4608
Philippine National Bank	0.5217	0.5272	0.4894
Security Bank Corp.	0.4907	0.5145	0.5222
Union Bank of the Philippines	0.4560	0.4567	0.4528
Development Bank of the Philippines	0.5028	0.5089	0.4851
East West Banking Corp.	0.6371	0.6410	0.6093
Asia United Bank Corp.	0.5441	0.5495	0.5750
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	0.2971	-	0.3279
Bank of Commerce	0.5386	0.5097	0.5182
Philippine Trust Co.	0.1555	0.1569	0.1250
Philippine Bank of Communications	0.5974	0.6045	0.5687
MUFG Bank Ltd.	0.3176	0.2691	0.2865
Standard Chartered Bank	0.1190	0.1153	0.1058
Maybank Philippines, Inc.	0.5477	0.5177	0.4176
MEDIAN	0.4907	0.5093	0.4722

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

Mizuho Bank Ltd.	0.2456	-	0.3174
CTBC Bank	0.5636	0.5873	0.5973
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	0.0102	0.0084	0.0048
Philippine Veterans Bank	0.4021	0.4094	0.3409
Bank of China Ltd.	0.6255	0.6182	0.5794

Deutsche Bank AG	0.3046	-	0.2771
MEDIAN	0.3533	0.4984	0.3291

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	0.2320	0.2431	0.3496
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	0.4283	-	0.4529
ING Bank N.V.	0.3005	0.4091	0.4121
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	0.1699	-	0.2012
BDO Private Bank	0.0443	-	0.0928
Bank of America NA	0.0962	0.1013	0.0866
KEB Hana Bank	0.6921	0.6936	0.6341
MEDIAN	0.2320	0.3261	0.3496

20B AND BELOW

Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	0.5635	0.6108	0.6932
Mega International Commercial Bank	0.3694	0.2887	0.2482
Shinhan Bank	0.5330	0.5442	0.6256
Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	0.3588	0.3961	0.4507
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	0.4730	0.5415	0.4682
Industrial Bank of Korea	0.6569	0.6079	0.5585
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	0.5555	0.5389	0.6832
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	0.2413	0.2610	0.3690
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	0.8070	0.7348	0.8144
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	0.5756	0.6196	0.6007
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	0.2598	0.3107	0.2588
Citibank NA	-	-	0.1416
Robinsons Bank Corp.	-	-	0.5425
MEDIAN	0.5330	0.5415	0.5425

GRAND MEDIAN	0.4706	0.5097	0.4608
TOTAL LOANS/TOTAL ASSETS	0.5106	0.5045	0.4958

*Bank of the Philippine Islands merged with Robinsons Bank Corp. effective Jan. 1, 2024.

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Exclusive: UOB Private Bank's Malaysia team sees six departures

Priyanka Boghani

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Citywire Asia

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English

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UOB Private Bank's Malaysia team head has left the bank along with five relationship managers (RMs), Citywire Asia understands.

Remus Tan, UOB Private Bank's senior team lead, has departed and is tipped to join Maybank as its new Malaysia market head, according to sources.

RMs in the Malaysia team, including Christina Tseng, Bernard Tay, Tina Tan, Laurence Kok and Stanley Nga, have also left. It comes after Dean Sia and Andy Chua's departures last year.

All the RMs have spent varied lengths of time at UOB, with Tseng working there for five years and Tay for six years. Tan, who spent four years at Bank of Singapore, joined UOB a year ago and Nga had a six-year stint at the Singaporean bank.

Tan worked for over six years at UOB Private Bank, where he covered the offshore high-net-worth market for Malaysia clients. Prior to that, he was at OCBC for over a decade.

Citywire Asia approached Maybank for comment on Tan's new role.

Not dependent on RM hires

At a recent corporate day in Kuala Lumpur, UOB's private banking chief, Chew Mun Yew, said he is not dependent on hiring RMs to bolster its assets.

He said they are not the only engine of client acquisition and noted that the deepening of existing wallet share and updating clients from other parts of the bank are also key strategies.

The bank has added 140 RMs in the last two and a half years, covering Southeast Asia and Greater China. Chew said 'more than 80% of them are working out well', with the majority generating sufficient revenue to cover their costs within 24 months.

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UOB's Chew: We're not dependent on RMs for growth

James Philipps

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Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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UOB **Private Bank** insists it is not dependent on hiring relationship managers to bring in new money, unlike many of its peers, expecting two thirds of future asset growth to come from existing customers of the wider group.

The Singaporean lender increased the **private bank**'s assets under management target to S\$145bn (\$110bn) by 2026, up from S\$120bn, at its corporate day in Kuala Lumpur on 14 August.

'The pathway to [reaching] S\$145bn is one third will come from new clients. The rest is deepening the share of wallet of existing clients, including the clients we upgrade from the rest of bank,' said head of **private bank** Chew Mun Yew (pictured) at the event.

'Hiring RMs is an important element of our strategy, but because we have the whole ecosystem and they can bring clients, we don't depend on RMs. For a lot of **private banks**, the RM is the only engine of client acquisition.'

The bank continues to hire RMs apace though and has added 140 in the last two and a half years, covering Southeast Asia and Greater China. Chew said 'more than 80% of them are working out well', with the majority generating sufficient revenue to cover their costs within 24 months.

Since Chew joined in December 2021, UOB has [consistently targeted 400 RMs](#) by 2026. The headcount reached 300 at the end of 2023, so recruiting 40 a year should reach the target, factoring in some attrition, he said.

The bank now has 15 bankers in Hong Kong, who report into the local **private banking** head Muck Kin Ling. They oversee 250 clients, including some previously booked in Singapore, but now serviced out of the special administrative region.

Greater China is the biggest client growth area for UOB and most of the **private bankers** it has hired are focused on the region, including out of Singapore. Chew said the regional recruitment tilt more reflects where the bank has been able to identify the right individuals, and it continues to recruit for both Greater China and Southeast Asia.

EAM quandary

The bank also expects to increase flows from **family offices** and external asset managers. Chew sees them as secondary targets, however, believing they could contribute around 20% of new money flows combined.

He cautions there is a 'lot of hype' around the fast-growing single-**family office** sector in Singapore and Hong Kong, but warns it can be a 'margin trap'.

The bank runs around \$7bn in **family office** assets, but Chew is more bullish on the growth potential of EAMs.

UOB has strengthened its EAM desk, but the industry is split on how to approach the sector. [HSBC](#) and [JP Morgan Private Bank](#) canned their EAM desks this year, while [BNP Paribas Wealth Management](#), [Deutsche Bank](#) and [Indosuez WM](#) opened them.

'The growth of the EAM business can be quite divisive because you have RMs (relationship managers) and there'll be a conflict with the direct business,' Chew said. 'But the good thing about our EAM business is that a lot of the clients our partners bring in actually are new to bank, so we don't suffer [from] that.'

Many EAM clients are looking for Singapore bank accounts, he said, 'so there's a lot of growth for all three of us', referencing rivals Singaporean banks, DBS and OCBC. The quality of servicing **private banks** provide, including speed of onboarding, is key to winning EAM business, Chew said. He has been building the team to ensure the process is as fast as possible and said whispers of rivals being slow to onboard is 'music to his ears'.

Mining the group

Targeting clients within the group, where 70% are business owners, is the core focus and expected to be buttressed by the region's strong wealth creation. UOB has upgraded 4,000 clients to the **private bank** in the first half of 2024, with 50% contributing new money. This was up from 2,300 clients, adding 33% new money last year.

Additionally, 1,400 clients have been referred by bankers in the wider franchise, of which 440 opened accounts at the **private bank**, averaging \$14m in assets apiece and \$6.1bn in total.

The **private bank** has pulled in \$22.5bn of net new money in the last two and a half years, which helped drive [record profits](#) this year. Over the same period investment penetration has increased from 42% in 2022 to 46% at the end of last year. Mun Yew said the figure is now closer to 50%, even as the bank's AUM has grown, and he hopes to up it to 55% by 2026.

Document CWIRAS0020240827ek8I00008

Supplement 1

Bespoke solutions, global vision beyond traditional private banking are key to manage ultra wealth across borders

1,448 words

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STBT

English

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ULTRA-HIGH-NET-WORTH investors are seeking tailored wealth management and protection solutions amid rising macro uncertainties.

A significant portion of ultra-high-net-worth individuals have yet to put comprehensive wealth plans in place, often due to the complexity and time-consuming nature of managing their wealth, as highlighted by HSBC Global Private Banking's Global Entrepreneurial Wealth Report.

Such clients are facing challenges in managing complex wealth across multiple jurisdictions, ensuring effective succession planning, and navigating volatile markets, said Tommy Leung, head of global private banking of South Asia.

It has become more important for them to bank with a well-rounded wealth manager like HSBC that offers superior international reach and strong local knowledge.

This is especially so given that today's entrepreneurs are globally connected -- the wealthier entrepreneurs are, the more geographically dispersed businesses and families become, they highlighted. In one instance, a private banking client approached HSBC for mortgage needs in the United Kingdom. This discussion soon expanded to meet the client's other expressed needs, including opening an account in Singapore to manage their investment portfolio and subsequently, commercial opportunities within SEA were explored.

Among the 973 wealthy entrepreneurs (including 95 ultra-high-net-worth individuals) polled globally in the report, 73 per cent live across more than one market and 89 per cent own businesses that are trading beyond their immediate border.

"While many ultra-high-net-worth individuals own homes or businesses in multiple jurisdictions, the next 20 years will also witness one of the largest wealth transfers in history, with trillions of assets passing to the next generation. As a result, these clients require highly sophisticated wealth management and multi-jurisdictional, multi-generational wealth planning," said Kerri Lim, head of ultra-high-net-worth segment of Asia in HSBC.

HSBC's private banking team that offers a global network and full suite of banking capabilities, is uniquely poised to help ultra-high-net-worth entrepreneurs manage their wealth and succession planning across multiple jurisdictions, ensuring the best outcome for the business and wealth they have built.

These clients' needs have become increasingly complex and multifaceted over time, as they are seeking more comprehensive wealth planning solutions, including succession planning, family governance and flexible investment strategies.

Among wealth managers, HSBC stands out by offering tailored solutions that address these evolving needs.

As a prestigious international bank, it offers a global vision with a strong network of full-suite capabilities to provide holistic yet bespoke solutions to its clients.

"We provide personalised support through a dedicated team, ensuring that our clients receive the best advice and solutions for their unique circumstances," said Lim, adding that the clients can benefit from its deep expertise in structured lending, alternative investments, and wealth planning/advisory services.

Singapore as a hub to serve the ultra-high-net-worth

Singapore, as a leading financial hub in Asia, has become a prominent base for wealthy families and individuals in the region.

The number of family offices in Singapore grew from about 400 in late 2020 to around 1,100 towards the end of 2022, according to the Economic Development Board.

"Positioned as a regional linchpin hub, Singapore connects international and regional onshore markets, particularly in South-east Asia and the Middle East and North Africa region," noted HSBC Global **Private Banking**'s Leung.

The Republic's financial stability with a strong rule of law, a robust political system and comprehensive infrastructure also boosted its status as a **wealth management** hub, as ultra-high-net-worth individuals, family offices and entrepreneurs look to access Asia and beyond for their business and **wealth management** needs.

As of end-2023, overall assets under management in Singapore grew 10 per cent to S\$5.41 trillion, reflecting a rising demand for **wealth management** services.

With the number of the ultra-high-net-worth investors rising, HSBC is committed to grow its presence to serve the group in Singapore and beyond, on the back of a positive outlook of the region's growth prospect.

Leung highlighted the global diversification and connectivity these ultra-high-net-worth clients need: "At HSBC Global **Private Banking**, we leverage our extensive global network to offer clients unparalleled access to diversified investment opportunities, especially valuable in these uncertain times."

HSBC's international network covers more than 60 markets in Europe, the Middle East and Africa, North America and Latin America and Asia. With deep roots in Asean, HSBC's first branch in Singapore opened in 1877. The bank's **private banking** team operates across 40 markets and 13 strategic booking centres. Singapore is one of the key global wealth hubs, with dedicated teams serving clients in Singapore, Malaysia, Indonesia, Australia, China, Hong Kong, Taiwan, India, the Middle East, Thailand and the Philippines, providing comprehensive coverage across the region.

"Our presence in Singapore allows us to tap into the city-state's robust financial infrastructure while providing our clients with the global diversification they seek," said Leung.

In the first half of 2024, HSBC's Global **Private Banking** Asia sustained strong momentum with US\$15 billion of net new invested assets, reflecting the UK lender's strong ability to attract and manage substantial new investments in the flourishing region.

On Jun 19, HSBC unveiled its new Wealth Centre on the ground floor of Marina Bay Financial Centre Tower 2. This marked the first of three wealth centres that HSBC plans to establish in Singapore by Q1 2025, aiming to facilitate the bank's services to the burgeoning affluent population in the country.

Distinctive ultra-high-net-worth proposition

HSBC, with a global presence in all major global wealth hubs beyond Asia, offers a differentiated proposition that goes beyond traditional **private banking**.

The bank offers the full breadth of the universal bank and investment platform and delivers the best of HSBC through its universal banking model with Commercial Banking, Global Banking and Markets, Asset Management, Insurance and more.

This allows its clients, such as business owners and their families, to have access to the bank's wholesale franchise services, and have their personal, business and institutional needs in multiple markets met thoroughly.

They highlighted that the bank offers clients differentiated and customised solutions on areas including deep credit expertise, wealth planning solutions, alternative investments as well as environmental, social, and governance.

Each of HSBC's ultra-high-net-worth clients is supported by a core team, with a global relationship manager acting as the primary contact for the client.

The relationship manager will link the client up with specialists best equipped to help them build their financial strategies, such as an ultra-high-net-worth investment counsellor who can bring appropriate ideas, recommendations and advice.

"In the strategically located booking centres, the team provides clients with not only coverage, but also connection to the respective teams around the world to provide the bank's deep local investing and banking expertise. This makes us stand out against competition to offer global wealth and mobility solutions to our clients," noted Lim.

Outside of Asia, HSBC is one the few banks that has a relevant position in all major global wealth hubs, including the United Kingdom, United Arab Emirates, the US, Switzerland, Channel Islands and Isle of Man.

"HSBC Global **Private Bank**'s ambition is to be the world's leading **wealth manager** and global **private bank** for Asian and international clients and entrepreneurs -- South-east Asia is key to our growth strategy," said Leung, noting that the ultra-high-net-worth segment is a key focus as they offer bespoke, institutional-level solutions tailored to the complex needs of those clients.

HSBC Global **Private Banking** Asia reported invested assets up 23 per cent year-on-year to US\$185 billion as of the second quarter of 2024, underscoring its robust growth and market leadership.

Notably, the bank provides clients access to sophisticated investment management products, bespoke financial and capital markets services, and extensive credit facilities through its global network.

Additionally, HSBC Global **Private Bank** has one of the largest wealth planning and advisory teams in Asia, along with a dedicated ultra-high-net-worth solutions group and ultra-high-net-worth segment team to serve the clients.

HSBC has been committed to innovation, client-centricity, and excellence, while working on developments to enhance our offerings, including advancements in digital services and bespoke investment solutions.

"We believe in a holistic approach that goes beyond traditional **private banking**, leveraging our global reach and strength in Asia to provide our clients with unparalleled access to growth markets, investment opportunities and best-in-class expertise," said Leung.

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Supplement 1

StanChart: Winning over UHNW clients with its global network and proposition

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WITH the global growth in Indian wealth, Standard Chartered **Private Bank** is confident that it can leverage its heritage, brand presence, network and open architecture platform to offer a differentiated proposition to this segment.

Standard Chartered **Private Bank**'s global head of South Asia Community and regional head of Europe, Middle East and Africa, Vinay Gandhi, believes that the bank's regional footprints in corporate banking, wealth and retail banking give it a strong position to meet the needs of this community.

"Our unique combination of deep local knowledge and a global network enables us to meet the local and international wealth needs of our clients," he says.

According to the International Monetary Fund's 2024 World Economic Outlook, India's GDP is expected to grow by 7.8 per cent in 2024, and is on track to becoming a US\$5 trillion economy by 2027.

Gandhi attributes this growth to key factors such as consistent policy reform, political stability, a healthy financial sector as well as an increased pace of digitalisation which has boosted the service sector.

This robust growth is reflected in the strong performance of the Indian stock market, boosting investor confidence as well creating significant wealth. Notably, there were a record number of 200 Indians on Forbes' 2024 list of billionaires, with a combined wealth of a staggering US\$954 billion, up 41 per cent from US\$675 billion a year ago.

Significantly, the nation's wealth is being generated from a more diverse range of sectors beyond telecom and energy. "We are seeing a sharp growth in startups especially in the technology and pharmaceuticals space," Gandhi says, adding that with the current Artificial Intelligence (AI) boom, India is expected to have 250 unicorns by 2025.

Strong legacy footprint in India with seamless global coverage

Standard Chartered has been present in India since Chartered Bank opened its first branch in Kolkata on 12 April 1858. This long history has given the bank a deep understanding of India. Currently, its corporate bank is one of the largest foreign lenders in India and it has a strong retail presence in the country with over 100 branches across 43 cities. "Our heritage and local presence give us a deep understanding of the Indian market," observes Gandhi.

To capture the growth in India, Standard Chartered has continued to invest in its **private bank** in the country as it remains a focal point to capture the onshore market and be the centre of excellence to service Global Indian wealth.

The bank has plans to grow its team of relationship managers by almost 15 per cent by the end of this year. It has also added **private banking** centres in Kolkata and Chennai in 2023 to serve ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) clients, with more centres planned for 2025.

"These new centres align with the growth in wealth and increase in UHNW client penetration across multiple locations in the country. Our strategic approach is to capitalise on emerging opportunities and cater to the evolving needs of UHNW clients across India," Gandhi says. He also notes that Standard Chartered already has presence in GIFT City and is exploring a **private banking** centre there to offer **wealth management** services.

In addition, to service the well-travelled and internationally connected Global Indian client base, Gandhi highlighted that the bank's established presence in financial centres such as Dubai, London, Hong Kong and Singapore helps it meet its clients' needs around the globe.

London has traditionally been attractive as a wealth hub with access to good educational and healthcare facilities as well as the presence of a large Indian diaspora, while Dubai has benefited from the economic boom in the Middle East with its pro-business environment and tax regime. Meanwhile, Singapore has been favoured for its strong and stable financial sector, multicultural composition, strategic location within Southeast Asia as well as its proximity to India.

As an example, Gandhi says that an UHNW family with a business in India, a second generation living in Dubai and the UK, and a family office setup in Singapore can be serviced seamlessly across all four locations through the bank's network. "All of these locations are well positioned as gateways to wider regions and come with inherent advantages in terms of efficient business environments," Gandhi says.

Best-in-class coverage and solutions for sophisticated Global Indian clients

From his experience, Gandhi notes that wealthy Indians outside of India tend to have a strong entrepreneurial spirit and are very sophisticated with complex investment needs across asset classes. Serving them requires a strong platform with diverse idea generation, efficient execution, and 24-hour trading access to global markets. With Standard Chartered **Private Bank**'s robust investment platform, its clients have exclusive access to a diverse list of international fund managers with strong track records.

Global Indian clients being served out of Singapore and Dubai have traditionally been very active in fixed income, foreign exchange and equity derivative products. Gandhi believes that the bank has a very strong platform for these where advisers can get live executable quotes from a multitude of counterparties and can execute the trade instantly at the most competitive pricing.

There is also a strong interest in alternative investment options. "This interest is being driven by several factors such as the desire for diversification, the potential for higher returns, and the need to preserve wealth in a rapidly changing economic landscape. Global Indian clients are looking towards more sophisticated, premium, and exclusive products that offer better returns," Gandhi says.

Playing on the bank's open architecture strengths, its clients have access to private markets to generate income from real estate and infrastructure assets. They can benefit from the higher-for-longer interest rate environment through their investments in floating rate private credit.

Gandhi also highlights the bank's emphasis on a holistic portfolio approach as opposed to tactical trades. "Over the last three decades, I have noticed that some clients have been very successful in short-term tactical trades but less so in long-term strategic trades. We monitor client performance very rigorously, and regularly ask our advisers to make sure that clients' portfolios are properly subdivided into foundation and opportunistic holdings."

The **private bank** has built an experienced team of specialists with investment, **wealth management**, and corporate knowledge who work closely with relationship managers to serve the complex and sophisticated needs of HNW and UHNW individuals and families. These investment advisers work closely with the clients to deliver well-diversified portfolios that are positioned in line with their objectives and the bank's Chief Investment Office's (CIO) views.

Superior advisory with a focus on Impact Investing

Gandhi notes that Global Indians are increasingly aligning their **wealth management** and planning objectives with sustainable investing strategies. "For many UHNW individuals and affluent families, engaging in sustainable investing not only helps generate positive impact but is also a good diversification for their wealth portfolios," he says.

"We are committed to strengthening our expertise in these fields and have made strategic hires to boost our wealth planning and advisory teams across our wealth hubs. We have also forged key partnerships with industry leaders in sustainability and philanthropy to deliver a strong value proposition to support our clients' legacy goals."

Gandhi says that the bank's team of relationship managers and wealth specialists undergo specially curated training to equip them with skills including elements of wealth planning, philanthropy and sustainable financing such as its recent tie up with Centre of Sustainable Finance and Private Wealth, University of Zurich.

To sum it all up, Gandhi says, "Our long-standing history in India combined with our presence in key global cities as well as our client centricity give us expertise and drive to meet the needs of Indian clients across the globe."

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Business Times Breaking News

Harnessing almost 90 years of experience in navigating intergenerational wealth transfer

Lee Kim Siang

1,064 words

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STBT

English

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THIS is the generation of the “Great Wealth Transfer”. It is anticipated that there will be a large-scale transfer of private wealth from the post-World War II generation, or often referred as Baby Boomers, to younger generations. The successors are poised to inherit about US\$90 trillion of assets in the coming decades. Specifically, in Asia alone, some 70,000 high-net-worth individuals are set to transfer US\$2.5 trillion of generational wealth by the turn of the decade, according to a Knight Frank report. Real wealth will be concentrated in the North Asia region, including Hong Kong, mainland China, and Taiwan. Chew Mun Yew, managing director and head of UOB **Private Bank**, shares his perspective on succession planning in the changing landscape of family **wealth management** and how UOB **Private Bank** leverages its strengths to help high-net-worth families achieve generational success.

Q: Why has succession planning become more relevant and important now more than ever before? A: We are entering the biggest intergenerational transfer of wealth in history. This shift requires careful planning to preserve and manage assets effectively, ensuring the continuity, growth and preservation of the family’s wealth and legacy. Succession is a common and pressing concern for wealthy families, yet they often do not take proactive steps to address it. For many, the focus is still on wealth accumulation and asset preservation. It is not surprising that more than half of high-net-worth families in Asia do not have a robust plan in place. Q: What unique challenges do high-net-worth families face? A: The transfer of wealth from one generation to the next is crucial but it can be complex, and at times sensitive, especially in Asia where family harmony and filial piety take precedence. Some see it as a taboo to broach the topic of succession planning, given it is associated with the subject of mortality. There is often a reluctance to address these topics head-on, causing them often being left for another day. Another challenge is the generational gap in perspectives and values. The older generation often prioritises preserving the family legacy and traditional **wealth management**, while the younger generation favours innovation and new strategies. Balancing these differing viewpoints requires careful mediation and a thoughtful approach to succession planning. Q: How can these complexities be effectively navigated? A: It is crucial to engage in open, respectful dialogue facilitated by trusted **wealth managers** who understand both the cultural context and technical aspects of succession planning. With nearly 90 years of experience and an extensive footprint across Asean, we are well-placed to understand the nuances, and to simplify the complexities of intergenerational wealth transfer. We know just how emotional and uncertain family succession can be. That’s why we prioritise building trust – earning a seat at the table and becoming a trusted partner in the vital conversations that take place between generations as they explore their own succession. Q: In what ways has the evolving landscape impacted the approach to succession planning today? A: In the everchanging world of business, it is essential to develop and future-proof the next generation of business leaders. They need the skills and vision to navigate evolving challenges and opportunities, ensuring that they can effectively manage and grow the wealth and family business they stand to inherit. This new landscape also requires a more nuanced approach. The **wealth manager** should consider the needs and ambitions of both the immediate heirs and future generations, creating legacy and succession plans that remain adaptable to future changes while ensuring sustained success. UOB **Private Bank** was recently named as Asia’s and Singapore’s best **Private Bank** for Next-Gen at the Euromoney **Private Banking** Awards 2024. Our immersive next gen programme offers a rich curriculum designed to equip the future leaders with relevant management capabilities, technical skillset, and networking opportunities. It focuses on entrepreneurship, digital innovation and technology – elements crucial to the sustainability and longevity of family businesses. Q: Putting together a succession plan is not a one-time affair. How do **Private Banks** approach this, and how do you see UOB **Private Bank** doing this differently? A: **Private banks** tailor succession plans to ensure seamless wealth transfer, leadership continuity and legacy preservation, leveraging trusts, governance frameworks and expert advisory services to ensure long-term stability. At UOB **Private Bank**, we take on a journey of great foresight in succession planning together with our clients. As a financial institution owned and managed by the third-generation, we know first-hand what it takes for wealth to endure across generations. That enterprising spirit and shared experience have enabled us to deeply understand our clients’ needs, aspirations and challenges from a business owner’s perspective and offer insights and

solutions that are sound and relevant for them. Leveraging extensive regional networks from our Asean franchise, we also provide the connectivity and opportunities to maximise the potential of our clients' portfolios. We harness vast resources and deep capabilities across business segments within the UOB group, drawing upon the wealth of expertise, experience and synergies to support Asian high-net-worth families. With our home based in Singapore, the nation's stability and security is also ours. This gives our clients a combined comfort and peace of mind, where they can trust us to safeguard their well-earned assets and future. Because of our history, our experience, our focus and our roots, nobody understands the values and heart of Asean better than we do. The importance of succession planning and starting it early cannot be overstated. Rarely is succession smooth but here at UOB **Private Bank**, our goal, like yours, is to always see beyond the now to the long term. We will be right by you to help generations progress, together. And to help grow, preserve and transfer wealth for the long-term. Disclaimer: The material contained in this publication is intended for information only and does not constitute recommendation or advice as it does not take into account personal objectives, specific goals or financial situation. UOB does not accept any responsibility for any loss or damage caused by any use of or reliance on the opinions or views expressed in this publication which may be subject to change due to dynamic market conditions.

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Bank DBS Indonesia helps Balikpapan citizens feel confident in seizing investment and business opportunities

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Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Bank DBS Indonesia offers One Bank Solution for individual and business needs.
- * Bank DBS Indonesia captures local and regional insights for **wealth management**.
- * Bank DBS Indonesia connects customers with global networks for banking and lifestyle access.

Original Press Release:

Indonesia, Aug. 15 -- DBS Bank Ltd. issued the following news release:

- Through personalised advisory with Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning-based data processing
- One Bank Solution for individual and business needs and access to Bank DBS' global networks

Bank DBS Indonesia ("Bank DBS") always strives to understand the challenges faced by customers and identify their needs through research. Its latest research has found changes in **wealth management** needs, including a change in the definition of wealth in the affluent segment. In the past, wealth in the affluent segment denoted the financial profile of an individual. Today, it also encompasses the financial profile or net worth of a business. Therefore, it is crucial for **wealth management** partners to have a vision and capabilities that cover both areas.

In addition, the 2024 Customer Immersion study on Bank DBS Indonesia's priority and **private banking** segments highlights the affluent segment's dominance in Indonesia with 66 percent of them classified as business owners, 16 percent as private employees and 15 percent as professionals. Other findings reveal that three segments, namely retail, priority and **private banking**, share a common need, which is to find partners who can provide guidance and discuss investment and business opportunities. This is especially crucial for priority and **private banking** customers.

However, each segment faces different challenges. The retail segment may find investment too hard to understand. The priority banking segment, on the other hand, faces problems in finding reliable partners to support growth in every aspect of life (financial, business, and personal growth). Meanwhile, the **private banking** segment has to deal with the challenges of information complexity as they strive to strengthen their business while preparing the next generation to run the business.

To support all three segments, Bank DBS Indonesia presents personalised solutions that suit the profile of each segment so that customers can 'Be Confident. Be More of You.' These solutions include local and regional insights, Bank DBS' global networks, business and investment banking services (Consumer Banking Group and Institutional Banking Group), and artificial intelligence-enhanced insights. Bank DBS Indonesia also continues to grow wealth penetration by improving financial literacy and expanding access to investment products in the digibank by DBS ecosystem with non-banking partners in the wealth technology sector. These partnerships will be further scaled up in 2025 to accelerate wealth growth at Bank DBS Indonesia.

"Bank DBS Indonesia understands the different needs for **wealth management** in each segment, which is why we deal with it early on by presenting different solutions so that they can Be Confident. Be More of You. Exclusive to digibank by DBS customers, Bank DBS Indonesia enables them to cleverly navigate the future. For the DBS Treasures segmen, we equip them with the necessary instruments to embrace all opportunities, both big and small. As for the DBS Treasures Private Client segment, Bank DBS Indonesia provides various solutions so that

customers can leave their footprint across generations," said Director of Consumer Banking at PT Bank DBS Indonesia Melfrida Gultom.

To support these customers' aspirations, Bank DBS Indonesia applies the One Bank Solution approach, a holistic solution to make it easier for customers to access banking services under one roof:

1. Local and regional insights: in a dynamic market environment, Bank DBS Indonesia captures every signal, no matter how small, and turns it into an opportunity with the support of a team of regional experts, the Chief Investment Office (CIO), and sharpened by a team of experts in each country to design personalised **wealth management** strategies for each client.
2. Bank DBS' global networks: for banking and lifestyle access and transactions
3. Business and investment banking services: Connecting customers with Bank DBS Indonesia's networks to support business expansion and wealth building.
4. Artificial intelligence-enhanced insights (based on market data, profiles, and customer behavioral characteristics: momentum-driven analysis tailored specifically for each customer to enable them to make the right financial decisions.

Beyond that, ESG-linked Asset under Management (AuM) in Asia-Pacific is set to more than triple to USD3.3 trillion by 2026, according to PwC's "Asset and **Wealth Management** Revolution 2022" report. This shows the growing public interest in and awareness of sustainable investment. Accordingly, Bank DBS Indonesia is expanding access to Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG)-linked investment solutions that generate higher potential returns while making a positive impact on society and the environment, in line with its vision to be the 'Best Bank for a Better World'.

To further increase wealth penetration, Bank DBS Indonesia organised a series of wealth literacy programmes for all segments, ranging from the Live & Learn financial literacy programme for digibank by DBS customers to Smart Talk for DBS Treasures and DBS Treasures Private Client in the form of the latest outlook from Bank DBS Indonesia's and regional experts and prominent speakers, as well as networking to open doors to new opportunities.

This year, Bank DBS Indonesia made the Be Confident. Be More of You Road Trip to six cities: Pekanbaru, Makassar, Balikpapan, Jakarta, Medan, and Surabaya. Balikpapan was the third stop where the event discussed two main topics, namely "5 Surefire Ways to Achieve Wealth" and "Win the Digital Race: Business Expansion & Wealth Development". It was presented by experts in their fields, such as Head of Market Intelligence PT Bank DBS Indonesia Boy Suhendry, DBS Group Research Maynard Arif, Entrepreneur, Content Creator, and Community Builder Theo Derick, Founder The Overpost Leonard Hartono, among others.

All these efforts are tangible proof of Bank DBS Indonesia's 'spark' to provide comprehensive solutions for customers in line with its 'Trust Your Spark' spirit and in accordance with Bank DBS Indonesia's commitment to making customers 'Live more, Bank less'. For more information, please visit the DBS **Wealth Management** website <https://go.dbs.com/dbswealth>.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the world's "Most Innovative in Digital Banking" by The Banker. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 15 consecutive years from 2009 to 2023. DBS Indonesia is ranked second in the top as World's Best Bank in Indonesia for three consecutive years from 2020 to 2022.

Established in 1989 as part of the Singapore-based DBS Group, PT Bank DBS Indonesia (Bank DBS Indonesia) is one of the banks with the longest history in Asia. Currently operating 1 Head Office, 13 Branch Offices, 16 Assistant Offices and 4 Functional Offices and 3,011 active employees in 15 Major Cities in Indonesia, Bank DBS Indonesia provides comprehensive banking services in the corporate, SME and consumer banking segments that

focuses on the customer experience to 'Live more, Bank less'. We also see a purpose beyond banking and are committed to supporting our customers, employees and the community towards a sustainable future.

PT Bank DBS Indonesia is licensed and supervised by The Indonesian Financial Services Authority (OJK), and an insured member of Indonesia Deposit Insurance Corporation (LPS).

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by supporting businesses for impact: enterprises with a double bottom-line of profit and social and/or environmental impact. DBS Foundation also gives back to society in various ways, including equipping underserved communities with future-ready skills and helping them to build food resilience.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

[Category: Banks, Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Financial/ Capital Market, Artificial Intelligence]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd.

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Straits Times Breaking News

Business

In comfortable shoes, DBS' next CEO Tan Su Shan runs the bank by day and the Bay by night

Ravi Velloor

1,579 words

15 August 2024

The Straits Times

STIMES

English

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Several evenings a week, a Chinese Singaporean woman clad in jogging gear and Nike shoes emerges from Tower 3 of the Marina Bay Financial Centre and heads towards Gardens by the Bay.

It is the DBS CEO-designate's way of de-stressing, gathering her thoughts and, above all, staying fit for the seemingly incandescent energy and enthusiasm she exudes at work, and outside it.

Her friends say Tan Su Shan runs the bank by day, and the Bay by night.

After a global search that started when DBS' legendary chief executive officer Piyush Gupta informed the board that he would like to retire when he turns 65, the bank's board, led by Mr Peter Seah, picked Ms Tan by "unanimous" consent, according to the chairman.

On March 28, 2025, she will be the first woman CEO of South-east Asia's largest lender by assets, and the second woman to head a Singapore bank, after Ms Helen Wong at OCBC.

DBS has always been a board-led bank, and investors seem convinced that the board made the right choice, and reassured that Mr Seah himself will be around a while longer.

DBS' share price barely budged on Aug 8 - the day after the announcement - as the country absorbed the news. Investors have pushed it up since. The shares ended Aug 14 trading at \$34.61, up more than 4.5 per cent in the past five days.

The chalice Ms Tan inherits from Mr Gupta is a worthy one, characterised by record profit, impressive returns on equity and one that is highly digitalised - a much-chronicled and highly rewarding technology journey of which she was very much a part during her 14 years with the bank.

"Just go and do it, lah," Mr Seah, her longstanding well-wisher, is said to have told the senior team in a 2013 board meeting, after hearing several rounds of enthusiastic presentations on the need for DBS to digitalise, and handing them an extra \$200 million for the effort.

While much of what Mr Gupta set in motion will doubtless continue, DBS is poised to see a change of style at the top. DBS chief executive Piyush Gupta; chairman Peter Seah; and group head of institutional banking Tan Su Shan, who will succeed Mr Gupta in March 2025. PHOTO: DBS

Mr Gupta was adept at hiding his softer side - there were, for instance, no layoffs or retrenchments under him - all the time exuding a muscular, practical approach to banking, and demanding total alignment from staff on the bank's goals.

Ms Tan, 56, comes across as collegial, concerned and caring.

The only hint of muscularity is the steel Rolex Daytona that she wears on her left wrist - a gift from her husband Chris, said to be a supportive, chilled-out spouse who rides a Harley-Davidson and was in the British Army before building a career as a **private banker**.

Ms Tan and Mr Christopher Wilson reportedly met in Hong Kong nearly three decades ago.

"Su Shan emerged from the **private banking** universe, and that makes her highly customer-centric," says a senior Singaporean banker who has known her for two decades.

"Most senior bankers, when they travel for work, are inclined to start by conducting business reviews with their overseas staff. Su Shan, on the other hand, will be off to engage key clients first thing." More On This Topic 'What'll define me as CEO? In a word, impact': DBS' Tan Su Shan 'Be with the customer through their darkest hour': DBS CEO-designate Tan Su Shan

Customers appreciate that hand-holding. Mr S.S. Teo, managing director of Pacific International Lines, recalls a particularly difficult time for his company in late 2019, requiring a restructuring.

At a two-hour meeting on Oct 1 that year, Ms Tan gave Mr Teo a patient hearing. Then, she took the case to Mr Gupta, who supported the restructuring.

"She said 'as long as the customer is open and truthful, we will work with him to overcome his challenges'," Mr Teo recalls.

"In 2020, when we did the restructuring, DBS was lead banker and their presence helped us convince other banks. The rest is history. By March 2021, we had paid off all debts and we had very good results thereafter. The company was kept intact.

"What's more, when my father passed away in September 2020, she was at the wake, although it was Covid times."

People who know the DBS CEO and his incoming successor say the differences in exterior and style notwithstanding, there is a lot in common between them.

Both were born to civil servant fathers - Mr Gupta in India, and Ms Tan in Singapore. Both went to fine schools - St Columba's School, St Stephen's College and the Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad in Mr Gupta's case, and CHIJ St Nicholas Girls' School, Hwa Chong Institution and Oxford University for Ms Tan.

Both also acquired global experience before landing at DBS. Mr Gupta spent more than two decades at Citi, interrupted by a brief foray to lead a technology start-up. Ms Tan has worked at Barings Securities, Citibank and Morgan Stanley, in places as diverse as London, Tokyo and Hong Kong. More On This Topic DBS faces challenges amid changing environment in the post-Piyush era DBS succession: The end of an era, but incoming CEO Tan Su Shan is poised to run the next lap well

Like Mr Gupta, Ms Tan brings a common-sense approach to issues, and it starts from the bottom up. Her shoes, for instance, are what might be called "sensible", bought from Japanese boutique Le Talon Footwear.

Why this relatively unknown brand? Because she finds Talon to be the most comfortable.

That practicality shows up in her work.

Shortly after she joined DBS in 2010 at Mr Gupta's call and was given charge of the **private bank** and chairmanship of the asset management arm, she asked to be "downgraded" to a position that meant giving up direct access to the CEO, surprising him.

She did so because she realised that to be a real **wealth manager**, you have to be product-agnostic.

"How could I possibly look a client in the eye and say DBS has the best funds for all purposes if I owned my own asset management company?"

Later, she sold the asset management division. Today, **wealth management** is a key profit centre for the bank.

Singlife Group CEO Pearlyn Phau, who worked alongside Ms Tan as DBS acquired SocGen Securities' **private banking** business and the **wealth management** business of ANZ, describes her as someone who knows what she does not know, and is willing to learn.

Ms Tan was one of the first in DBS to do what is called "reverse-mentoring" - getting younger, more knowledgeable people to educate her on technologies such as cloud and blockchain.

"I always felt empowered around her," says Ms Phau. "She is not naturally rough, but she can be tough - for instance, with errant sellers who flout bank guidelines or mislead customers. Then, she has no qualms about

doing what needs doing." More On This Topic DBS Q2 profit tops forecasts, rising 6% to \$2.79 billion as wealth fees surge Once a DBS intern, now its next CEO: 5 things to know about Tan Su Shan

And like Mr Gupta, who thinks nothing of dancing in the aisles during a rock music concert, Ms Tan can be fun, too. Colleagues say that at company dinner-and-dance events, she is among the most enthusiastic participants.

Not that she is short on tenacity either.

Ms Tan got her first job - at Barings Securities - because of her Japanese-language skills. Turns out that when she was a schoolgirl at St Nicholas, she was learning tap dancing and couldn't speak to the rest of her class, most of whom were Japanese girls.

So, in addition to her Chinese mother tongue, she picked up Japanese as well.

That tenacity and relentlessness would show up in her working life.

One of the stories about Ms Tan that has passed into legend is that she took her Bloomberg terminal with her into the labour room of KK Women's and Children's Hospital as she gave birth in February 1999 to their first child, a girl.

"I was working for Morgan Stanley as a banker and I had a yen margin call," she recalls. "As you saw last week, when the yen goes, it goes. Last week, it went from almost 160 (to the US dollar) to 147.

"When I was looking at it (in 1999), it went from 118 to 111. Big figures.

"I had to bring my laptop along into the labour room. I wheeled in my Bloomberg because if you have a margin call, you have to decide whether to cut loss or not."

Over the past two decades, she has been an active member of the KKH Health Endowment Fund Board and, until the beginning of 2024, served as chairperson of the KKH Health Fund's Grant Making Committee.

She has helped raise more than \$2 million through her collective efforts over the years, including organising cake-bake sales.

READ NEXT: Be with the customer through their darkest hour, says incoming DBS CEO Tan Su Shan

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Front Page Business

DBS Q2 profit rises 6% to \$2.79b on growth in wealth business

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8 August 2024

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DBS raised its full-year income outlook as second-quarter earnings rose more than expected on the back of a strongly growing **wealth-management** business.

South-east Asia's largest bank reported a 6 per cent rise in second-quarter net profit to \$2.79 billion on Aug 7, up from the \$2.63 billion recorded in the same period a year earlier.

If costs from the integration of Citigroup's Taiwan consumer business were excluded, second-quarter earnings grew 4 per cent to \$2.8 billion, topping the mean estimate of \$2.71 billion from five analysts, according to LSEG data.

The board declared a dividend of 54 cents a share for the second quarter, bringing the first-half payout to \$1.08 a share.

DBS chief executive Piyush Gupta said: "While recent market volatility and ongoing geopolitical tensions have resulted in heightened uncertainty, we have built resilience against the risks of an economic slowdown and lower interest rates."

DBS has "a reasonable amount of dry powder", he told a results briefing on Aug 7, from the ample general allowances the bank has set aside for potential bad loans. This will help to absorb unexpected risks from a recession or sharp economic slowdown, he said.

The lender has also added nearly \$65 billion of fixed-rate assets in recent years, bringing the total to \$190 billion. Mr Gupta said: "That makes a big difference to the interest rate sensitivity of our book."

While falling interest rates will hit the bank's margins, they are also likely to boost demand for loans and strengthen market sentiment.

Mr Gupta said: "That makes us reasonably well positioned for the next year."

The bank's total income growth in 2024 is anticipated to be a high single digit. In May, when presenting DBS' first-quarter results, Mr Gupta said total income growth would be 1 to 2 percentage points above the previous guidance of mid-single digit.

He said on Aug 7 that full-year net profit growth will be in the mid- to high single digits.

Net interest income in the second quarter from the bank's commercial book rose 5 per cent year on year to \$3.77 billion as the lender's net interest margin, a key profitability gauge, improved two basis points to 2.83 per cent.

Loans grew 3 per cent and deposits rose by 6 per cent in constant-currency terms, bolstered by the consolidation of Citi Taiwan.

Net fee income from the commercial book grew 27 per cent to a record \$1.05 billion, as **wealth management** fees jumped 37 per cent to \$518 million. This was driven by a shift from deposits into investments and bancassurance, as well as an expansion in assets under management.

Wealth assets under management surged 24 per cent in the quarter to a record \$396 billion. The **wealth management** segment income rose 19.6 per cent to \$1.29 billion for the quarter.

The bank recorded \$3 billion in net new money inflows in the second quarter, bringing the total to \$9 billion for the first half of 2024.

Card fees increased 32 per cent to \$313 million from higher spending, with the Citi Taiwan consolidation benefiting **wealth management** and card fees, DBS said. Loan-related fees were also higher, rising 40 per cent to \$186 million.

Expenses increased 12 per cent to \$2.17 billion, with Citi Taiwan accounting for 5 percentage points of the increase. The cost-to-income ratio stood at 40 per cent.

Asset quality remained sound, DBS said. Non-performing assets fell 3 per cent from the previous quarter to \$5.08 billion, as new non-performing asset formation was more than offset by repayments and write-offs. The non-performing loan ratio was unchanged at 1.1 per cent.

The lender set aside more allowances in the second quarter. Specific allowances amounted to \$97 million, bringing the half-year amount to \$210 million, or nine basis points of loans.

General allowances of \$51 million were also taken in the second quarter, compared with the same period in 2023 when the bank wrote back \$42 million. This brought general allowances to \$73 million for the first half of 2024.

DBS' net profit fell 5 per cent from \$2.95 billion in the first quarter.

The bank had record earnings of \$5.76 billion for the first half of the year, excluding Citi Taiwan integration costs, up 9 per cent from the same period in 2023.

The DBS results wrap up Singapore banks' earnings season. UOB posted a 1 per cent increase in second-quarter net profit to \$1.43 billion on Aug 1.

The following day, OCBC Bank said its earnings in the second quarter rose 14 per cent to \$1.94 billion.

DBS shares closed up 2.75 per cent to \$33.65 on Aug 7.

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Business Times Breaking News
Companies & Markets
When will DBS get a new CEO?

Tan Nai Lun
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As banking veteran Piyush Gupta nears his 15th year at the helm of South-east Asia's largest bank, questions are being asked about who his successor will be

DBS chief Piyush Gupta is nearing his 15th year at the helm of South-east Asia's biggest bank, and does not appear to be slowing down. But there has been considerable chatter about how long he is going to remain in charge. At a briefing for analysts held when the bank released its first-quarter results in May, he was asked point-blank if he was leaving this year. His reply: "No, I am not retiring this year." Asked subsequently whether he would be at DBS three years hence, Gupta, among the highest-paid CEOs in Singapore, sidestepped the question. He pointed to the bank's "robust succession planning process at every step and in every level of the organisation". He added: "The defining questions to me are: Do we have enough momentum in the business, is our strategy sound, is our execution capability robust, and is the culture in the company long-lasting? I think the answer to all of those is yes." Given that answer, even if there is no change, it is probable that Gupta could step aside in the near future. Long service Gupta was handed the reins of the Singapore bank in November 2009, joining from Citibank, where he was then CEO for South-east Asia, Australia and New Zealand.

While Gupta's time at DBS is at this point not as long as his 27-year stint at Citi, he is already DBS' longest-serving CEO. At 14 years, his tenure is almost twice as long as the bank's next longest-serving CEO, Ngiam Tong Dow, who held the top role for eight years. Gupta, 64, is among the oldest of chief executives helming Singapore companies in Singapore state investor Temasek's portfolio. There is Loh Chin Hua of Keppel, and Hiew Yoon Khong of Mapletree Investments, who are both 62. Other Temasek-portfolio company chiefs range in age from their late 40s to 60. That said, Gupta has been at the helm for a shorter period of time than Hiew, for example. Mapletree's group CEO was appointed in 2003, six years before Gupta took DBS' top job. Leadership reorganisation DBS has historically chosen most of its successors from outside the bank, with Gupta himself having joined DBS from Citibank. But Gupta himself has made reference to the internal candidates who are qualified for his role. DBS made a leadership reshuffle in 2023, rotating some of its younger management staff into different roles at the bank, following the retirement of Sim S Lim, then group head of consumer banking and **wealth management**. Among those moved was Han Kwee Juan, who became Singapore country head from head of strategy and planning.

Hired in 2019, he was named by Gupta, in a 2019 interview with business and finance magazine Euromoney, when he spoke about his potential successors. Then, Gupta said he had four or five candidates, all of whom "with the right grooming, have the potential to take my job some day". Other bankers he named included Tan Su Shan, head of corporate and commercial banking, and Shee Tse Koon, head of consumer banking group and **wealth management**. Tan was formerly head of consumer banking group and **wealth management**, while Shee was formerly Singapore country head.

Han also wore a second hat as acting chief information officer for DBS from November 2023 to May 2024, when the bank split its technology and operations function into two units under its drive to improve technology resiliency. Gupta said he was a "big believer in having generalists", which meant someone who could look after the consumer, wealth, as well as corporate side of the business.

Howard Yu, Lego professor of management and innovation at IMD Business School, rates the chances of DBS selecting an internal candidate as "quite high" – around 70 to 80 per cent. He said: "The recent leadership reorganisation, which saw key internal candidates elevated to critical roles, strongly suggests that DBS is actively grooming potential successors from within." The professor also said that the ideal candidate would be an "inside outsider" – someone who has been with the company for a long time, but has not been responsible for the

mainstream business. This would imbue the individual with a unique blend of institutional knowledge and fresh perspective. "This type of 'rebel talent' can be particularly valuable in driving necessary changes, while still understanding the organisation's limits and levers," he said. In any case, the choice for DBS' next CEO would likely need the green light from its largest shareholder, Temasek. Yu said Temasek's substantial stake in the bank is likely to influence the selection of a new CEO "who aligns with Singapore's long-term strategic interests".

"The chosen candidate will need to demonstrate an ability to maintain strong relationships with government stakeholders and continue DBS' role as a key pillar of Singapore's financial sector," he said. The next thing is timing. These indicators aside, there is no official word on when or if Gupta is stepping down anytime soon.

The timing of the change could well depend on various factors. Given the significance of such a change, the bank is likely to give the market some time to digest the news before the actual handover.

One could look to Singapore's second-largest bank, OCBC, which announced in January 2021 that Helen Wong would take over as CEO. She officially took up the post in April, around the time of the bank's annual general meeting, when she then could meet the shareholders. Wong was already at OCBC. If the next DBS CEO comes from within the ranks, a similar timeframe could possibly work.

There are also various moving parts. Another factor might well be determined by what happens to the board chairmanship.

The bank's chairman, Peter Seah, has been in his role since May 2010, and a board member since 2009. Depending on when board-level renewal takes place, it is likely to have an impact on when the CEO change happens.

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Business

Banks want to tap into Asia's wealth sector StanChart is doing it

413 words

31 July 2024

Financial Times

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18

English

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In 2020, Asia and **wealth management** were big buzzwords for global banks trying to address concerns about slowing growth elsewhere. Standard Chartered was among a long list of lenders that bet heavily on **wealth management** income from markets such as mainland China to drive growth. StanChart is among the few that has managed to deliver on its promise.

The London-headquartered lender yesterday reported second-quarter pre-tax profit of \$1.83bn and raised its outlook for income growth for this year. Operating income from wealth solutions rose a quarter in the first half, a record performance as net new sales more than doubled to \$13bn. This is an impressive feat: it has been up against strong competition from local Chinese banks as it tries to win mainland Chinese clients and from rival HSBC in Hong Kong.

The **wealth management** business in Asia especially in Hong Kong, Singapore and mainland China remains one of the most promising areas of growth for global lenders. It will offer an estimated \$81tn onshore opportunity in terms of personal financial assets by 2027, according to McKinsey research. There is room for lasting growth with the industry still in its early stages, with around half of those assets in cash and deposits. In mainland China alone, the ultrawealthy population with a net worth of \$30mn and over is expected to grow almost 50 per cent by 2028, according to Knight Frank research, despite the global economic slowdown.

Meanwhile, the StanChart balance sheet is in a good position to pursue growth with a common equity tier one capital ratio of 14.6 per cent, above its targeted 13-14 per cent target range. In the coming quarters, sticking to cost reduction plans will be key to keeping earnings strong: StanChart is in the midst of a fresh cost-cutting programme and is aiming to save the bank about \$1.5bn over the next three years. Stringent cost controls, including slowing hiring and slashing bankers' travel and entertainment expenses, has been a common theme for Asia's lenders this year.

The bank's shares rose nearly 6 per cent yesterday following the better than expected earnings. Still, they trade at just 0.7 times tangible book value, a significant discount to regional peers, and a third lower compared with HSBC. A record \$1.5bn share buyback coupled with sustained wealth earnings growth should help narrow that gap.

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Maybank names new group **wealth management** head

Priyanka Boghani

190 words

30 July 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Malaysia's Maybank has promoted its current Singapore **wealth management** head to group head, according to a 30 July statement from the bank.

Alice Tan will be the group **wealth management** (GWM) head from 1 August, reporting to both the group CEO of community financial services and the CEO of Maybank Singapore.

As the head of GWM, Tan will lead Maybank's group **wealth management** business, which covers the Privilege Wealth, Premier Wealth, Private Wealth, and Islamic Wealth segments in all the countries where the bank operates, the statement said.

She will also be responsible for integrating Maybank Singapore's regional strategy, creating and developing the bank's **wealth management** business with regional/global Privilege, Premier, Private, and Islamic Wealth.

Tan has worked with several asset managers before Maybank, including Overseas Union Bank, UOB Asset Management, Allianz Dresner Asset Management and Societe Generale Asset Management.

Her career in private banking started at Coutts where she was head of investment consultants for South Asia and deputy head of client portfolio managers, Asia at Credit Suisse before she joined Maybank Singapore in 2014.

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Banks want to tap into Asian wealth — StanChart is doing it

435 words

30 July 2024

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Financial Times (FT.Com)

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English

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In the coming quarters, sticking to cost reduction plans will be key to keeping earnings strong

In 2020, Asia and **wealth management** were big buzzwords for global banks trying to address concerns about slowing growth elsewhere. Standard Chartered was among a long list of lenders that bet heavily on **wealth management** income from markets such as mainland China to drive growth. StanChart is among the few that has managed to deliver on its promise.

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june.yoon@ft.com

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Credit Analyst: Effie Tsai, Taipei (886) 2-2175-6824; effie.tsai@taiwanratings.com.tw,
effie.tsai@spglobal.com Secondary Contact: Jenny Lin, Taipei (886) ...

Former BNP Paribas WM banker moves to DBS in Dubai

Priyanka Boghani

144 words

29 July 2024

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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A former BNP Paribas Wealth Management banker in the Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC) has moved to Singaporean **private bank** DBS, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Sidharth Kalia has joined DBS as a **private banker** based in Dubai. He reports to the bank's head of **private banking**, Shanker Iyer.

A spokesperson for DBS declined to comment on the hire.

Kalia was at the French **private bank** for almost three years and prior to that he worked at Credit Suisse for more than two years.

He spent the bulk of his career at Standard Chartered Bank, where he worked for over 15 years. Most recently he held the role of unit head, international priority clients for more than five years.

Prior to this role, he was at ICIC Bank as a team leader.

Document CWIRME0020240730ek7t0002u

Bank DBS Indonesia helps Pekanbaru citizens feel confident in seizing investment and business opportunities | Bahasa

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1,526 words

27 July 2024

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* 66% of affluent segment in Indonesia are business owners, 16% are private employees, and 15% are professionals.

* Bank DBS Indonesia presents personalised solutions for retail, priority, and **private banking** segments.

* Bank DBS Indonesia relocates its Pekanbaru branch office to Surya Dumai Building, Jl. Jend. Sudirman No. 395, Pekanbaru, Riau.

Original Press Release:

Indonesia, July 27 -- DBS Bank Ltd. issued the following news release:

- Through personalised advisory with Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning-based data processing
- One Bank Solution for individual and business needs and access to Bank DBS' global networks

Bank DBS Indonesia ("Bank DBS") always strives to understand the challenges faced by customers and identify their needs through research. Its latest research has found changes in **wealth management** needs, including a change in the definition of wealth in the affluent segment. In the past, wealth in the affluent segment denoted the financial profile of an individual. Today, it also encompasses the financial profile or net worth of a business. Therefore, it is crucial for **wealth management** partners to have a vision and capabilities that cover both areas.

In addition, the 2024 Customer Immersion study on Bank DBS Indonesia's priority and **private banking** segments highlights the affluent segment's dominance in Indonesia with 66 percent of them classified as business owners, 16 percent as private employees and 15 percent as professionals. Other findings reveal that three segments, namely retail, priority and **private banking**, share a common need, which is to find partners who can provide guidance and discuss investment and business opportunities. This is especially crucial for priority and **private banking** customers.

However, each segment faces different challenges. The retail segment may find investment too hard to understand. The priority banking segment, on the other hand, faces problems in finding reliable partners to support growth in every aspect of life (financial, business, and personal growth). Meanwhile, the **private banking** segment has to deal with the challenges of information complexity as they strive to strengthen their business while preparing the next generation to run the business.

To support all three segments, Bank DBS Indonesia presents personalised solutions that suit the profile of each segment so that customers can 'Be Confident. Be More of You.' These solutions include local and regional insights, Bank DBS' global networks, business and investment banking services (Consumer Banking Group and Institutional Banking Group), and artificial intelligence-enhanced insights. Bank DBS Indonesia also continues to grow wealth penetration by improving financial literacy and expanding access to investment products in the digibank by DBS ecosystem with non-banking partners in the wealth technology sector. These partnerships will be further scaled up in 2025 to accelerate wealth growth at Bank DBS Indonesia.

"Bank DBS Indonesia understands the different needs for **wealth management** in each segment, which is why we deal with it early on by presenting different solutions so that they can Be Confident. Be More of You. Exclusive to digibank by DBS customers, Bank DBS Indonesia enables them to intelligently navigate the future. For the

DBS Treasures segment, we equip them with the necessary instruments to embrace all opportunities, both big and small. As for the DBS Treasures Private Client segment, Bank DBS Indonesia provides various solutions so that customers can leave their footprint across generations," said Director of Consumer Banking at PT Bank DBS Indonesia Melfrida Gultom.

To support these customers' aspirations, Bank DBS Indonesia applies the One Bank Solution approach, a holistic solution to make it easier for customers to access banking services under one roof:

1. Local and regional insights: in a dynamic market environment, Bank DBS Indonesia captures every signal, no matter how small, and turns it into an opportunity with the support of a team of regional experts, the Chief Investment Office (CIO), and sharpened by a team of experts in each country to design personalised **wealth management** strategies for each client.
2. Bank DBS' global networks: for banking and lifestyle access and transactions
3. Business and investment banking services: Connecting customers with Bank DBS Indonesia's networks to support business expansion and wealth building.
4. Artificial intelligence-enhanced insights (based on market data, profiles, and customer behavioral characteristics: momentum-driven analysis tailored specifically for each customer to enable them to make the right financial decisions.

Beyond that, ESG-linked Asset under Management (AuM) in Asia-Pacific is set to more than triple to USD3.3 trillion by 2026, according to PwC's "Asset and **Wealth Management** Revolution 2022" report. This shows the growing public interest in and awareness of sustainable investment. Accordingly, Bank DBS Indonesia is expanding access to Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG)-linked investment solutions that generate higher potential returns while making a positive impact on society and the environment, in line with its vision to be the 'Best Bank for a Better World'.

To further increase wealth penetration, Bank DBS Indonesia organised a series of wealth literacy programmes for all segments, ranging from the Live & Learn financial literacy programme for digibank by DBS customers to Smart Talk for DBS Treasures and DBS Treasures Private Client in the form of the latest outlook from Bank DBS Indonesia's and regional experts and prominent speakers, as well as networking to open doors to new opportunities.

This year, Bank DBS Indonesia made the Be Confident. Be More of You Road Trip to six cities: Pekanbaru, Makassar, Balikpapan, Jakarta, Medan, and Surabaya. Pekanbaru was the first stop where Bank DBS Indonesia held the Smart Talk event to present a sharp analysis of and the latest insights into investment, business and asset growth. The event discussed two main topics, namely "5 Surefire Ways to Achieve Wealth" and "Win the Digital Race: Business Expansion & Wealth Development", presented by experts in their fields, such as Regional Business Manager West Region at PT Bank DBS Indonesia Herman; Head of Research at DBS Group William Simadiputra; General Manager Commercial at PT Tri Buana Solusi Inovasi Teknologi Nicko Arywibowo; Investor, Content Creator, and Community Builder Theo Derick, among others.

To get closer to customers, Bank DBS Indonesia relocated its Pekanbaru branch office to Surya Dumai Building, Jl. Jend. Sudirman No. 395, Pekanbaru, Riau. The new office makes it easier for customers to access banking services and make the most of the various investment and business opportunities offered by Bank DBS Indonesia.

All these efforts are tangible proof of Bank DBS Indonesia's 'spark' to provide comprehensive solutions for customers in line with its 'Trust Your Spark' spirit and in accordance with Bank DBS Indonesia's commitment to making customers 'Live more, Bank less'. For more information, please visit the DBS **Wealth Management** website <https://go.dbs.com/dbswealth>.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the world's "Most Innovative in Digital Banking" by The Banker. In addition, DBS has been accorded the

“Safest Bank in Asia“ award by Global Finance for 15 consecutive years from 2009 to 2023. DBS Indonesia is ranked second in the top as World’s Best Bank in Indonesia for three consecutive years from 2020 to 2022.

Established in 1989 as part of the Singapore-based DBS Group, PT Bank DBS Indonesia (Bank DBS Indonesia) is one of the banks with the longest history in Asia. Currently operating 1 Head Office, 13 Branch Offices, 16 Assistant Offices and 4 Functional Offices and 3,011 active employees in 15 Major Cities in Indonesia, Bank DBS Indonesia provides comprehensive banking services in the corporate, SME and consumer banking segments that focuses on the customer experience to 'Live more, Bank less'. We also see a purpose beyond banking and are committed to supporting our customers, employees and the community towards a sustainable future.

PT Bank DBS Indonesia is licensed and supervised by The Indonesian Financial Services Authority (OJK), and an insured member of Indonesia Deposit Insurance Corporation (LPS).

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by supporting businesses for impact: enterprises with a double bottom-line of profit and social and/or environmental impact. DBS Foundation also gives back to society in various ways, including equipping underserved communities with future-ready skills and helping them to build food resilience.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

[Category: Banks, Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Financial/ Capital Market, Artificial Intelligence]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd.

Document ATINBK0020240812ek7r0002x

Exclusive: BNP Paribas WM team head tipped to join DBS

Priyanka Boghani

150 words

24 July 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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A BNP Paribas Wealth Management team head is slated to join DBS **Private Bank**, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Ling Ly Loh will join DBS **Private Bank**, based in Singapore, where she will take on a similar role.

A spokesperson from BNP Paribas and for DBS declined to comment.

Loh has been at BNP Paribas Wealth Management for over four years.

DBS **Private Bank** has been busy [beefing](#) up its onshore and offshore Thailand teams, hiring product specialists and relationship managers from Credit Suisse.

In the first quarter of 2024, DBS's wealth assets hit a record [high](#) of S\$365bn (\$271.3bn). The Singaporean lender's full-year net profit rose 26% to S\$10.3bn as income grew by 22% to top S\$20bn for the first time, boosted by higher net interest margins and fee income.

Document CWIRAS0020240724ek7o00003

Bank DBS Indonesia helps make people feel confident in taking investment and business opportunities

Distributed by Contify.com

1,308 words

23 July 2024

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Bank DBS Indonesia offers global networks for banking and lifestyle access
- * Bank DBS Indonesia provides business and investment banking services
- * Bank DBS Indonesia uses Artificial Intelligence for momentum-driven analysis tailored for each customer

Original Press Release:

Indonesia, July 23 -- DBS issued the following news release:

- Through personalised advisory with Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning-based data processing
- One-Bank Solution for individual and business needs and access to Bank DBS' global networks

Bank DBS Indonesia ("Bank DBS") always strives to understand the challenges faced by customers and identify their needs through research. Its latest research has found changes in **wealth management** needs, including a change in the definition of wealth in the affluent segment. In the past, wealth in the affluent segment denoted the financial profile of an individual. Today, it also encompasses the financial profile or net worth of a business. Therefore, it is crucial for **wealth management** partners to have a vision and capabilities that cover both areas.

In addition, the 2024 Customer Immersion study on Bank DBS Indonesia's priority and **private banking** segments highlights the affluent segment's dominance in Indonesia with 66% of them classified as business owners, 16% as private employees and 15% as professionals. Other findings reveal that three segments, namely retail, priority and **private banking**, share a common need, which is to find partners who can provide guidance and discuss investment and business opportunities. This is especially crucial for priority and **private banking** customers.

However, each segment faces different challenges. The retail segment may find investment too hard to understand. The priority banking segment, on the other hand, faces problems in finding reliable partners to support growth in every aspect of life (financial, business, and personal growth). Meanwhile, the **private banking** segment has to deal with the challenges of information complexity as they strive to strengthen their business while preparing the next generation to run the business.

To support all three segments, Bank DBS Indonesia presents personalised solutions that suit the profile of each segment so that customers can 'Be Confident. Be More of You.' These solutions include local and regional insights, Bank DBS' global networks, business and investment banking services (Consumer Banking Group and Institutional Banking Group), and Artificial Intelligence-enhanced insights. Bank DBS Indonesia also continues to grow wealth penetration by improving financial literacy and expanding access to investment products in the digibank by DBS ecosystem with non-banking partners in the wealth technology sector. These partnerships will be further scaled up in 2025 to accelerate wealth growth at Bank DBS Indonesia.

"Bank DBS Indonesia understands the different needs for **wealth management** in each segment, which is why we deal with it early on by presenting different solutions so that they can Be Confident. Be More of You. Exclusive to digibank by DBS customers, Bank DBS Indonesia enables them to intelligently navigate the future. For the DBS Treasures segment, we equip them with the necessary instruments to embrace all opportunities, both big and small. As for the DBS Treasures Private Client segment, Bank DBS Indonesia provides various solutions so

that customers can leave their footprint across generations," said Director of Consumer Banking at PT Bank DBS Indonesia Melfrida Gultom.

To support these customers' aspirations, Bank DBS Indonesia applies the One Bank Solution approach, a holistic solution to make it easier for customers to access banking services under one roof:

1. Local and regional insights: in a dynamic market environment, Bank DBS Indonesia captures every signal, no matter how small, and turns it into an opportunity with the support of a team of regional experts, the Chief Investment Office (CIO), and sharpened by a team of experts in each country to design personalised **wealth management** strategies for each client.
2. Bank DBS' global networks: for banking and lifestyle access and transactions.
3. Business and investment banking services: connecting customers with Bank DBS' networks to support business expansion and wealth building.
4. Artificial Intelligence-enhanced insights (based on market data, profiles, and customer behavioral characteristics: momentum-driven analysis tailored specifically for each customer to enable them to make the right financial decisions.

To increase wealth penetration, Bank DBS Indonesia organised a series of wealth literacy education programmes for all segments, ranging from digibank Live & Learn financial education classes for digibank by DBS customers, to Smart Talk for DBS Treasures and DBS Treasures Private Client customers in the form of the latest outlook from Bank DBS Indonesia and regional experts and leading speakers, as well as networking to open doors to new opportunities.

Beyond that, ESG-linked Asset under Management (AuM) in Asia-Pacific is set to more than triple to USD3.3 trillion by 2026, according to PwC's "Asset and **Wealth Management** Revolution 2022" report. This shows the growing public interest in and awareness of sustainable investment. Accordingly, Bank DBS Indonesia is expanding access to Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG)-linked investment solutions that generate higher potential returns while making a positive impact on society and the environment, in line with its vision to be the 'Best Bank for a Better World'.

All these efforts are also tangible proof of Bank DBS Indonesia's 'spark' to provide comprehensive solutions for customers in line with its 'Trust Your Spark' spirit. For more information, please visit the DBS **Wealth Management** website <https://go.dbs.com/dbswealth>.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the world's "Most Innovative in Digital Banking" by The Banker. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 15 consecutive years from 2009 to 2023. DBS Indonesia is ranked second in the top as World's Best Bank in Indonesia for three consecutive years from 2020 to 2022.

Established in 1989 as part of the Singapore-based DBS Group, PT Bank DBS Indonesia (Bank DBS Indonesia) is one of the banks with the longest history in Asia. Currently operating 1 Head Office, 13 Branch Offices, 16 Assistant Offices and 4 Functional Offices and 3,011 active employees in 15 Major Cities in Indonesia, Bank DBS Indonesia provides comprehensive banking services in the corporate, SME and consumer banking segments that focuses on the customer experience to 'Live more, Bank less'. We also see a purpose beyond banking and are committed to supporting our customers, employees and the community towards a sustainable future.

PT Bank DBS Indonesia is licensed and supervised by The Indonesian Financial Services Authority (OJK), and an insured member of Indonesia Deposit Insurance Corporation (LPS).

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by supporting businesses for impact: enterprises with a double bottom-line of profit and social and/or environmental impact. DBS Foundation also gives back to society in

various ways, including equipping underserved communities with future-ready skills and helping them to build food resilience.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

Source: DBS

[Category: Banks, Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Financial/ Capital Market, Artificial Intelligence]

Document ATINBK0020240805ek7n000gu



Business

OCBC to expand operations in Macau

Enoch Yiu

651 words

15 July 2024

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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Singapore giant expects **wealth management** to be key engine of growth

Singaporean banking giant OCBC Group is expanding its **wealth management** and corporate banking business in Macau to tap opportunities in the Greater Bay Area and offset falling demand for mortgages.

"**Wealth management** will be our future growth engine," Kelvin Lou Po-hong, chief executive of OCBC Macau, said in an interview in the gaming hub. "We would also like to serve more corporate clients who are expanding in Macau, riding on the government's policies to diversify the economy."

OCBC is diversifying into these new areas because mortgage lending, the bank's core business in Macau, has declined in recent years owing to falling property transactions, he added.

OCBC, the second largest bank in Southeast Asia by assets, joins financial firms such as Manulife, Prudential and HSBC Life that have expanded in the gaming hub.

Group chief executive Helen Wong said in May that the lender would spend HK\$1.5 billion over the next three years to upgrade its Hong Kong and Macau digital platforms, offices and branches.

The plan does not entail increasing branch numbers in Macau, but they will be upgraded to cater to more **wealth management** customers, Lou said.

While Macau's population of 680,000 is smaller than the population of Sha Tin, the city has a strong tourism industry.

"Macau attracts about 30 million tourists every year, or on average about 100,000 a day," he said. "Many of these visitors are from Greater Bay Area cities, who need about 15 minutes by car to cross the border to buy insurance and fund products in Macau."

Beijing rolled out the Greater Bay Area blueprint in February 2019 to integrate Hong Kong, Macau and nine mainland cities into an economic powerhouse.

OCBC entered Macau via its acquisition of Wing Hang Bank in 2014. By taking over Wing Hang Bank's 11 branches and 450 employees in Macau, the lender is now the second-largest bank in the former Portuguese colony, with total assets of HK\$32 billion at the end of 2023.

Lou, 52, was born and brought up in Macau. After getting a bachelor's degree in commerce from the University of Alberta, Canada, he returned to Macau and joined KPMG, where he worked for 11 years before switching to Wing Hang Bank in 2007. He held many positions in the finance sector before his current role.

An increasing number of financial firms and companies from other sectors from Hong Kong and Asia are expanding their footprint in Macau following the government's launch of the "1+4" development strategy last year. The strategy calls for the diversification of the casino-dependent economy to four other sectors, namely healthcare, financial services, technology, and conventions and exhibitions.

"Previously, our corporate clients were mainly domestic small and medium-sized enterprises, but the '1+4' policies have attracted more large companies to Macau," Lou said.

These newcomers, ranging from luxury brands, jewellers and supermarket chains, have boosted OCBC Macau's corporate banking business. This segment represented 45 per cent of its business last year, up from about 30 per cent in 2019. Revenues meanwhile grew 20 per cent last year.

OCBC Macau is leaning more on **wealth management**, selling policies for AIA and China Life, while also offering hundreds of fund products to its clients.

"Many Macau investors previously invested only in property or stocks in Hong Kong," Lou said. "Now we see more wealthy customers both from Macau and the Greater Bay Area buying insurance and fund products."

Macau's economy has a modest financial sector. There are only three securities intermediaries, 27 insurers and 33 lenders, compared with 600 stockbrokers, 160 insurance companies and 164 banks in Hong Kong.

Lou said Macau lenders could still compete for wealthy customers from cities like Zhuhai and Zhongshan.

Document SCMP000020240714ek7f0000j

Deutsche Bank PB recruits from HSBC for SE Asia market head

Cheryl Heng

200 words

11 July 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Deutsche Bank **Private Bank** has hired a new market head for Southeast Asia from HSBC Global **Private Banking**, who will be building a team to cover the market.

Paul Handley has joined Deutsche Bank PB as managing director and market head for Southeast Asia, according to a media release on 11 July. Citywire Asia [first reported](#) the move earlier this week.

He will manage and recruit a team of relationship managers to cover the Southeast Asia market.

Handley will report to Johannes Oeni, head of **private bank**, Southeast Asia. Oeni said strengthening the bank's Southeast Asia platform remains a strategic priority, expecting Handley to expand capabilities in the ultra-high-net-worth segment.

Handley had worked at HSBC in Bangkok for more than a year, covering the onshore and offshore desks for Thailand and Vietnam.

He was also in Singapore for over five years, where he was responsible for the Philippines market as well. Prior to HSBC GPB, he worked at JP Morgan **Private Bank** for five years. He had an earlier 10-year stint at HSBC in various locations before his role at JP Morgan.

Document CWIRAS0020240711ek7b00001

Exclusive: UBS GWM philanthropy veteran joins HSBC GPB

Priyanka Boghani
278 words
10 July 2024
Citywire Middle East
CWIRME
English
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A former UBS Global Wealth Management philanthropy head has joined HSBC Global **Private Banking**, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Christina Tung has taken up the role of HSBC GPB's new head of Trust and Fiduciary Services (TFS) for North Asia, an appointment that's been confirmed by a company spokesperson. She is based in Hong Kong.

Tung was most recently head of A&S client services, which included client development, family office and marketing for over four years. Before that she was head of the client strategy office for Greater China before spending over a decade as UBS GWM's philanthropy head for the Apac region.

Tung was also actively involved in the Swiss **private bank**'s philanthropic organisation, Optimus Foundation.

UBS GWM's family advisory team now reports to Philippe Spielhofer, head of A&S North Asia, and the client development team is now integrated into the strategic development team led by Claire Tsui, UBS Hong Kong's head of strategic business development.

UBS declined to comment on the changes.

HSBC GPB's Lok Yim has [started](#) steering the bank's focus towards the ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) segment as a key driver for business growth. It recently launched a VC programme for Asia's UHNW clients.

Yim, in an exclusive conversation with Citywire Asia earlier this year, said clients are increasingly prioritising wealth preservation over pursuing higher returns and this is where succession planning and wealth protection can play a big role.

Last April, HSBC China [upgraded](#) its legacy offerings for its **private banking** clients in mainland China by launching a family trust advisory service.

Document CWIRME0020240710ek7a00002

Exclusive: Former HSBC GPB Thailand and Vietnam banker tipped to join Deutsche

Priyanka Boghani

277 words

9 July 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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A former managing director who covered Thailand onshore and offshore as well as Vietnam at HSBC Global **Private Banking** has departed and is tipped to join Deutsche Bank **Private Bank**, Citywire Asia has learnt.

Paul Handley is thought to be joining Deutsche Bank as a new Southeast Asia market head, relocating from Thailand to Singapore for the role.

A spokesperson from Deutsche Bank declined to comment.

Handley spent more than a year in Bangkok at HSBC, covering the onshore and offshore desks for Thailand and Vietnam. He was also in Singapore for over five years, where he was responsible for the Philippines market as well. Prior to HSBC GPB, he worked at JP Morgan **Private Bank** for five years. He was at HSBC again for over 10 years in various locations before his role at JP Morgan.

In April, Deutsche Bank PB's group head for Southeast Asia, Urs Brudermann and Doreen Seah, a senior client partner, [left](#) the bank.

The German **private bank** had a tough 2023 where revenues took a hit as transactions fell on the back of market uncertainty and interest rate hikes.

This year, it is focusing on the single-family office market. 'No one has yet put a flag in Asia when it comes to distinguishing and delivering a SFO offering,' [says](#) Marco Pagliara, the bank's Singapore-based head of emerging markets, said in an earlier conversation. The German lender will focus on SFOs with \$100m of assets and look to serve their investment needs, which typically tend to be more sophisticated with their own investment teams.

Document CWIRAS0020240710ek7900006

Exclusive: HSBC nabs StanChart's global wealth and retail COO

Priyanka Boghani

188 words

27 June 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC Global **Private Banking** and Wealth has nabbed Standard Chartered Bank's wealth and retail global COO, Citywire Asia can confirm.

Jean Nabaa has been appointed HSBC's new COO for its global **private banking** and wealth division, where he will relocate from Singapore to Hong Kong. The appointment is effective 16 September 2024.

A spokesperson from the bank confirmed the hire.

Nabaa was at Standard Chartered for 10 years, where he started in SCB's **private banking** business before his remit was extended to include wealth management products and services, as well as retail and small and medium-sized enterprise banking.

Nabaa joined the company in 2014 from Merrill Lynch, where he was COO for Asia Pacific wealth management after heading business development and strategy in the region. Before that he spent seven years at McKinsey.

He was [replaced](#) by Rosalind Ng at Standard Chartered.

HSBC's regional CEO for wealth, Lok Yim, [told](#) Citywire Asia the bank is focusing on bolstering its ultra high net worth segment, flattening its structure hierarchy and tightening processes across divisions.

Document CWIRAS0020240627ek6r00005

Singapore dollar bonds boom amid arb and stability

1,212 words

13 June 2024

GlobalCapital

EURMCM

English

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HSBC and Manulife among global names finding strong investor support in the Lion City

Bonds in Singapore dollars are fast becoming an integral part of international issuers' fundraising mix, reflected by a 30% year-on-year spike in volumes. Pricing arbitrage opportunities, a liquid if somewhat shallow fixed income market, and support for the currency are ensuring a strong pipeline.

By June 13, non-Singaporean borrowers had raised \$3.86bn-equivalent from the local bond market via 11 trades, according to Dealogic. This trumped the \$2.7bn over the same time in 2023, and surpassed the volumes in each of 2020, 2021 and 2022 year to date.

Notably, at the end of last week, HSBC Holdings priced a S\$1.5bn (\$1.1bn) additional tier one perpetual non-call 5.5 year note, the largest Basel III AT1 in Singapore dollar bond to be issued by any financial institution.

On Tuesday this week, Manulife Financial Corp followed with a S\$500m 10 year non-call five tier two bond, ending a seven year absence from the currency.

A senior Singapore-based syndicate banker said the Singapore dollar market does not generally see many senior deals, except on occasion from local corporates or holding companies. Most of the supply comes from offshore financial institutions as local banks are well-capitalised and do not need to tap capital markets for senior funding.

"Without seniors, the next best place to express risk is tier twos and if there's only a finite amount of tier twos, then the next best place to express your interest is tier one," said the syndicate banker. "In that context, Singapore dollars is an interesting place for issuers to get arbitrage funding, particularly in the tier one and tier two space."

The leads on the Manulife deal, for example, sounded out investors last Friday on a no-name basis to test their appetite for an insurance name, before marketing the tier two bonds in the 4.6% area on Tuesday.

They spotted Manulife's Canadian dollar bonds after swap costs in the 4.28% to 4.30% range, said a banker on the trade. The group's Singapore dollar deal was sealed at 4.275% — inside of the Canadian bonds' after-swap levels.

"This helped them achieve some arbitrage and at the same time allowed them to get the size they wanted," said the banker.

The books for Manulife peaked at S\$1bn, before landing at about S\$900m at reoffer. <h3 > Wealth appeal

Singapore's status as a **private banking** and wealth hub is also a factor in fuelling demand for deals, and in turn building a pipeline.

This is important. Many ultra-high net worth investors and family offices were hit in March 2023 when UBS's emergency takeover of Credit Suisse resulted in some \$17bn of Credit Suisse's AT1 bonds being written down to zero, hitting both institutional and retail investors.

As GlobalCapital's sister publication Asiamoney wrote at the time, AT1s had long been popular with Asia's **private banks** for the juicy yields they offer. The AT1 write-off triggered numerous lawsuits against the Swiss financial authority — many from Singapore-based ultra-rich individuals and family offices.

The upheaval, however, appears to have done some good in the year since.

"Post UBS-Credit Suisse, there's a lot more information symmetry and people are a lot more knowledgeable about the various structures and triggers which previously they might not have been as clear on," said the senior syndicate banker in Singapore.

He added: "The central banks also came out in a fairly coordinated fashion to clarify their rules around a write-off, so it has actually benefitted the space in terms of understanding the risks associated with these products, making the market more robust. That's also why we're seeing the bonds perform — may be even more so than pre-UBS/CS for that matter."

Manulife's notes were trading a little higher in the secondary market on Wednesday morning, according to a second syndicate banker on the deal.

HSBC's notes, sold on Thursday last week, opened at 99.90/100 at the break the following morning. There was some initial sell-off from hedge funds, pushing the bonds a bit lower. But soon after, **private banks** became big buyers of the bonds, helping stabilise the notes at 99.90/100 in the early afternoon session last Friday, reflecting the market's ability to digest such a chunky deal. <h3 > Supportive conditions

Most market participants believe the stability will last.

The second syndicate banker said Manulife came out quite soon after HSBC and yet it managed to raise its targeted amount and see strong secondary performance.

"The Sing market doesn't enjoy the same depth as the US dollar market, so it will take some time to digest S\$2bn worth of bonds," he said. "But if the secondary market is anything to go by, I would say demand is there; you just have to navigate the launch window more carefully."

The second syndicate banker said more issuers — including those that have not previously tapped the Singapore market — are exploring the currency and holding conversations with investment banks.

The senior Singapore syndicate banker said that his bank is looking to bring two debut credits to the Singapore dollar market in the next couple of weeks. These names are new to the city's local debt market but they have tapped G3 currencies before, giving investors some reference points.

That currency's appeal is also in some ways helped by the regulators' efforts to keep the market liquid, said bankers.

For instance, the Monetary Authority of Singapore issued S\$7.1bn worth of six-month Treasury bills through an auction on June 11. The cut-off yield was 3.75%, with the central bank receiving bids for twice the amount of bills, shows information on the MAS website.

"When T-bills are maturing, they can get rolled into a new T-bill or go to the fixed income market," said the senior syndicate banker. "I think we saw some of that [T-bill] money being recycled into the recent deals, particularly by **private banks**, including Manulife. For some investors, it's not an apple-to-apple comparison between a six-month triple-A rated T-bill versus five year single-A rated paper. But nonetheless, even a sliver of this T-bill money can help move transactions in a positive way."

The Singapore stock exchange is not the deepest, he said, so investors will need to find other avenues to put their money to work. Yields on Singapore dollar bonds from global issuers prove appealing.

"The depth and pool of liquidity within Singapore dollars would always persist because the government has a plethora of tools to keep liquidity within Singapore," said the senior banker. "So it's not going to shake the liquidity in any shape or form, even when rates are uncertain."

Manulife's deal was run by DBS Bank and Standard Chartered as bookrunners and lead managers, alongside co-managers ANZ and HSBC.

HSBC ran its own trade as sole global coordinator and bookrunner, joined by lead managers DBS Bank, OCBC and UOB.

Document EURMCM0020240701ek6d00022

Standard Chartered is appointed as Trustee, Fund Administrator and Custodian for iFAST's Authorised Collective Investment Scheme Retail Funds

Distributed by Contify.com

1,562 words

13 June 2024

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Standard Chartered appointed as Trustee, Fund Administrator, and Custodian for iFASTs Retail Funds
- * iFAST Fund Management manages 12 authorised retail funds with total assets under management of S\$1.1 billion as of March 31, 2024
- * iFAST Singapore is a subsidiary of SGX Mainboard-listed iFAST Corporation Ltd, providing investment solutions to various entities

Original Press Release:

Singapore, June 13 -- Standard Chartered issued the following news release:

iFAST Fund Management, a division of iFAST Financial Pte Ltd ("iFAST Singapore") and Standard Chartered ("the Bank") announced today the reinforced partnership between both organisations with the recent appointment of the Bank as Trustee, Fund Administrator and Custodian for seven Collective Investment Scheme ("CIS") Retail Funds managed by iFAST Fund Management. This new appointment by iFAST Fund Management demonstrates the strong collaboration between both organisations which consolidates all its Investment Retail Funds, inclusive of its Authorised VCC Funds launched back in 2022 with Standard Chartered as its sole custodial provider.

Since 2021, iFAST Fund Management has been growing its fund management capabilities in Singapore to service its investors and clients, playing an important part in the expanding fund ecosystem. iFAST Fund Management chose to partner Standard Chartered because of the Bank's track record in trustee solutions since 2014, providing a full suite of client solutions which include fund administration, transfer agency and custodial services for investor clients.

As an international bank and a pioneer provider of custodial services in Singapore, Standard Chartered leverages its in-depth experience and local expertise to offer clients across their global footprint a comprehensive suite of custody and asset servicing solutions ranging from International Custody, Fund Administration, Trustee and Transfer Agency services. These capabilities enable Standard Chartered to service onshore and offshore fund structures, across fund strategies, effectively supporting global, regional and local asset managers, asset owners and financial intermediaries.

iFAST Fund Management currently manages 12 authorised retail funds including variable capital company ("VCC") funds ranging from equity, fixed income to enhanced liquidity funds. iFAST Singapore holds a Capital Markets Services Licence and is a CPF Investment Scheme (CPFIS)-registered Investment Administrator. The company, the Singapore subsidiary of SGX Mainboard-listed iFAST Corporation Ltd ("iFAST Corp"), provides investment solutions to financial advisers, financial institutions, insurance companies, pension fund managers, retail and accredited investors, and multi-national companies.

Lim Chung Chun, Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of iFAST Corp said, "Standard Chartered has been a long-standing partner of the iFAST group over the years. We are pleased that Standard Chartered shares our vision and plans for our fund management business and this appointment showcases the strong commitment between both organisations to provide quality investment solutions to our investors and clients."

Francois Verlaine, Regional Head, Financing and Securities Services, ASEAN and South Asia, Standard Chartered, said, "We are thrilled to be able to leverage our expertise in trustee solutions to continue to support

iFAST's strategic growth in the fund management space. This appointment of Standard Chartered as iFAST's sole partner for all its investment funds is a strong testimony of the longstanding trust and understanding between both organisations."

About Standard Chartered Bank

Standard Chartered Bank in Singapore is part of an international banking group, with a presence in 53 of the world's most dynamic markets for more than 160 years and serving clients in a further 64. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

The Bank has a history of 165 years in Singapore, where we opened our first branch in 1859. In October 1999, we were among the first international banks to receive a Qualifying Full Bank (QFB) license, an endorsement of the Group's longstanding commitment to our business in the country.

Singapore is home to the majority of our global business leadership, our technology operations, as well as SC Ventures, our innovation hub. In 2013, the Bank transferred our Singapore Retail and SME businesses to a locally incorporated subsidiary, Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Limited ("SCBSL"). And in May 2019, we fully consolidated our business operations in Singapore through the transfer of our Commercial Banking, Corporate & Institutional Banking and Private Banking businesses to SCBSL. SCBSL is one of the highest-rated banks globally: A1/Stable by Moody's Investor Services, A+/Stable by Standard & Poor's and A+/Stable by Fitch Ratings. In August 2020, we were the first and only bank to be awarded the "Significantly Rooted Foreign Bank" (SRFB) status by the Monetary Authority of Singapore. In December 2020, we were granted enhanced SRFB privileges, in recognition of the significantly higher degree of rootedness exceeding the SRFB baseline criteria.

In September 2022, we launched Trust Bank Singapore Limited (Trust), our digital bank venture in partnership with FairPrice Group. Trust offers a wide range of products and features for retail customers, including credit cards, personal loans, savings accounts, insurance and money insights. Trust has become one of the world's fastest-growing digital banks and amassed over 700,000 customers, equivalent to 14% of the Singapore market, by end-2023.

In Singapore, we support both individual and corporate needs to build wealth and drive commerce at every step of their journey. We do this by offering an entire range of financial services across Wealth and Retail Banking as well as our Corporate and Investment Banking teams. The Bank has a network of 11 branches, including 4 Priority Banking Centres, 1 International Banking and Priority Private Centre, and 21 ATMs. For more information, please visit www.sc.com/sq.

About iFAST Fund Management

iFAST Fund Management currently manages 12 authorised retail funds including variable capital company ("VCC") funds ranging from equity, fixed income to enhanced liquidity funds, with total assets under management of S\$1.1 billion as at end 31 Mar 2024. Besides offering its own range of CIS funds, iFAST Fund Management also offers a Fund Management Platform Service providing fund registration and setup, investment management, trade execution and custody service, fund accounting and administration, transfer agency, middle office operations, distribution, compliance and regulatory reporting and financial accounting services, under a seamless one-stop solution to help family offices, fund management companies and financial institutions launch funds under its VCC fund hosting platform.

About iFAST Singapore

iFAST Financial Pte Ltd (iFAST Singapore) is the Singapore subsidiary of SGX-ST Mainboardlisted iFAST Corporation Ltd. (iFAST Corp), which is present in Singapore, Hong Kong, Malaysia China and UK. iFAST Singapore holds the Capital Markets Services licence and the Financial Advisers licence, issued by the Monetary Authority of Singapore, and is also a Central Provident Fund-registered Investment Administrator. iFAST Singapore is also an SGX-ST Trading Member, a CDP Clearing Member and a CDP Depository Agent.

iFAST Singapore's Business-to-Business (B2B) division includes iFAST Central, iFAST Global Prestige and iFAST Pensions, which cater to over 100 financial advisory (FA) firms, financial institutions, banks and multinational companies, as well as iFAST Global Market, which provides investors with transparent adviser-assisted **wealth management** plans. FSMOne.com is the Business-to-Consumer (B2C) division of iFAST Singapore, offering self-directed investors a comprehensive range of investment products and services.

About iFAST Corp

iFAST Corp (stock code: AIY) is a digital banking and **wealth management** platform, with assets under administration (AUA) of S\$21.05 billion as at 31 March 2024.

Incorporated in the year 2000 in Singapore and listed on the SGX-Mainboard in December 2014, the Group is also present in Hong Kong, Malaysia, China, and UK. Through the years, the Group has built a well-established Fintech ecosystem connecting its product providers and clients.

iFAST Corp holds the requisite licences in the various jurisdictions it operates in to provide a wide range of products and services. As at end March 2024, the Group offers access to over 22,500 investment products including over 13,500 funds from over 325 fund houses, over 2,200 bonds, stocks and ETFs listed on the Singapore, Hong Kong, US, Malaysia, UK, and China A stock exchanges, as well as services including **wealth management** solutions, banking services, research and investment seminars, Fintech solutions, pension administration, and investment administration and transaction services.

The main business divisions of the Group include the **Wealth Management** division, the Digital Bank division, and the ePension division. Within the **Wealth Management** division, the Business-to-Consumer ("B2C") platform, FSMOne.com (formerly known as Fundsupermart.com), is a multiproducts transactional platform that caters to investors who prefer to do their own investments online. The Business-to-Business ("B2B") platforms cater to the specialised needs of more than 680 financial advisory companies, financial institutions, banks and internet companies with over 12,800 wealth advisers. The iFAST Global Bank is a full-licensed UK bank that aspires to provide global banking connectivity to customers, corporates and financial institutions. iFAST ePension Services division provides a wide range of pension administration services and white label solutions for pension scheme sponsors, trustees and other institutions, enabling seamless digital access as well as efficient management and processing of pension scheme transactions.

The Group's mission statement is, "To help investors around the world invest globally and profitably".

[Category: Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Financial/ Capital Market, Procurement and Sales]

Source: Standard Chartered

Document ATINBK0020240622ek6d000jq

StanChart Private Bank India's CEO: UHNWs are driving AIF surge

Priyanka Boghani

598 words

13 June 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Standard Chartered India continues to invest in its private banking business, seeing growth opportunities in alternative investment funds (AIFs), driven by its ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) segment.

The Indian private bank manages over \$10bn in assets and has \$58bn in assets under custody. It recently expanded its reach in the country, opening private banking centres in Kolkata and Chennai last year. The firm plans to add more in 2025 as the UHNW population in non-metro locations in the country increases, Pankaj Walia (pictured), the India private banking CEO told Citywire Asia.

The rise of AIFs

The super-rich segment is also spurring the growth of AIFs, which have become an important investment vehicle as clients look to up their alternatives exposure in the hunt for diversification from an increasingly frothy equity market. AIFs are pooled investment products for high-net-worth (HNW) individuals with a minimum ticket size of Rs1 crore (\$162,000).

'We think the AIF industry will grow threefold in the next five years, supported by the consistent growth in UHNW clients and their wealth,' Walia said.

AIFs have already raised around Rs4.3tn, of which Rs3.1tn has been in Category II, which comprises funds that invest in debt and equity, according to data provided by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi).

The investment vehicle has been popular among UHNW clients as it provides an avenue for them to invest in emerging new sectors like technology, healthcare, renewable energy and other innovative sectors, Walia noted. He added AIFs also provide an opportunity to invest internationally.

Several wealth and asset managers launched AIFs last year after there was a change to the taxation of debt mutual funds, effectively removing the tax arbitrage opportunity on the asset class. The change prompted many to turn to AIFs for their promise of higher returns and greater tax efficiency.

For example, Dolat Wealth and Asset Management launched an AIF with the use of a derivatives strategy; 360 One rolled out a fund-of-fund that focuses on private credit; and ASK Private Wealth, Nuvama Private and Sanctum Wealth have all set up real estate investment funds or infrastructure investment trusts.

'Overall, the shift towards AIFs and new investment opportunities reflects a broader trend of UHNW clients in India seeking more sophisticated and diversified investment options to meet their financial goals,' Walia said. Allocation to alternatives on a portfolio level has gone up from 5% to 10% to 20%, depending on client risk levels, the bank said.

Hiring targets

Standard Chartered has typically operated its private bank on its universal bank platform. The retail bank supports it, with its strong network, boosting its new-to-bank clients from tier 2 and non-metro banks.

The bank, which has a legacy of close to 170 years, has been competing with domestic private banks with an established history, as well as newcomers, looking for a slice of India's burgeoning wealth market. It has not been easy growing assets. StanChart's Walia told Citywire Asia last May that it had \$12bn in assets under management (AUM) and \$16bn in assets under custody (AUC) at the time.

He has also been setting hiring goals to increase his bench of bankers. Today, Walia said the bank has 35 private bankers and wants to up this to 40 by the end 2024. Last year, the bank had a stable of 30 private bankers in India and was seeking to add five-to-seven more by the end of 2023.

HSBC China completes key acquisition deal

Liu Zizheng and Liu Zhihua

525 words

12 June 2024

China Daily

CHNDLY

14

English

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Lender acquires Citi's retail wealth biz to further tap Chinese mainland market

HSBC China has completed the acquisition of Citi's retail **wealth management** portfolio in the Chinese mainland, HSBC said on Tuesday.

The portfolio of investment assets and deposits, and associated **wealth management** customers - covering 11 major Chinese cities - has been integrated into HSBC China's Wealth and Personal Banking operations. Over 300 employees have also joined HSBC.

Experts said the move indicates HSBC's intense focus on the promising prospects of the asset management business in China, as well as foreign investors' strengthening confidence in China's real economy.

Zhou Maohua, a researcher at China Everbright Bank, said foreign institutions see great potential in China's financial market because its economy is expected to grow steadily over the long run, and the country has continuously advanced high-standard opening-up in its financial sector.

Zhou said that in recent years, China has accelerated the improvement of its legal system and regulatory requirements, aimed at fostering a world-class business environment.

There also exists ample room for foreign investors to carry out more cross-border investment and financing services, Zhou added.

Dong Ximiao, chief researcher at Merchants Union Consumer Finance, said China has further optimized the allocation of its financial market resources, which has injected impetus into the sector's sustainable development.

In addition, as household incomes in China continue to increase, more opportunities have emerged in the country's **wealth management** market and foreign financial institutions have been provided with broader space for further development, said Dong.

Mark Wang, president and CEO of HSBC China, said the lender has confidence in the growth potential of the China market and has been making substantial investments in the country - particularly into the fast-growing **wealth management** sector.

"Completion of this deal enabled us to further strengthen our competitive edge among foreign banks providing wealth services in the country. Going forward, we will keep supporting our clients both at home and abroad to seize opportunities from connecting China and the world economy, fully leveraging our capabilities in cross-border financial services," Wang said.

Zhou said greater engagement by foreign institutions in the Chinese market could help meet Chinese consumers' diversified needs for financial services.

Zhou added that amid both cooperation and competition with foreign institutions, Chinese financial institutions could also accelerate the enhancement of their operational capacity and efficiency, thus better serving the real economy.

HSBC China and Citi first announced the deal in October, and the latter plans to exit consumer banking businesses across 14 markets, including Asia, Europe and Mexico, as part of its strategic refresh.

Citi has now closed sales in nine of those markets including Australia, India, Indonesia and Malaysia.

Citi's institutional businesses in China are excluded from the sale. Citi said it remains focused on serving institutional clients in China locally, regionally and globally.

As part of a previously signed agreement, Citi will also transfer its remaining credit card portfolio in China to Fubon Bank China later this year.

Contact the writers at liuzizheng@chinadaily.com.cn

Document CHNDLY0020240612ek6c00008

Business Times Breaking News

Banking & Finance

StanChart banks on international ties amid demand for cross-border wealth needs: James Lye

Tan Nai Lun

632 words

5 June 2024

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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INTERNATIONAL banking is increasingly becoming a key driver for Standard Chartered Bank's (SCB) affluent business, as more clients look for wealth offerings outside of their home jurisdictions, said James Lye, SCB's global head of international banking. "Increasingly, (clients' needs and our international corridors) play a part in driving where our growth is," Lye said on Wednesday (Jun 5). SCB's international banking proposition is part of its wider strategy to grow its affluent client business and in the wealth management space.

The affluent client business reported an income of US\$4.6 billion in 2023, from US\$3.7 billion the year before, according to SCB's annual report for 2023.

Client numbers rose to 2.3 million in 2023, from 2.1 million in 2022, which helped drive a 50 per cent rise in net inflows to US\$29 billion.

The lender said it intends to increase the number of international affluent clients to over 375,000 – from 274,000 as at the end of 2023 – by 2026.

This comes as more clients are looking for cross-border offerings, Lye said.

Nearly seven in 10 clients across the markets it surveyed send money internationally, according to RFI Global's international banking report for 2023, commissioned by SCB. The UAE, Indonesia, Malaysia and Singapore topped the list. Some 20 per cent of consumers also hold cross-border banking products, said the report.

The top reasons for cross-border needs were to gain greater returns on investments, to have access to more banking and investment products, and to diversify portfolios.

For SCB, cross-border needs of its clients include relocation, overseas investments, multi-currency payments, funding children's education, buying a second home as an investment, investing in global protection and legacy management.

Lye noted that income from international banking clients has grown two times since 2021, while the number of such clients has also grown two times since 2021 as well. But contributions from international banking go beyond the immediate earnings, as they act as a key proposition to appeal to clients, he said. "A table needs its legs; the legs without a tabletop are just legs. So it becomes a complimentary conversation for all our markets when we go to our clients," Lye said.

"Whatever numbers provided will not be representative of the impact of what (international banking) means to the bank...it is part of the engine that drives overall revenue," he added.

Lye expects to leverage the four wealth hubs – in Jersey, the UAE, Hong Kong and Singapore – to connect the cross-border needs of clients. Jersey connects clients to opportunities in Asia and the Middle East, while the UAE is an offshore centre that serves the global Indian community, he said. Meanwhile, Singapore is a financial hub for Asean and South Asia, while Hong Kong is a gateway to the Greater China region.

The RFI report found that Singapore and Hong Kong are top markets for cross-border outbound flows from Indonesia, Malaysia and India and China.

Some 1 in 3 affluent clients in Indonesia and Malaysia hold banking products in Singapore, while almost half of affluent clients in China hold accounts in Hong Kong.

Noting that several banks also have a similar international approach when it comes to their wealth offerings, Lye said the bank is able to stand out by having a good understanding of the ground, even as it boasts its international links.

"We are almost like a local bank everywhere," Lye said.

"It's not a magic formula that people cannot copy. But having that presence, the history and the relationship with the clients through generations is not so easy to do," he added.

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HSBC to open three Wealth Centres in Singapore by Q1 2025

Distributed by Contify.com

1,150 words

4 June 2024

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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HSBC plans to open three Wealth Centres in Singapore by Q1 2025, doubling technology investments. The bank serves clients across various wealth segments and aims to increase client-facing roles by over a third by 2028. Recent initiatives include legal integration with AXA, launching new insurance plans, and acquiring SilkRoad Property Partners Group. HSBC is focused on enhancing customer experience and becoming the leading **wealth manager** in Asia.

Key Highlights:

- * HSBC serves clients across mass, affluent, high net worth, and ultra-high net worth segments
- * HSBC's international customers accounted for 40% of Wealth and Personal Banking revenue at the Group level in 2023
- * HSBC saw a 76% year-on-year increase in new-to-bank international customers in Singapore in 2023

Original Press Release:

June 4 -- HSBC issued the following news release:

- Increases investment fivefold in physical network, pivoting branches to wealth centres
- Aims to increase client-facing roles by a third by 2028 to sustain growth momentum

HSBC announced its plans today to open three wealth centres in Singapore by Q1 2025, increasing its investment fivefold in its physical network as it pivots its branches into wealth centres to facilitate comprehensive wealth conversations with clients. The three centres will be in the Central Business District as well as the east and west region of Singapore.

Part of a broader strategy to build the Bank's international and wealth propositions, HSBC has doubled its technology investments in Singapore over the last five years, uplifting capabilities and delivering improved customer experiences. Serving clients across the full wealth continuum – mass, affluent, high net worth and ultra-high net worth, HSBC's Wealth and Personal Banking business includes Retail Banking, Global **Private Banking**, HSBC Life and Global Asset Management.

The significant investments underline HSBC's growth ambitions to be the leading **wealth manager** in Asia and reflects the Bank's long-term commitment to Singapore and its position as an international wealth hub.

Wong Kee Joo, CEO of HSBC Singapore said: "Since HSBC established its presence here in 1877, our purpose has always been to connect our customers to opportunities. Our substantial investments have set the stage for future growth, enabling us to better support the needs of our clients. As Singapore grows as an international financial centre and international wealth hub, HSBC is uniquely placed to meet the wealth and international banking needs of our clients through the scale and breadth of our network and capabilities."

Scaling up to capture growth of wealth assets globally

HSBC's international proposition has been an area of growth for the Bank. With presence in over 60 markets globally, HSBC's international customers accounted for 40% of the Wealth and Personal Banking revenue at the Group level in 2023[1]. In Singapore, HSBC saw a 76% year-on-year increase in new-to-bank international

customers in 2023 compared with 2022, supported by the launch of new digital onboarding journeys for accounts and investments[2] and an expanded range of wealth solutions.

The Bank also saw double digit growth in client numbers in Singapore for its mass affluent and high net worth segment from 2019 to 2022, and this rate of growth continued in 2023. To sustain this growth momentum, HSBC plans to increase client-facing roles by more than a third by 2028.

Ashmita Acharya, Head of Wealth and Personal Banking at HSBC Singapore said: “We want to be the **wealth manager** of choice for affluent Singaporeans and international professionals. We’ve been focused on elevating the customer experience across our channels and building a differentiated proposition that supports our client’s wealth, health and international banking needs – from growing and protecting their wealth, to planning for their family, their children’s international education, and the next generation.”

Organic initiatives, selective acquisitions and partnerships to bolster wealth proposition

The bank continues to bolster its proposition through a combination of organic initiatives and selective acquisitions and partnerships:

- * In February 2023, the legal integration of AXA Singapore and HSBC Insurance (Singapore) was completed, positioning HSBC to grow its insurance business in Singapore and expand its customer reach in wealth and health. HSBC Life Singapore recently launched HSBC Life Diamond Prestige IUL, an indexed universal life plan, designed to meet the needs of the affluent segment, offering both life insurance protection and investment.

- * In April 2023, HSBC entered into a 15-year exclusive distribution agreement with MSIG Insurance to provide a comprehensive range of general insurance propositions covering retail and commercial lines to HSBC’s retail and corporate banking clients in Singapore.

- * In January 2024, HSBC Asset Management acquired Singapore’s SilkRoad Property Partners Group to expand its Asia Pacific real estate investment capabilities under its HSBC Alternatives business, adding staff in Singapore, Hong Kong, Shanghai and Japan offices. The acquisition of SilkRoad adds unique expertise - Asia physical commercial real estate -that augments incremental dimensions to the Bank’s overall investment capabilities.

- * Global **Private Banking** enhanced its ultra HNW services to enable institutional Family Offices to have better market access and execution capabilities to meet their wealth transfer, legacy planning and more complex investment needs.

According to the Asian **Private Banker** Asia 2023 league table, HSBC is ranked #1 for wealth continuum in Asia and #2 in **private banking** for Asia, by assets under management.

HSBC services for international customers

The suite of HSBC international products and services will enable international customers to:

- * Open a new account via a digital and frictionless journey before they arrive in their destination
- * See all their HSBC accounts in one global view
- * Make simple, fast and competitively priced payments via Global Money Transfers
- * Use their HSBC credit history from their previous country to apply for a credit card in their new country with HSBC (subject to local regulations, Premier status and applicable channels)
- * Manage their banking needs in different time zones across multiple countries with global support
- * Access services with global partners beyond banking (tax solutions, relocation support and more)

For more information please visit: <https://internationalservices.hsbc.com/>

HSBC Singapore

HSBC opened its first branch in Singapore in 1877. A qualifying full bank serving international needs of individual, corporate and institutional clients, HSBC in Singapore offers a comprehensive range of banking and financial services including retail banking and **wealth management**; commercial, investment and **private banking**;

insurance; forfaiting and trustee services; securities and capital markets services. HSBC was recognised by Asiamoney as "Best International Bank in Singapore" in 2022 and 2023.

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 62 countries and territories. With assets of \$3,001bn at 31 March 2024, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

Footnotes:

[1] HSBC Annual Report 2023.

Source: HSBC

[Category: Banks, Retail/ Commercial Bank, Business Expansion]

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Business

HSBC courting more private bankers amid Middle East wealth push

411 words

31 May 2024

The Straits Times

STIMES

English

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Dubai HSBC Holdings is courting private bankers as it seeks to expand its business of catering to the growing number of millionaires and billionaires moving to the Middle East.

The British lender already added 100 bankers in 2023 and is looking to hire "opportunistically" in the energy-rich region in the coming months, according to Mr Aladdin Hangari, who joined HSBC to lead its private banking business for the Middle East and North Africa in 2023.

The moves should help his unit boost client assets by around 60 per cent in the next five years, Mr Hangari said. The division is the largest contributor to HSBC's Swiss private banking entity, which currently manages US\$85 billion (S\$115 billion) in client assets.

"We are in all the key markets and we have a strong business," Mr Hangari said in an interview. "There's a lot more we can do with existing clients, and there's more we can do in terms of attracting new clients."

HSBC is known for its wealth prowess across Asia, but it has long lagged Swiss rivals like UBS Group in the Middle East.

Mr Hangari brings some of that know-how to HSBC after spending 20 years at Credit Suisse, where he was one of the top wealth management executives for Qatar and the key relationship manager for the Qatari royal family.

HSBC added several other key hires from Credit Suisse in 2023, including bankers that will expand the lender's coverage in countries including Qatar, Kuwait and Saudi Arabia.

"There is definitely a strong demand for talent and especially the top performers," Mr Hangari said. "There is an opportunity for us to grow everywhere, but obviously Saudi is going to always be a key market for all the private banks due to its sheer size, along with the United Arab Emirates, Kuwait and Qatar."

HSBC is betting that its strong operations in Asia will help it win more business with wealthy investors in the Gulf. The two regions have sought to deepen their ties in recent years and China's President Xi Jinping is meeting Arab leaders this week to discuss trade.

"We see definitely a lot of interest both in terms of investments from the Middle East into Asia and Asia into the Middle East," Mr Hangari said. "We want to be in the middle of these investment flows and trade flows."

BLOOMBERG

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Straits Times Breaking News

Business

HSBC making Middle East wealth push after hiring 100 bankers

450 words

30 May 2024

The Straits Times

STIMES

English

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Along with Mr Hangari, HSBC added several other key hires from Credit Suisse in 2023, including bankers that will expand the lender's coverage in countries including Qatar, Kuwait and Saudi Arabia.

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BLOOMBERG More On This Topic Citi, HSBC order more US staff to work in offices 5 days a week HSBC chairman says Asia business spin-off 'will not happen'

Document STIMES0020240530ek5u000gp



Business

HSBC targets lending against fast-growing private assets after adding SVB's UK unit to its portfolio

Aileen Chuang

699 words

30 May 2024

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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* HSBC to leverage its balance sheet strength to finance wealthy clients' fast-growing private asset portfolios

* 'Hong Kong has become an important hub in Asia and globally for private markets' says HSBC **private bank's** APAC credit advisory head Jyrki Rauhio

HSBC sees opportunities to lend against wealthy clients' private assets, following its acquisition of the UK unit of Silicon Valley Bank (SVB), in a move that leverages its balance sheet strength to finance this fast-growing market.

HSBC, the largest bank in Hong Kong and Europe, is "responding to the evolution in the asset markets", where private or alternative assets have grown tremendously, said Jyrki Rauhio, head of credit advisory for Asia-Pacific at HSBC Global **Private Banking**.

[SVB's UK unit, which was acquired](#) just over a year ago and rebranded HSBC Innovation Banking, could pave the way for more business opportunities in private markets, he added.

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"The rise of the private markets poses a challenge and an opportunity for wealth managers and **private banks** worldwide to respond to it because, traditionally, **private banks** have been focusing on public markets and operating more like stockbrokers," Rauhio said.

As wealthy individuals increasingly invest in private assets, which are often illiquid, they require financing services to free up liquidity.

"Usually, **[private] banks** lend against stocks, bonds, and some mutual funds, but they do not necessarily lend against alternative funds like we do," Rauhio said. "We can leverage our strong balance sheet and superior in-house expertise on these private funds."

Rauhio added the Innovation Banking unit brings "additional knowledge, access and opportunity", especially in the venture space. Before its collapse, SVB was the go-to bank for Silicon Valley start-ups since the 1980s and had access to funds in Asia and globally.

Rauhio said the universe of funds the bank lends against is expanding, while it offers loans against most alternative assets and tailored financing for clients with slightly more exotic portfolios. The bank also provides "GP financing" for private fund managers, or general partners, to help them finance their commitments to their funds and smooth their cash flows.

Traditionally, people have not raised funding against their alternative assets because of a lack of banking solutions, Rauhio said. But the situation has changed with the rise in interest rates and private asset owners being less sensitive to the cost of funding against the [higher-yield alternative assets](#), he added.

"That is why funding against alternatives is still very attractive, because you are typically paying single digits and typically yielding double digits," he said.

Global private equity assets under management (AUM) have increased 22 per cent annually over the last five years, reaching US\$8.2 trillion as of June 2023, according to McKinsey & Co.

Individual investors in Asia-Pacific are increasing their capital commitments to private equity funds, expecting a growth of 26 per cent by 2025 and outpacing all the other markets, according to an estimate by Boston Consulting Group in 2021.

"Hong Kong has become an important hub in Asia and globally for private markets given the number of fund managers specialising in private assets based here," Rauhio said.

The city is Asia's largest hedge fund centre and the second-largest private equity hub after mainland China, according to government statistics, which shows that more than 250 open-ended fund companies and 780 limited partnership funds are registered in Hong Kong.

"Because of our large client base in places like Hong Kong, we are an attractive partner for some of the biggest funds that want to raise money from individuals and family offices," Rauhio said.

"The opportunity is not only for a wider client base that wants to invest in this asset class, but also for managers who have been running these fund management companies, who have become very wealthy individuals and have their own financial needs."

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Front Page Business

DBS expands HK private banking headcount by 25% on better flows

248 words

30 May 2024

The Straits Times

STIMES

English

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DBS Group Holdings is hiring more private bankers in Hong Kong, where the bank is increasingly attracting money from both mainland China and Taiwan, North Asia business head Sebastian Paredes said.

The number of clients acquired from mainland China has totalled close to 1,200 so far in 2024, Mr Paredes said in an interview on Bloomberg TV.

The bank has seen "substantial" flows from Taiwan in the past 12 months, he said, without elaborating.

"We continue to hire," said Mr Paredes, who is also chairman of the bank's China unit. "This year, for example, we are expanding more than 25 per cent our headcount in private banking business alone."

Singapore's biggest lender is moving in as some of the older international banks in Hong Kong scale back.

DBS replaced Credit Suisse as the third-largest private bank in Asia, excluding onshore China, in 2023, with some US\$201 billion (S\$271 billion) assets under management, according to Asian Private Banker.

Total headcount of relationship managers grew 12 per cent to 730 in 2023 from a year earlier and topped HSBC, according to the publication.

Mr Paredes praised the Hong Kong government's efforts in promoting the city's status as a tourism and entertainment hub for Chinese mainlanders.

Still, he warned the city is facing competition in tourism from countries such as Japan, where the cheap yen has diverted tourist attention. BLOOMBERG

Document STIMES0020240530ek5u000kf



Business

HSBC eyes synergies in wealth management, family office business amid robust profit growth in Asia

Enoch Yiu

578 words

27 May 2024

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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* The UK lender aims to boost synergies through talent exchanges and client referrals in both cities in the coming years

* Pre-tax profit from HSBC's wealth management unit in Asia surged 51 per cent last year, according to its financial report

HSBC aims to strengthen the ties between its Hong Kong and Singapore wealth management teams to enhance cross-selling and sharpen their focus on winning more high-net-worth clients and family offices, senior executives said.

While both Asian financial hubs compete on many fronts, the UK lender is seeking to boost synergies through talent exchanges and client referrals in the coming years, said Maggie Ng, head of wealth and personal banking operations in Hong Kong.

"Our ambition is to grow beyond just our domestic markets," she said in an interview. "Many of our customers like to set up family offices in both Hong Kong and Singapore" as they see both cities as complementary rather than competitors, she added.

Do you have questions about the biggest topics and trends from around the world? Get the answers with [SCMP Knowledge](#), our new platform of curated content with explainers, FAQs, analyses and infographics brought to you by our award-winning team.

Hong Kong is keen to bolster its status by attracting the world's wealthiest families, and dangled several tax and long-term residency incentives earlier this year to pursue its goals. The city had 2,703 single-family offices at the end of 2023, managing US\$10 million to US\$100 million of assets, a study showed.

HSBC is keen to help its super-rich clients manage their family investment, succession planning and philanthropic endeavours, emphasising the bank's commitment to the business. Pre-tax profit from its wealth management unit in Asia surged 51 per cent last year, according to its financial report.

HSBC's global private banking unit discontinued its Independent Asset Management (IAM) channel in Hong Kong and Singapore last month, after creating the desk in December 2020 to serve family offices. The move was only to streamline its personnel and resources, Ng said.

"Our focus is to grow the ultra high-net-worth family office segment," she added. Instead of the IAM channel, HSBC is using its relationship managers to serve the family offices, she said, adding that its strong brand can help boost its trust and investment services.

Total assets under management in Hong Kong stood at US\$3.9 trillion in 2022, with 64 per cent of the funding coming from investors outside Hong Kong, according to government statistics. In Singapore, some 76 per cent of the US\$3.7 trillion of assets under management are from offshore funds.

Kai Zhang, HSBC's Singapore-based head of wealth and personal banking for South Asia, said investors have continued to favour both financial hubs as a gateway to opportunities in mainland China and Asia-Pacific markets.

"International investors like to invest in Asia because of the demographic dividends [such as] a young population, rising middle class and wealth in the region," she said. "They are key to the growth story of HSBC in South Asia."

Zhang and her team members look after the wealth and insurance markets covering Southeast Asia, India, Taiwan and Australia. It has logged double-digit growth in new international customers over the last few years and expect the trend to continue.

Document SCMCOM0020240527ek5r0002w



Business

HSBC to boost ties between wealth teams

Enoch Yiu

412 words

27 May 2024

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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HK-Singapore synergy set to be strengthened with talent exchanges and client referrals

HSBC aims to strengthen the ties between its Hong Kong and Singapore wealth management teams to enhance cross-selling and sharpen their focus on winning more high-net-worth clients and **family offices**, according to senior executives.

While both Asian financial hubs competed on many fronts, the British lender was seeking to boost synergies through talent exchanges and client referrals in the coming years, said Maggie Ng, head of wealth and personal banking in Hong Kong.

"Our ambition is to grow beyond just our domestic markets," she said in an interview.

"Many of our customers like to set up **family offices** in both Hong Kong and Singapore" as they saw both cities as complementary with each other rather than competitors, she said.

Hong Kong is keen to bolster its status by attracting the world's wealthiest families, dangling various tax and long-term residency incentives earlier this year to pursue its goals. The city had 2,703 single-**family offices** at the end of last year, managing US\$10 million to US\$100 million of assets, a study showed.

HSBC seeks to help its super-rich clients manage their family investment, succession planning and philanthropic endeavours, emphasising the bank's commitment to the business. Pre-tax profit from its wealth management unit in Asia saw double-digit growth last year, according to Ng.

The group's global private banking unit discontinued its independent asset management channel in Hong Kong and Singapore last month after creating the desk in December 2020 to serve **family offices**. The move was aimed to streamline its personnel and resources, Ng said.

"Our focus is to grow the ultra-high-net-worth **family office** segment," she said, adding the bank was using its relationship managers, instead of the independent asset management channel, to serve **family offices**.

Total assets under management in Hong Kong stood at US\$3.9 trillion in 2022, with 64 per cent from investors outside the city, according to government statistics. In Singapore, some 76 per cent of the US\$3.7 trillion of assets under management are from offshore funds.

Kai Zhang, HSBC's Singapore-based head of wealth and personal banking for South Asia, said investors had continued to favour both financial hubs as a gateway to opportunities in the mainland and Asia-Pacific markets.

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Business

Bank of Singapore bolsters HK family office business

Enoch Yiu

533 words

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SCMP

B1

English

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CEO is bullish about city's future as bank raises headcount with a focus on the region and Dubai

Bank of Singapore, the private banking unit of Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp (OCBC), is expanding its family office business in Hong Kong, as it is bullish about its growth prospects in the city and mainland China.

It had increased its headcount, mainly relationship managers and senior bankers, by 15 per cent in mainland China, Hong Kong, Macau and Taiwan in the first four months of this year, CEO Jason Moo said. Assets under its management in these markets had risen by 10 per cent between 2021 and 2023, he added.

"We have hired more bankers here as we have ambitious plans to grow in Hong Kong," he said in an interview, citing the ongoing stock market rally as a factor.

Apart from its home base of Singapore, Hong Kong and Dubai are the two other cities targeted for expansion, he added, noting these three cities were where "we will focus the most in the coming years".

Bank of Singapore in February hired Rickie Chan, the former CEO of Credit Suisse Hong Kong, to head its Hong Kong operation.

The bank is also keen to expand its family office business in these markets, citing the growing needs of wealthy families to help set up such offices to invest their wealth, plan succession and manage charities.

"We want to help families set up individual family offices and, at the same time, we would also like to provide an external investment services platform for multifamily offices," Moo said.

The Hong Kong and Singapore governments offer a range of incentives, such as tax cuts and investment migration schemes, as they compete to lure wealthy families to set up offices.

However, the demand from family offices for such services was so big that both markets could thrive, Moo said, adding that the recent stock rally had drawn the attention of clients who wanted to invest in the Hong Kong and mainland markets.

Hong Kong's benchmark Hang Seng Index has gained more than 16 per cent since the China Securities Regulatory Commission, the mainland's securities watchdog, last month unveiled five measures to support the city's capital market and enhance cross-border trading.

"Some clients have started dipping their toes again in the market, buying stocks in Hong Kong and mainland China," Moo said, suggesting that investors keep an eye on companies in the artificial intelligence sector.

Moo is targeting a combined headcount of 500 relationship managers in Hong Kong, Singapore and Dubai by the end of 2025, from 450 now.

Bank of Singapore expects to leverage the three cities' strengths in its expansion: Singapore's closeness to Asean and India, Hong Kong as the gateway to the Greater Bay Area and mainland China, and Dubai as the stepping stone into the Middle East.

"Previously, only a few international private bank clients put their assets in Asia as part of their diversification strategy," Moo said.

"Now, investing in Asia and the Middle East is part of their strategy to achieve high growth."

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DBS Private Bank upbeat on Hong Kong NRI desk

Priyanka Boghani

504 words

15 May 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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DBS Private Bank is seeing an increasing need for its non-resident Indian (NRI) desk in Hong Kong and its onshore India presence Vikas Jaidka, the bank's head of Middle East, Africa and NRI said.

Several private bankers have relocated from Singapore to Hong Kong, owing largely to a reportedly diminishing NRI community in Hong Kong, particularly after the Covid-19 pandemic. This has prompted private banks to rethink their NRI desks in Hong Kong, with many of the bigger banks covering the segment from Singapore.

However, DBS Private Bank's Jaidka said that there remains a 'sizeable NRI community' in Hong Kong, the Greater Bay area and the Philippines.

'Our NRI Hong Kong desk is fully equipped to serve our clients, who are business owners themselves in these locations and going beyond wealth management services to include corporate banking,' Jaidka said.

He said NRI clients, like many of the Singaporean private bank's wider clients, are looking for more personalised, holistic financial planning services and cross-border wealth management solutions, with more families having members living in different countries.

The interest in bespoke private market investment options from larger families has also increased.

Jaidka said one of the biggest differentiators of DBS's NRI desk is its use of data analytics, artificial intelligence and machine learning to serve its ultra-high-net-worth clients. He added that nine out of 10 of the bank's clients use its digibank wealth app to monitor and transact from their portfolios.

The Singaporean bank has been an early adopter of technology. It has invested in AI and machine learning to help its data cleaning process and to help relationship managers with real-time data and analytics.

'They [NRI clients] are sophisticated and tech-savvy and require digital platforms that allow them to monitor and trade on their portfolios anytime, anywhere,' he said.

The bank has also increased engagement with clients from both portfolio advisory and wealth planning perspectives, Jaidka said. Through curated research recommendations and insights, the NRI bankers are driving around 30% more clients to take up legacy planning solutions.

Onshore opportunity

Jaidka said the bank's amalgamation with Lakshmi Vilas Bank (LVB) completed in November 2020, signals that it is serious about service. Through the deal, customers can access a wider range of products and services, including the full suite of DBS digital banking services.

'India is one of our key markets and post our amalgamation with Lakshmi Vilas Bank some years ago, we are now well-positioned to service burgeoning demand by offering a full spectrum of onshore retail, wealth and corporate banking services,' Jaidka said.

The Singaporean bank competes with a string of foreign rivals, including Julius Baer, HSBC Global Private Banking, Standard Chartered Private Bank, Deutsche Bank Private Bank and LGT, as well as established local outfits.

DBS also recently launched Treasures Private Client in India which provides bespoke wealth management solutions and lifestyle benefits for its onshore clients.

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Front Page

DBS, UOB, OCBC's Q1 outperformance lifts optimism for 2024 profits

Tan Nai

942 words

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STBT

English

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THE chief executives of the three local banks -- DBS, UOB and OCBC -- were noticeably more optimistic at their respective earnings briefings for the first quarter ended March, after the lenders posted better-than-expected results.

While market volatility and geopolitical uncertainties remain, the banks' Q1 performance lifted their outlook for the rest of 2024. Higher-for-longer interest rates also contributed to the optimism about net interest incomes.

DBS' Q1 net profit rose 15 per cent to S\$2.95 billion, beating the S\$2.5 billion consensus forecast in a Bloomberg survey of five analysts. UOB's earnings dipped 1.6 per cent to S\$1.49 billion, but was ahead of the mean estimate of S\$1.43 billion from three analysts polled by LSEG. OCBC's net gain rose 5 per cent to a quarterly high of S\$1.98 billion, surpassing the S\$1.85 billion consensus forecast in a Bloomberg survey of three analysts.

The banks dialled back on rate cut expectations for the year.

DBS CEO Piyush Gupta and OCBC CEO Helen Wong expect two cuts in 2024, compared with their initial forecasts of five and three cuts, respectively. UOB CEO Wee Ee Cheong also expects fewer rate cuts ahead.

Against this backdrop, analysts said the key areas to watch are higher-for-longer rates and the **wealth management** segment. Thilan Wickramasinghe, head of Singapore research at Maybank Securities, said higher-for-longer interest rates should keep net interest margins (NIMs) -- which came in better than expected in Q1 -- well-supported.

DBS' NIM was up slightly at 2.14 per cent, from 2.13 per cent a quarter earlier, supported by fixed asset repricing. UOB's NIM was unchanged from the previous quarter at 2.02 per cent, as active management of excess liquidity had buffered lower loan margins.

Meanwhile, OCBC's NIM fell two basis points on quarter to 2.27 per cent, as higher asset yields outpaced the rise in funding costs.

Fee income beat expectations

The banks also posted strong fee income in the quarter, boosted by their **wealth management** segments.

Q1 net fee income for DBS was up 23 per cent on year at S\$1.04 billion. **Wealth management** fees rose 47 per cent to S\$536 million, amid a stronger market sentiment and an expanded asset under management (AUM) base.

DBS' consistent AUM inflow for the past two years and into Q1 should give significant dry powder for further wealth growth, said Wickramasinghe.

UOB's net fee income was also up, at 5.1 per cent to S\$580 million, buoyed by a stronger showing in loan-related fees and the wealth segment.

The lender is looking to move clients towards higher-fee wealth products from fixed deposits, which bodes well for further growth in this segment, said Wickramasinghe. He added that **wealth management** appears to be a bright spot for DBS and UOB.

As for OCBC, fee income rose 6 per cent to S\$479 million amid growth in **wealth management** fees, driven by increased customer activities.

Citi analyst Tan Yong Hong noted that the bank reversed three successive quarters of AUM decline -- its AUM rose 1 per cent to S\$273 billion, while net new money for the quarter was around S\$6 billion.

He said OCBC's results were largely driven by trading income, which was up 45 per cent to S\$370 million on the back of record customer flow income and improved non-customer flow income.

Despite the lender's good performance, the market appeared more positive about its announcement to privatise its insurance arm, Great Eastern, Tan added.

OCBC on Friday said it planned to acquire the remaining 11.56 per cent of Great Eastern that it does not own, with the aim of delisting the insurer.

Nevertheless, Tan expects the possible benefits of acquiring all the shares to have already been priced in.

Better targets

On the back of a strong first quarter, the lenders have raised their forecasts for their 2024 performance.

DBS' Gupta expects group net interest income to be modestly better than 2023 levels, and guided for commercial book non-interest income growth to be in the mid- to high-teens in terms of percentage.

As a result, total income could be one or two percentage points higher than the bank's previous guidance of a mid-single digit, he said.

With DBS' strong capital levels, Maybank's Wickramasinghe also expects the lender will have potential to pay more dividends ahead.

As DBS is likely to accrue more capital than it pays out, there will likely be further capital management actions including potential special dividends, he said.

Meanwhile, UOB maintained its 2024 guidance of positive growth in total income, amid a low single-digit loan growth and double-digit fee growth.

But Citi's Tan noted that UOB's Q1 results summarised stable NIM, cost discipline and asset quality, which should improve overall investor sentiments on the stock.

Tan is focusing on NIM upside for UOB, as a result of funding cost management, as well as cost discipline after the lender completes the integration of Citi's Thailand retail portfolio.

As for OCBC, Wong expects 2024's NIMs to reach the higher end of its 2.2 to 2.5 per cent target range, while return on equity will also likely be at the higher end of its 13 to 14 per cent target.

Tan noted that OCBC has lowered its NIM's sensitivity to interest rate changes, while its loan growth guidance was also kept conservatively lower.

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Singapore - Banks - Competitive Landscape

3,280 words

10 May 2024

MarketLine Industry Profiles

DMRP

English

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The Singaporean banks industry consists of four top performers: DBS Group, Oversea-Chinese Banking (OCBC), Standard Chartered Bank Singapore (SCBS), and United Overseas Bank (UOB). All the main players are based in Singapore, indicating the strong presence of Singaporean banks in the industry. There is not much differentiation in the industry, as all the main players offer similar financial products to consumers and operate with similar strategies. The only way a player could get a competitive edge over their peers is if that player was involved in a government project or financed a low-risk endeavor. Most of the industry players are periodically financing their activities in the form of bonds, issuing equity to investors, or acquiring different kinds of companies in several industries and markets.

Who are the leading players?

DBS Group Holdings Ltd (DBS)

DBS, through its principal subsidiary, DBS Bank, is the largest bank in Singapore, with a market share of 37.2% in 2023. The bank is based in Singapore and offers consumer, corporate, and SME banking and other financial solutions. It also provides cash management, **wealth management**, and capital markets solutions. DBS classifies its operations into four segments: Institutional Banking, Consumer Banking/ **Wealth Management**, Treasury Markets, and Others. As of December 2023, the bank served 17.9 million consumer banking and **wealth management** customers. In FY2023, the bank reported total assets of \$485.8 billion.

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd (OCBC)

OCBC is the second-largest bank in Singapore with a market share of 26.2% in 2023. The bank is based in Singapore and is a provider of consumer, corporate, investment, private, and transaction banking, as well as global treasury and stockbroking services. It also carries out insurance and asset management business activities through its subsidiaries. OCBC classifies its operations into five segments: global consumer and **private banking** (GCPB), global wholesale banking (GWB), insurance, global Treasury and markets (GTM), and others. As of December 2023, OCBC operated through more than 420 branches and representative offices in 19 countries and territories, including 32 branches in Singapore and more than 190 branches in Indonesia through a subsidiary, Bank OCBC NISP, with over 60 branches in Mainland China, Macau, and Hong Kong under OCBC Wing Hang. In FY2023, the bank reported total assets of \$343.0 billion.

United Overseas Bank Ltd (UOB)

UOB is the third-largest bank in Singapore with a market share of 24.0% in 2023. The bank is based in Singapore and provides personal, commercial, business, private, and investment banking solutions. It also offers corporate finance, asset management, insurance, treasury, capital markets, venture capital management, and stock broking services. UOB classifies its operations into four segments: Group Retail (GR), Group Wholesale Banking (GWB), Others, and Global Markets (GM). As of December 2023, it had a network of over 500 branches and offices, and more than 1.1 million ATMs in 19 countries and territories in Europe, North America, and the Asia Pacific. In FY2023, the bank reported total assets of \$314.2 billion.

Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Ltd, (SCBS)

SCBS, a subsidiary of Standard Chartered, is the fourth-largest bank in Singapore with a 7.9% in 2023 market share. The bank is based in Singapore and is an international banking group, which provides personal, business, private, SME, wholesale, Islamic, online, and investment banking services to personal and business customers globally. Standard Chartered classifies its business operations into four segments: Corporate, Commercial & Institutional Banking, Consumer Private & Business Banking, Central & other items, and Ventures. As of

December 31, 2023, it operated in 52 markets. It served 11.8 million individuals and 226,000 business and banking clients. In FY2023, the bank reported total assets of \$102.7 billion.

What are the strategies of the leading players?

OCBC is taking up various strategic initiatives to develop and expand its business. To this end, in April 2024, OCBC Securities and Lion Global Investors collaborated to launch the exchange-traded fund tracking the performance of Asia-Pacific financial services companies. In November 2023, OCBC Singapore offered its customers the option to lock funds in their existing OCBC bank accounts. In August 2023, the bank announced a collaboration with UnionPay QR. This initiative helps bank customers to use their OCBC Digital app to make retail payments to UnionPay QR-enabled merchants in 47 markets from their OCBC Singapore bank accounts. In July 2023, the bank announced the expansion of its partnership with Ascenda to improve the latter's premium rewards offerings. This partnership enables the bank to improve OCBC's credit card options, advancing the initiative to increase significant worth client acquisition and involvement.

UOB group is taking various strategic initiatives to acquire new customers, which will drive its business growth. In April 2023, UOB and Lazada Group entered MOU to collaborate on retail products and banking solutions in five key markets, such as Indonesia, Thailand, Singapore, Malaysia, and Vietnam. This partnership will increase access to financing for e-commerce sellers on the Lazada platform. In the same month the bank plans to invest more than \$368 million to build its new global technology and innovation centre in JTC's Punggol Digital District (PDD). This investment enables the group to establish its presence in Singapore as first smart and sustainable business district.

What have been the recent M&A activities?

In February 2024, Singapore-based fintech start-up Xalts has acquired Contour Network, a digital trade finance platform launched in 2020 by leading banks like ANZ, BNP Paribas, HSBC, and Standard Chartered. Contour was comprised of 21 banks and various partners from various industries. Xalts plans to focus on embedded trade and supply chain finance solutions, enabling banks, logistics, and technology companies to offer integrated solutions on one platform. The acquisition follows Contour's suspension of operations in October 2023 due to insufficient funding.

In June 2023, Japan's Orient (Orico) has invested in Singapore's Honest Financial Technologies International, aiming to expand its reach to Indonesian credit card customers and promote new businesses using advanced technology and services. Orico's subsidiary, Orico Balimor Finance, operates auto loans in Indonesia, and Honest is considering mutual customer transfer using their customer bases, digital technology, and financial services. The investment aims to secure Orico's reach and encourage the creation of new businesses using advanced technology and services.

This section contains brief overviews of the leading companies in the Singaporean banks industry.

Company

Company Name: DBS Group Holdings Ltd

DBS Group Holdings Ltd (DBS), through its principal subsidiary, DBS Bank Ltd (DBS Bank), offers a range of banking and financial solutions that include current, savings, multi-currency, and business accounts; debit and credit cards; fixed deposits; and loans for home, personal, business, car, education, working capital, and business property purchase. DBS offers supply chain, equipment, secured lending, and venture debt-financing solutions. It provides insurance coverage for life, health, travel, car, accident, education, and business. The company also offers **wealth management**, treasury products, cash management, trade finance, **private banking**, institutional banking, online banking, and advisory and capital markets solutions. Its priority markets are India, China, Taiwan, Indonesia, Singapore, and Hong Kong. DBS is headquartered in Singapore City, Singapore.

The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD27,862 million for the fiscal year ended December 2023 (FY2023), an increase of 74.9% over FY2022. In FY2023, the bank's operating margin was 51.3%, compared to an operating margin of 54.1% in FY2022. In FY2023, the bank recorded a net margin of 27.5%, compared to a net margin of 36.7% in FY2022.

Head office: 12 Marina Boulevard Marina Bay Financial Centre Tower 3, Singapore, Singapore

Telephone: 6568788888

Fax: 6564451267

Number of Employees: 40000

Website: www.dbs.com/investors/fixed-income/overview

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: D05

Stock Exchange: Singapore Exchange Securities Trading

Company Overview

DBS Group Holdings Ltd (DBS), through its principal subsidiary, DBS Bank Ltd (DBS Bank), offers a range of banking and financial solutions that include current, savings, multi-currency, and business accounts; debit and credit cards; fixed deposits; and loans for home, personal, business, car, education, working capital, and business property purchase. DBS offers supply chain, equipment, secured lending, and venture debt-financing solutions. It provides insurance coverage for life, health, travel, car, accident, education, and business. The company also offers **wealth management**, treasury products, cash management, trade finance, **private banking**, institutional banking, online banking, and advisory and capital markets solutions. Its priority markets are India, China, Taiwan, Indonesia, Singapore, and Hong Kong. DBS is headquartered in Singapore City, Singapore. The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD27,862 million for the fiscal year ended December 2023 (FY2023), an increase of 74.9% over FY2022. In FY2023, the bank's operating margin was 51.3%, compared to an operating margin of 54.1% in FY2022. In FY2023, the bank recorded a net margin of 27.5%, compared to a net margin of 36.7% in FY2022.

Business Description

DBS Group Holdings Ltd (DBS) offers consumer, corporate, and SME banking, and other financial solutions. It also provides cash management, **wealth management**, and capital markets solutions.

As of December 31, 2022, it had assets of SGD743.4 billion, deposits of SGD566.7 billion, and loans and advances to customers of SGD414 billion.

DBS classifies its operations into four segments: Institutional Banking, Consumer Banking/ **Wealth Management**, Treasury Markets, and Others.

Company

Company Name: Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd (OCBC) is a provider of an array of retail and commercial banking, **wealth management**, insurance, and other financial solutions to individual customers, government agencies, financial institutions, and corporate and SMEs. Its portfolio of offerings include deposit services, card products, personal and home loans, business purchase loans, and commercial property and working capital loans. The company's major services consist of trade and treasury, corporate escrow, and cash management. OCBC provides insurance covers for home, property, mortgage, travel, car, life, and retirement. OCBC offers investment banking, investment solutions, and **wealth management**. It operates through branches and representative offices in Asia, North America, Europe, Oceania, and the Middle East. OCBC is headquartered in Singapore City, Singapore.

The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD20,867 million for the fiscal year ended December 2023 (FY2023), an increase of 80% over FY2022. In FY2023, the bank's operating margin was 42.7%, compared to an operating margin of 94.1% in FY2022. In FY2023, the bank recorded a net margin of 22.7%, compared to a net margin of 50.3% in FY2022.

Head office: 65 Chulia Street #01-00, Ocbc Centre, , Singapore, Singapore

Telephone: 6565301513

Fax: 6565304438

Number of Employees: 32675

Website: www.ocbc.com

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: O39

Stock Exchange: Singapore Exchange Securities Trading

Company Overview

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd (OCBC) is a provider of an array of retail and commercial banking, **wealth management**, insurance, and other financial solutions to individual customers, government agencies, financial institutions, and corporate and SMEs. Its portfolio of offerings include deposit services, card products, personal and home loans, business purchase loans, and commercial property and working capital loans. The company's major services consist of trade and treasury, corporate escrow, and cash management. OCBC provides insurance covers for home, property, mortgage, travel, car, life, and retirement. OCBC offers investment banking, investment solutions, and **wealth management**. It operates through branches and representative offices in Asia, North America, Europe, Oceania, and the Middle East. OCBC is headquartered in Singapore City, Singapore. The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD20,867 million for the fiscal year ended December 2023 (FY2023), an increase of 80% over FY2022. In FY2023, the bank's operating margin was 42.7%, compared to an operating margin of 94.1% in FY2022. In FY2023, the bank recorded a net margin of 22.7%, compared to a net margin of 50.3% in FY2022.

Business Description

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd (OCBC), along with its subsidiaries, is a provider of consumer, corporate, investment, private, and transaction banking; and global treasury and stockbroking services. It also carries out insurance and asset management business activities through its subsidiaries. As of December 31, 2022, it had assets of SGD559,956 million, net loans SGD291,467 million, and deposits of SGD360,127 million.

OCBC classifies its operations into five segments: Global Consumer and **Private Banking** (GCPB), Global Wholesale Banking (GWB), Insurance, Global Treasury and Markets (GTM), and Others.

As of December 31, 2022, OCBC operated through more than 420 branches and representative offices in 19 countries and territories, including more than 190 branches in Indonesia through a subsidiary, Bank OCBC NISP; over 60 branches in Mainland China, Macau, and Hong Kong under OCBC Wing Hang.

OCBC also has a presence in Brunei, Myanmar, the Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, the US, Indonesia, Australia, the UK, the UAE, and Luxembourg.

Company

Company Name: Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Ltd

Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Ltd, (SCBS) a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC, is a financial services provider that offers banking services. The bank provides deposit-taking, **wealth management** services, overdrafts, credit cards, auto financing, personal loans, mortgages and others. SCBS offers trade finance, lending, foreign exchange, cash management, securities services, debt capital markets and corporate finance to corporate and institutional clients. The bank also provides **private banking** services through its **private banking** division. SCBS offers online banking and transfer services. The bank serves corporate and retail customers, individuals, and small and medium-sized enterprises. SCBS operates through a network of branches, banking centers and ATM centers. SCBS is headquartered in Singapore City, Singapore.

Head office: 9 Changi Business Park Cres #05-01 Singapore City, Singapore

Website: www.sc.com/sq

Financial Year End: December

Company Overview

Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Ltd, (SCBS) a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC, is a financial services provider that offers banking services. The bank provides deposit-taking, **wealth management** services, overdrafts, credit cards, auto financing, personal loans, mortgages and others. SCBS offers trade finance,

lending, foreign exchange, cash management, securities services, debt capital markets and corporate finance to corporate and institutional clients. The bank also provides **private banking** services through its **private banking** division. SCBS offers online banking and transfer services. The bank serves corporate and retail customers, individuals, and small and medium-sized enterprises. SCBS operates through a network of branches, banking centers and ATM centers. SCBS is headquartered in Singapore City, Singapore.

Company

Company Name: United Overseas Bank Ltd

United Overseas Bank Ltd (UOB) provides a range of financial solutions that includes deposit accounts, loans, payment and travel cards, and insurance. The group offers trade finance, corporate finance, financial supply chain management, savings bonds, cash management, treasury management, and debt and equity capital market solutions. UOB provides various other services such as asset management, **wealth management**, venture management, advisory, **private banking**, transaction banking, mobile banking, online banking, and internet banking services. The group also offers travel management, futures broking, stockbroking, portfolio management, and property management services. The group operates in Asia-Pacific, Europe, and North America. UOB is headquartered in Singapore.

The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD22,242 million for the fiscal year ended December 2023 (FY2023), an increase of 72.9% over FY2022. In FY2023, the bank's operating margin was 46.9%, compared to an operating margin of 49.6% in FY2022. In FY2023, the bank recorded a net margin of 21%, compared to a net margin of 28.2% in FY2022.

Head office: 80 Raffles Place Uob Plaza, , Singapore, Singapore

Telephone: 6562222121

Fax: 6565342334

Number of Employees: 30306

Website: www.uobgroup.com

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: U11

Stock Exchange: Singapore Exchange Securities Trading

Company Overview

United Overseas Bank Ltd (UOB) provides a range of financial solutions that includes deposit accounts, loans, payment and travel cards, and insurance. The group offers trade finance, corporate finance, financial supply chain management, savings bonds, cash management, treasury management, and debt and equity capital market solutions. UOB provides various other services such as asset management, **wealth management**, venture management, advisory, **private banking**, transaction banking, mobile banking, online banking, and internet banking services. The group also offers travel management, futures broking, stockbroking, portfolio management, and property management services. The group operates in Asia-Pacific, Europe, and North America. UOB is headquartered in Singapore. The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD22,242 million for the fiscal year ended December 2023 (FY2023), an increase of 72.9% over FY2022. In FY2023, the bank's operating margin was 46.9%, compared to an operating margin of 49.6% in FY2022. In FY2023, the bank recorded a net margin of 21%, compared to a net margin of 28.2% in FY2022.

Business Description

United Overseas Bank Ltd (UOB) provides personal, commercial, business, private, and investment banking solutions. It also offers corporate finance, asset management, insurance, treasury, capital markets, venture capital management, and stock broking services.

As of December 31, 2022, it had assets of SGD504,260 million, total deposits of SGD393,090 million, and loans to customers of SGD315,355 million.

UOB classifies its operations into four segments: Group Retail (GR), Group Wholesale Banking (GWB), Others, and Global Markets (GM).

As of December 31, 2022, it had a network of over 500 branches and offices, and more than 1.1 million ATMs in 19 countries and territories in Europe, North America, and the Asia Pacific.

Market Definition

The banking industry involves the activities of banks and similar institutions that offer financial services such as savings, loans, mortgages, and related services to businesses and consumers.

The market value represents the total assets held by banks or related institutions in a country in a year. The market share represents the total asset held by the companies in the specific year.

Geographical segmentation measures the total assets held by commercial banks of a particular region.

The market is segmented into bank credit, inter-bank loans, cash assets, trading assets, and others. The scope of others includes investments, loans receivable, and fixed assets.

Bank credit refers to funds that a bank lends to individuals, businesses, or other entities.

Inter-bank loans are loans made between banks. These loans serve as a mechanism for banks to manage their short-term liquidity needs and meet regulatory requirements.

Cash asset products of banks provide customers with a secure and convenient way to manage their cash holdings while earning potential returns on their funds. Customers can choose from a variety of products based on their financial goals, risk tolerance, and liquidity needs.

Bank trading assets refer to financial instruments and securities that banks hold primarily for trading to generate profits. These assets are actively bought and sold within the bank's trading desk or investment division to capitalize on short-term price fluctuations, market trends, or arbitrage opportunities. Trading assets can encompass a wide range of financial instruments such as equities, commodities, and foreign exchange.

All market data and forecasts are adjusted for inflation and all currency conversions used in the creation of this report have been calculated using yearly annual average exchange rates.

For the purposes of this report, the global market consists of North America, South America, Europe, Asia-Pacific, Middle East, South Africa and Nigeria.

North America consists of Canada, Mexico, and the United States.

South America comprises Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, and Peru.

Europe comprises Austria, Belgium, the Czech Republic, Denmark, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Ireland, Italy, Netherlands, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Russia, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Turkey, and the United Kingdom.

Scandinavia comprises Denmark, Finland, Norway, and Sweden.

Asia-Pacific comprises Australia, China, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Kazakhstan, Japan, Malaysia, New Zealand, Pakistan, Philippines, Singapore, South Korea, Taiwan, Thailand, and Vietnam.

Middle East comprises Egypt, Israel, Saudi Arabia, and United Arab Emirates.

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Hong Kong - Banks - Competitive Landscape

3,632 words

10 May 2024

MarketLine Industry Profiles

DMRP

English

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The Hong Kong banks industry consists of four top performers: Bank of China Hong Kong (BOCHK), Standard Chartered Bank Hong Kong (SCBL), the Hong Kong and Shanghai Banking (HSBC), and Hang Seng. The leading players are based in Hong Kong and China, indicating the well-diversified geographical presence of the leading players in the industry. There is not much differentiation in the industry, as all the main players offer similar financial products to consumers and operate with similar strategies. The only way a player could get a competitive edge over their peers is if that player was involved in a government project or financed a low-risk endeavor. Most of the industry players are periodically financing their activities in the form of bonds, issuing equity to investors, or acquiring different kinds of companies in several industries and markets.

Who are the leading players?

The Hong Kong and Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd. (HSBC)

HSBC Hong Kong, a subsidiary of HSBC Holdings plc, is the largest bank in Hong Kong, with a 37.3% market share in 2023. The bank offers personal, commercial, and corporate banking; insurance; wealth and asset management; money and capital markets; and treasury and securities solutions in Asia-Pacific. HSBC operates under six segments: wealth and personal banking, commercial banking, global banking, markets and securities services, corporate center, and others. HSBC primarily operates in various Asia-Pacific countries, including Hong Kong, China, India, Australia, Malaysia, Singapore, Indonesia, Taiwan, and others. HSBC's global businesses operate in 62 countries and territories, serving approximately 42 million customers globally. In 2023, HSBC saw a significant increase in new-to-bank Wealth & Personal Banking (WPB) customers in Hong Kong, with 634,500 individuals becoming customers. In FY2023, the bank reported total assets of \$1,341.8 billion from Hong Kong.

Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Ltd. (SCBL)

SCBL, a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC, is the second-largest bank in Hong Kong, with a 22.9% market share in 2023. The bank is based in Hong Kong and offers personal, private, SME, and wholesale banking services to individual and corporate customers. SCBL classifies its operations into four segments: corporate, commercial, and institutional banking; consumer, private, and business banking; central and other items; and ventures. As of 2023, Standard Chartered has a significant client base, including 11.8 million active individual clients and 226,000 total CCIB and business banking clients. In FY2023, the bank reported total assets of \$822.8 billion from Hong Kong.

Bank of China (Hong Kong) Ltd. (BOCHK)

BOCHK, a subsidiary of BOC Hong Kong (Holdings) Ltd., is the third-largest bank in Hong Kong, with a market share of 13.8% in 2023. The bank is based in Hong Kong and offers banking services, including corporate, private, enrichment, and **wealth management**. It provides products like time deposits, current accounts, savings accounts, personal loans, business loans, and credit cards. BOCHK also offers life, travel, and medical insurance. It also provides e-commerce, investment, RMB, remittance, trade finance, treasury, and payroll services. It caters to personal, corporate, and institutional customers in Hong Kong and China. In FY2023, the bank reported total assets of \$494.4 billion from Hong Kong.

Hang Seng Bank Ltd. (Hang Seng)

Hang Seng, a subsidiary of the Hong Kong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Ltd., is the fourth-largest bank in Hong Kong with a 6.0% market share in 2023. The bank is based in Hong Kong and is a provider of retail and commercial banking, **wealth management**, insurance, and other related solutions to individual, commercial, and SME clients. The bank also offers cross-border banking, insurance, and investment. Hang Seng operates through

five business segments: wealth and personal banking, commercial banking, global banking, global markets, and others. Geographically, it offers its products and services in the following three regions: Hong Kong, Mainland China, and others. Hang Seng offers innovative banking, investment, and **wealth management** services to over 3.9 million customers. With a mobile app and a network of over 260 outlets, it combines strong digital capabilities. In FY2023, the bank reported total assets of \$216.2 billion from Hong Kong.

What are the strategies of the leading players?

HSBC Bank focuses on expanding its business operations and meeting the evolving needs of its customers through various initiatives. To this end, in July 2023, the bank partnered with Gobi Partners to do business in ASEAN. During the same month, the bank partnered with PT Hutchison Ports Indonesia to promote maritime trade between Hong Kong and Indonesia. The bank launched data-led trade finance in partnership with Dowsure Technologies to serve merchants with cross-border eCommerce services. In March 2023, the bank launched online account opening services to serve foreign account holders. In July 2023, the bank partnered with Gobi Partners to support the innovation economy in Hong Kong and ASEAN. The partnership aims to explore further opportunities to drive business and financial connectivity between the Greater Bay Area and ASEAN, aiming to deepen their collaboration in July 2023.

BOC is involved in various strategic agreements to acquire new customers, which will drive its business growth. In February 2023, the Bank of China (Hong Kong) announced the launch of an efficient online payment collection solution for Cathay Pacific Airways.

Hang Seng Bank focuses on initiatives to expand its business operations and better serve its customer base. In line with this, in January 2024, the bank entered into a partnership with AlipayHK to introduce a new payment experience. With the introduction of this special service, the bank became the first bank in Hong Kong to provide credit card loyalty point redemption via AlipayHK, significantly increasing the number of merchants in Hong Kong that accept +FUN Dollars. Also in the same month, the bank introduced a comprehensive **wealth management** solution for the 'Sandwich Generation', to balance living standards and enable sustainable wealth planning by combining insurance and investing. In November 2023, the bank and China Construction Bank signed a Memorandum of Understanding to explore the possibilities of cross-border e-CNY. With this MOU, the two banks' cooperation will be strengthened, and their combined contributions to the growth of the Guangdong-Hong Kong-Macao Greater Bay Area (or "GBA") will be accelerated.

What have been the recent M&A activities?

In November 2023, Lufax Holdings announced plans to acquire Hong Kong virtual lender Ping An OneConnect Bank (PAOB) for \$119.5 million. The deal comes as Ping An reshuffles its investment portfolio and reduces exposure to China's heavily indebted property sector. Lufax lends to small businesses on the Chinese mainland, while PAOB offers virtual banking services primarily to small and medium-sized enterprises in Hong Kong.

In May 2023, Standard Chartered completed the acquisition of RBC Investor Services Trust Hong Kong, forming Standard Chartered Trustee (Hong Kong) Ltd. The acquisition aims to expand Standard Chartered Bank Hong Kong's securities services capabilities and client base, as well as extend its trustee activities for MPF schemes and Occupational Retirement Scheme Ordinances in Hong Kong. The existing trustee capabilities in Hong Kong, which service retail funds, will also be merged into SC Trustee over time.

This section contains brief overviews of the leading companies in the Hong Kong banks industry.

Company

Company Name: Bank of China Ltd

Bank of China Ltd (BOC), a subsidiary of Central Huijin Investment Ltd, is a provider of personal and commercial banking, **wealth management** and **private banking**, treasury, investment banking, insurance, and other financial solutions. Its portfolio of offerings consists of accounts and deposits, which include current accounts, term deposits, gift deposits; loans for foreign education, house, syndicated loans, export supplier, and the export buyer; card products such as credit and debit cards, and life and non-life insurance. As part of its related financial services, BOC offers domestic and overseas remittance, trade services, RMB settlement, telephone banking, cash management, agency bill payment, annuity, and cross-border cash management. The bank has an operational presence in the Asia Pacific, Europe, Africa, the Middle East, and the Americas. BOC is headquartered in Beijing, China.

The bank reported interest income of (Renminbi) CNY1,048,851 million for the fiscal year ended December 2023 (FY2023), an increase of 19.1% over FY2022. In FY2023, the bank's operating margin was 46.1%, compared to an operating margin of 45.8% in FY2022. In FY2023, the bank recorded a net margin of 18.9%, compared to a net margin of 21.8% in FY2022.

The bank reported interest income of CNY272,283 million for the first quarter ended March 2024, an increase of 0.2% over the previous quarter.

Head office: Xicheng District , Beijing, Beijing, China

Telephone: 861066596688

Fax: 861066016871

Number of Employees: 306931

Website: www.boc.cn

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: 601988

Stock Exchange: Shanghai Stock Exchange

Company Overview

Bank of China Ltd (BOC), a subsidiary of Central Huijin Investment Ltd, is a provider of personal and commercial banking, **wealth management** and **private banking**, treasury, investment banking, insurance, and other financial solutions. Its portfolio of offerings consists of accounts and deposits, which include current accounts, term deposits, gift deposits; loans for foreign education, house, syndicated loans, export supplier, and the export buyer; card products such as credit and debit cards, and life and non-life insurance. As part of its related financial services, BOC offers domestic and overseas remittance, trade services, RMB settlement, telephone banking, cash management, agency bill payment, annuity, and cross-border cash management. The bank has an operational presence in the Asia Pacific, Europe, Africa, the Middle East, and the Americas. BOC is headquartered in Beijing, China. The bank reported interest income of (Renminbi) CNY1,048,851 million for the fiscal year ended December 2023 (FY2023), an increase of 19.1% over FY2022. In FY2023, the bank's operating margin was 46.1%, compared to an operating margin of 45.8% in FY2022. In FY2023, the bank recorded a net margin of 18.9%, compared to a net margin of 21.8% in FY2022.

The bank reported interest income of CNY272,283 million for the first quarter ended March 2024, an increase of 0.2% over the previous quarter.

Business Description

Bank of China Ltd (BOC) is a provider of commercial, retail, and investment banking products; treasury; insurance; and **wealth management** solutions. As of December 31, 2022, it had assets of CNY28,913,857 million, net loans of CNY17,070,593 million, and deposits of CNY22,508,904 million.

BOC operates six business segments: Corporate Banking, Personal Banking, Treasury Operations, Insurance, Investment Banking, and Other operations.

It operates in Asia Pacific, Europe, Africa, the Middle East, and the Americas.

As of December 31, 2022, BOC operated a network of 10,323 commercial banking branches, which includes 9,913 outlets, 38 tier-1 and direct branches, and 371 tier-2 branches. It had 11,439 institutions across the world, which includes 10,908 institutions in China and 531 institutions in Macao, Hong Kong, Taiwan and other countries and regions. It also operated an extensive distribution channel that comprised 27,729 ATMs, 32,367 smart counters and 885 self-service terminals.

Company

Company Name: Hang Seng Bank Ltd

Hang Seng Bank Ltd (Hang Seng) is a financial institution that specializes in providing a wide range of banking, investment, and **wealth management** services. The bank's major activities include wealth and personal banking,
Page 96 of 182 © 2026 Factiva, Inc. All rights reserved.

commercial banking, and global banking and markets, alongside a comprehensive suite of renminbi services. Its product offerings encompass accounts, deposits, foreign exchange, various loan products including personal and mortgage loans, and investment services such as securities, funds, and bonds. The bank serves a diverse clientele, serving individuals and businesses with both local and cross-boundary banking needs. It operates a strategic network of service outlets and branches across Hong Kong, mainland China, Macau, and Singapore, and maintains a representative office in Taipei. Hang Seng is headquartered in Hong Kong, China.

The bank reported interest income of (Hong Kong Dollars) HKD59,439 million for the fiscal year ended December 2023 (FY2023), an increase of 70.9% over FY2022. In FY2023, the bank's operating margin was 36.7%, compared to an operating margin of 36.1% in FY2022. In FY2023, the bank recorded a net margin of 21.8%, compared to a net margin of 25.3% in FY2022.

Head office: 83 Des Voeux Road Central Central, , Hong Kong, Hong Kong (China SAR)

Telephone: 85234789216

Fax: 85234091235

Number of Employees: 8494

Website: www.hangseng.com

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: 11

Stock Exchange: Hong Kong Stock Exchange

Company Overview

Hang Seng Bank Ltd (Hang Seng) is a financial institution that specializes in providing a wide range of banking, investment, and **wealth management** services. The bank's major activities include wealth and personal banking, commercial banking, and global banking and markets, alongside a comprehensive suite of renminbi services. Its product offerings encompass accounts, deposits, foreign exchange, various loan products including personal and mortgage loans, and investment services such as securities, funds, and bonds. The bank serves a diverse clientele, serving individuals and businesses with both local and cross-boundary banking needs. It operates a strategic network of service outlets and branches across Hong Kong, mainland China, Macau, and Singapore, and maintains a representative office in Taipei. Hang Seng is headquartered in Hong Kong, China. The bank reported interest income of (Hong Kong Dollars) HKD59,439 million for the fiscal year ended December 2023 (FY2023), an increase of 70.9% over FY2022. In FY2023, the bank's operating margin was 36.7%, compared to an operating margin of 36.1% in FY2022. In FY2023, the bank recorded a net margin of 21.8%, compared to a net margin of 25.3% in FY2022.

Business Description

Hang Seng Bank Ltd (Hang Seng) is a provider of retail and commercial banking, **wealth management**, insurance, and other related solutions to individual, commercial, and SME clients. The bank also offers cross-border banking, insurance, and investment.

As of December 31, 2023, it reported assets of HKD1,692,094 million, total deposits of HKD1,182,626 million, and net loans of HKD860,406 million.

Hang Seng operates through five business segments: Wealth and Personal Banking, Commercial Banking, Global Banking, Global Markets, and Other. Geographically, it offers its products and services in the following three regions: Hong Kong, Mainland China, and Others.

Company

Company Name: HSBC Holdings Plc

HSBC Holdings Plc (HSBC) is a provider of banking and financial solutions. It offers retail, business, and commercial banking, **private banking**, and **wealth management** services through its subsidiaries. The group's portfolio of offerings comprises personal and commercial loans, deposit services, mortgages, card products, insurance solutions, asset management, working capital and term loans, payment services, international trade

facilitation, merger and acquisition advisory, transaction banking, capital markets, and risk management, investment management, and trusts and estate planning, among others. It has a presence in Europe, Asia, the Middle East, North Africa, North America, and Latin America. HSBC is headquartered in London, the UK.

The bank reported interest income of (US Dollars) US\$100,868 million for the fiscal year ended December 2023 (FY2023), an increase of 90.9% over FY2022. In FY2023, the bank's operating margin was 36.7%, compared to an operating margin of 28.2% in FY2022. In FY2023, the bank recorded a net margin of 15.9%, compared to a net margin of 18.8% in FY2022.

The bank reported interest income of US\$8,653 million for the first quarter ended March 2024, a decrease of 84% over the previous quarter.

Head office: 8 Canada Square London, Greater London, United Kingdom

Number of Employees: 214400

Website: www.hsbc.com

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: HSBA

Stock Exchange: London Stock Exchange (LON)

Company Overview

HSBC Holdings Plc (HSBC) is a provider of banking and financial solutions. It offers retail, business, and commercial banking, **private banking**, and **wealth management** services through its subsidiaries. The group's portfolio of offerings comprises personal and commercial loans, deposit services, mortgages, card products, insurance solutions, asset management, working capital and term loans, payment services, international trade facilitation, merger and acquisition advisory, transaction banking, capital markets, and risk management, investment management, and trusts and estate planning, among others. It has a presence in Europe, Asia, the Middle East, North Africa, North America, and Latin America. HSBC is headquartered in London, the UK. The bank reported interest income of (US Dollars) US\$100,868 million for the fiscal year ended December 2023 (FY2023), an increase of 90.9% over FY2022. In FY2023, the bank's operating margin was 36.7%, compared to an operating margin of 28.2% in FY2022. In FY2023, the bank recorded a net margin of 15.9%, compared to a net margin of 18.8% in FY2022.

The bank reported interest income of US\$8,653 million for the first quarter ended March 2024, a decrease of 84% over the previous quarter.

Business Description

HSBC Holdings Plc (HSBC) is a banking and financial services group that provides retail, commercial, and **private banking**, and **wealth management** solutions. As of December 31, 2023, it reported total assets of US\$3,038,677 million, customer accounts of US\$1,611,647 million, and loans and advances to customers of US\$938,535 million.

HSBC operates through four segments: Wealth and Personal Banking, Commercial Banking, Global Banking and Markets, and Corporate Centre.

As of December 31, 2023, the group served about 42 million customers in 62 countries and territories in Europe, Asia, the Middle East, Africa, North America, and Latin America.

Company

Company Name: Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Ltd

Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Ltd (SCBL), a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC, offers personal, private, SME, and wholesale banking solutions. It includes savings, current, and time deposits. It offers loans such as personal and mortgage loans, credit cards, investment products and services, and retirement solutions. The bank also offers overdrafts, lines of credit, working capital finance, business installment loans, cash management, foreign exchange, securities services, market insights, remittances, and **private banking**. It offers insurance for travel, home, medical care, life, and critical illness. The bank operates through various channels

such as online banking, mobile banking, and telephone banking among others. SCBL is headquartered in Hong Kong.

Head office: 32nd Floor 4-4A Des Voeux Road, Central, Hong Kong, Hong Kong (China SAR)

Website: www.sc.com/hk

Financial Year End: December

Company Overview

Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Ltd (SCBL), a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC, offers personal, private, SME, and wholesale banking solutions. It includes savings, current, and time deposits. It offers loans such as personal and mortgage loans, credit cards, investment products and services, and retirement solutions. The bank also offers overdrafts, lines of credit, working capital finance, business installment loans, cash management, foreign exchange, securities services, market insights, remittances, and **private banking**. It offers insurance for travel, home, medical care, life, and critical illness. The bank operates through various channels such as online banking, mobile banking, and telephone banking among others. SCBL is headquartered in Hong Kong.

Business Description

Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Ltd (SCBL) offers personal, private, SME, and wholesale banking services to individual and corporate customers. As of December 31, 2022, it had assets of HKD2,478 billion, advances to customers of HKD1,189.7 billion, and deposits from customers of HKD1,705.8 billion.

SCBL classifies its operations into four segments: Corporate, Commercial & Institutional Banking; Consumer, Private & Business Banking; Central & Other Items; and Ventures.

Market Definition

The banking industry involves the activities of banks and similar institutions that offer financial services such as savings, loans, mortgages, and related services to businesses and consumers.

The market value represents the total assets held by banks or related institutions in a country in a year. The market share represents the total asset held by the companies in the specific year.

Geographical segmentation measures the total assets held by commercial banks of a particular region.

The market is segmented into bank credit, inter-bank loans, cash assets, trading assets, and others. The scope of others includes investments, loans receivable, and fixed assets.

Bank credit refers to funds that a bank lends to individuals, businesses, or other entities.

Inter-bank loans are loans made between banks. These loans serve as a mechanism for banks to manage their short-term liquidity needs and meet regulatory requirements.

Cash asset products of banks provide customers with a secure and convenient way to manage their cash holdings while earning potential returns on their funds. Customers can choose from a variety of products based on their financial goals, risk tolerance, and liquidity needs.

Bank trading assets refer to financial instruments and securities that banks hold primarily for trading to generate profits. These assets are actively bought and sold within the bank's trading desk or investment division to capitalize on short-term price fluctuations, market trends, or arbitrage opportunities. Trading assets can encompass a wide range of financial instruments such as equities, commodities, and foreign exchange.

All market data and forecasts are adjusted for inflation and all currency conversions used in the creation of this report have been calculated using yearly annual average exchange rates.

For the purposes of this report, the global market consists of North America, South America, Europe, Asia-Pacific, Middle East, South Africa and Nigeria.

North America consists of Canada, Mexico, and the United States.

South America comprises Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, and Peru.

Europe comprises Austria, Belgium, the Czech Republic, Denmark, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Ireland, Italy, Netherlands, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Russia, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Turkey, and the United Kingdom.

Scandinavia comprises Denmark, Finland, Norway, and Sweden.

Asia-Pacific comprises Australia, China, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Kazakhstan, Japan, Malaysia, New Zealand, Pakistan, Philippines, Singapore, South Korea, Taiwan, Thailand, and Vietnam.

Middle East comprises Egypt, Israel, Saudi Arabia, and United Arab Emirates.

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OCBC deepens Indonesia presence with completion of PT Bank Commonwealth acquisition

Distributed by Contify.com

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2 May 2024

Contify Banking News

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English

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OCBC deepens its presence in Indonesia by acquiring PT Bank Commonwealth Indonesia, bringing over 1.2 million customers. PTBC, known for **wealth management**, will operate independently until integration in Q4 2024. The acquisition aligns with OCBC's strategy to capture opportunities from ASEAN-Greater China flows.

Key Highlights:

- * PTBC is a pioneer in **wealth management** in Indonesia
- * PTBC was the first bank to obtain a license as a Mutual Fund Sales Agent in Indonesia
- * PTBC will operate independently until the integration process is completed in the fourth quarter of 2024

Original Press Release:

Singapore, May 2 -- OCBC Bank issued the following news release:

- The acquisition brings more than 1.2 million PT Bank Commonwealth Indonesia customers to OCBC Indonesia

OCBC's Indonesian subsidiary, PT Bank OCBC NISP Tbk ("OCBC Indonesia"), has completed the acquisition of PT Bank Commonwealth Indonesia ("PTBC") on 1 May 2024. OCBC Indonesia now owns 100% of PTBC's shares, making PTBC a wholly-owned subsidiary of OCBC Indonesia. The acquisition brings more than 1.2 million PTBC customers to OCBC Indonesia. PTBC brings with it demonstrated capabilities in **wealth management** where it has been a pioneer, having been the first bank to obtain a licence as a Mutual Fund Sales Agent from Indonesia's financial services authority, BAPEPAM-LK (now known as Otoritas Jasa Keuangan).

PTBC will continue to operate independently until the integration process is completed. This is targeted to be in the fourth quarter of 2024. During this period, PTBC will serve its customers as usual with its banking products and services, including banking transactions at PTBC's branches and through digital channels.

OCBC Indonesia offers a full range of services to individuals across segments including **Private Banking**, as well as SMEs and large corporations. These customers are served through mobile and internet banking channels, as well as OCBC Indonesia's network of around 200 branches. The bank holds one of the highest credit ratings in Indonesia, namely AAA(idn)/stable from PT Fitch Ratings Indonesia.

This acquisition underscores Indonesia's continued importance to OCBC Group. It is one of the Group's core markets together with Singapore, Malaysia and Greater China, and presents many opportunities as ASEAN's largest economy and the world's fourth most populous country. China is Indonesia's largest trading partner and Indonesia's second largest investor. Combining PTBC's capabilities with OCBC Indonesia's enables OCBC Group to better capture the opportunities from the increasing ASEAN-Greater China wealth, trade and investment flows, in line with the Group's corporate strategy.

Ms Helen Wong, Group CEO of OCBC, said, "With the acquisition process now complete, our immediate priority is to ensure the successful operational integration of PT Bank Commonwealth Indonesia into OCBC Indonesia. We are working closely with its management team and are committed to a smooth transition for the customers and employees. Customers of both banks have a lot to look forward to as we leverage our complementary strengths to expand our product and services offerings in Indonesia.

This acquisition builds on our already strong presence in Indonesia. It signals our commitment to accelerating growth in the country, and to support our customers as they seek growth across multiple markets. Rising

ASEAN-Greater China flows is a focal point of Asia's growth story and a big opportunity for us. Chinese companies for instance, are looking to expand into Indonesia to tap its large young population and abundance of natural resources. Continuously strengthening our network across ASEAN and Greater China, and presence in other global financial centres, is therefore imperative to our strategy."

The acquisition is the latest strategic milestone for OCBC in Indonesia. It became the first Singapore bank to acquire a banking stake in Indonesia with the acquisition of a 22.5% stake in PT Bank NISP Tbk ("Bank NISP") in 2004 – a stake that has increased over the years to the current 85%. Bank NISP was renamed to become PT Bank OCBC NISP Tbk ("Bank OCBC NISP") in 2008. In 2023, in line with OCBC's brand refresh, Bank OCBC NISP changed its brand name to OCBC Indonesia and adopted OCBC's refreshed logo. Its legal name remains as PT Bank OCBC NISP Tbk. For more information, please refer to the Appendix below.

Appendix

OCBC's milestones in Greater China and ASEAN

- * 1912: The oldest of the three banks that would eventually be merged with two other banks to become OCBC, was the Chinese Commercial Bank founded in 1912.
- * 1923: Ho Hong Bank, which would eventually merge with two other banks in Singapore to form OCBC, established a branch office in Hong Kong.
- * 1925: OCBC first established presence in mainland China through its Xiamen branch. Since then, OCBC has been operating without interruption in the country.
- * 1927: OCBC established Shanghai branch.
- * 1932: OCBC formed from the merger of three local banks - Chinese Commercial Bank, Ho Hong Bank and the Oversea-Chinese Bank.
- * 1994: Incorporation of OCBC Bank (Malaysia) Berhad.
- * 2004: OCBC became first Singapore bank to acquire banking stake in Indonesia with acquisition of 22.5% stake in Bank NISP – a stake that has increased over the years to the current 85%.
- .
- * 2006: OCBC acquired a 12.2% equity holding in Ningbo Commercial Bank.
- * 2008: Bank NISP renamed to become Bank OCBC NISP.
- * 2009: OCBC bought ING Asia **Private Bank**.
- * 2010: Bank of Singapore formed from the combination of ING Asia **Private Bank** and OCBC **Private Banking** business.
- * 2014: Acquisition of Wing Hang Bank for HK\$38.7 billion (S\$6.2 billion) in July. At that time, it had been the largest cross-border bank deal within Asia (ex-Japan) in the past decade. Wing Hang Bank was renamed as OCBC Wing Hang Bank in October that same year.
- * 2014: OCBC raised stake in the renamed Bank of Ningbo (previously Ningbo Commercial Bank) to 20%.
- * 2016: Bank of Singapore acquired the wealth and investment management business of Barclays PLC in Singapore and Hong Kong (Barclays WIM Singapore and Hong Kong).
- * 2016: Wing Hang Bank (China) Limited, was officially merged with OCBC Bank (China) Limited to become OCBC Wing Hang Bank (China) Limited.
- * 2017: OCBC entered into an agreement to acquire National Australia Bank's (NAB) Private Wealth business in Singapore and Hong Kong SAR.
- * 2023:

- The sixth iteration of the OCBC logo was unveiled on 3 July 2023. Where regulations permit, all subsidiaries, branches, and offices across markets adopted the refreshed logo. This included Bank OCBC NISP in Indonesia which became OCBC Indonesia as it unveiled its new brand on 14 November 2023.

- Banking subsidiaries in Mainland China, Hong Kong SAR and Macau SAR also changed their legal names. In Hong Kong SAR, OCBC Wing Hang Bank Limited became OCBC Bank (Hong Kong) Limited and in Macau SAR, Banco OCBC Weng Hang, S.A. became OCBC Bank (Macau) Limited. OCBC Wing Hang Bank (China) Limited became OCBC Bank Limited in mainland China.

* 2024: OCBC Indonesia completed the acquisition of PT Bank Commonwealth Indonesia.

Source: OCBC Bank

[Category: Banks, Banks, Retail/ Commercial Bank, M&A Activities]

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StanChart HK and Manulife deepen strategic partnership

James Phillipps

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30 April 2024

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CWIRAS

English

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Manulife is to offer Standard Chartered Hong Kong's **private banking** clients a range of savings, protection and wealth accumulation products in a deepening of the companies' existing distribution partnership.

The arrangement will also see Manulife's legacy planning services made available to the **private bank's** customers, with immediate effect.

The two firms signed a 15 year exclusive pension distribution partnership in 2016 and the new tie-up extends the range of products that will be offered.

Alson Ho, head of wealth solutions, Hong Kong, at Standard Chartered, said: 'Standard Chartered Hong Kong's investment platform already offers a wide suite of diversified products for our **private banking** clients. Through introducing Manulife's sophisticated offerings, we are well positioned to provide our clients with bespoke asset management and wealth planning solutions.'

Manulife Hong Kong and Macau chief distribution officer Ivan Chan added: 'This strategic collaboration will enable us to further strengthen our position as a leading provider of savings and protection solutions in the city.'

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HSBC GPB shuts EAM desks in HK and SG

Priyanka Boghani

284 words

26 April 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC Global **Private Banking** has closed its independent/external asset manager desks in Hong Kong and Singapore, following a review of the business.

The news was first reported by Bloomberg and confirmed to Citywire Asia by a spokesperson from the bank.

HSBC said it will 'make this change as smooth as possible for the affected clients' and that it also remains 'committed' to serving the single **family office** and multi-**family office** clients.

The bank said it wants to focus on catering to **family office** clients directly through its **private bank**, with the majority of them already being serviced this way.

HSBC's IAM/EAM desks were set up in 2020 Singapore and in 2022 in Hong Kong. They were established to cater to the growing segment of UHNW clients, which typically appoint IAMs/EAMs to oversee their wealth and give them conflict-free advice.

Private banks have had varied strategies when it comes to keeping EAM desks in Asia, with some, like VP Bank, naming it its core business, while others, such as Deutsche Bank **Private Bank**, opted [out](#) as early as 2017.

The desks typically provide brokerage, custody and investment advisory services for EAM managed accounts. **Private banks** are custodians of the end-client assets and charge a flat fee or a percentage of the assets held.

Many **private banking** intermediaries desks that serve the multi-**family office** segment have been [called out](#) for being outdated and ripe for digital disruption, with critics pointing to inefficiencies in statement aggregation and pricing models. As a result, **private banks** have tended to veer towards firms with \$150m or more in assets under management.

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HSBC GPB market head for HK resurfaces at Hang Seng Bank

Cheryl Heng
306 words
17 April 2024
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A former HSBC Global **Private Bank**'s market head for Hong Kong has taken on the role of head of **private banking** and trust services at Hang Seng Bank.

Rachel Wei, who has been with HSBC for almost 13 years, will join Hang Seng Bank as head of **private bank** and trust services, effective 15 April.

A spokesperson at HSBC has confirmed Wei's departure, while Hang Seng Bank has confirmed her new appointment.

Wei has extensive experience in global private and commercial banking. In 2018, Wei was appointed co-market head for Hong Kong in HSBC GPB, after her past position as head of global trade and receivable finance for Hong Kong and Macau, as well as managing commercial banking corporate relationships earlier in her career.

In Wei's new role, she succeeds Alison Law, who has been Hang Seng Bank's head of **private banking** and trust services since 2021. The firm announced that Law returned to the parent company as global head of distribution for HSBC Life last December.

HSBC exits

Bryce Wan, HSBC GPB's Hong Kong market head, has also resigned to pursue opportunities outside the bank.

The bank has confirmed his departure as well.

He joined HSBC in 2022 from UBS, then appointed HSBC GPB as market head for North Asia where he reported to the then regional head Siew Meng Tan.

Tan has since announced her retirement, with [Lok Yim](#) from Deutsche Bank succeeding her.

In response to Wan and Wei's departures, the spokesperson for HSBC said: 'Our ambition to be the leading wealth manager in Asia remains unchanged and we have set a clear growth strategy for global **private banking** in Asia to become the world's leading **private bank** for Asian and international clients, and entrepreneurs.'

Document CWIRAS0020240417ek4h00002

Hong Kong stocks

HSBC plans to accelerate the expansion of its wealth business in mainland China

129 words

10 April 2024

GuruClub Live - English

GCLIEN

English

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Guru Club, April 10 | Nuno Matos, Global CEO of HSBC Wealth Management and Personal Banking, stated that the bank still plans to accelerate its expansion of wealth business in mainland China and is expected to nearly double the number of employees by the end of next year. He stated that since 2021, HSBC's project "Pinnacle" in mainland China has hired about 1700 wealth managers and is expected to increase to 1900 by the end of this year, with a target of 3000 by 2025. In addition, he mentioned that since the restart of India's private banking business in July last year, HSBC has hired about 50 relationship managers and investment advisors.

Document GCLIEN0020240410ek4a0000s



HSBC bullish on Philippine economy

Keisha Ta-Asan

608 words

7 April 2024

The Philippine Star

PHSTAR

English

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MANILA, Philippines — British banking giant HSBC is targeting to boost its financial services, onboard more affluent clients into its wealth management business and increase its lending capabilities in the country as it sees huge opportunities for the Philippines in the coming years.

In a roundtable discussion with reporters, HSBC head of wealth and personal banking of South Asia Kai Zhang said 2024 would be a strong year for the bank.

This developed as HSBC aims to accelerate three key areas of its business by boosting the growth of affluent international customer base.

"We are building all these capabilities. Our aim is to really bring more customers onto our platform, and the key is really around the affluent and international segments, where we can serve the needs as customers grow in different stages of their life cycle," she said.

HSBC is also planning to accelerate its wealth management capabilities by bringing in new product sets and tools in the market as well as streamlining sale processes.

The foreign bank is launching new lending products to help support their customers, as the Philippines is a service- and consumption-driven economy.

"We have a lot of opportunities in really meeting the financial needs for individuals and new families," she said. "Through credit cards, personal loans and mortgages, we actually serve the lending needs of our customers."

She added that HSBC would continue to digitize across its operations in the region to be able to offer clients easily accessible financial services.

"There is just a lot of opportunity that's untapped and I think we're going to work with our global platform team and bring more capabilities into the Philippines," she said. "As a 150-year-old bank, (we should) play a very important role to meet the growing financial needs of the population here."

Zhang pointed out that the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) region holds the world's fastest growing economies, with the Philippines as one of its growth leaders.

"The attractiveness of ASEAN and opportunities really stems from the economic growth, and also the size of the economy," she said.

She also noted that the country's young demographics and interconnectivity with its neighboring countries makes the Philippines an attractive market to invest in.

"This region really is attracting a lot of investment both from Asia and also from around the world. And of course, from the people's side, we have India and the Philippines as two of the largest international diasporas in the world," she said.

According to Zhang, the Philippines is one of the international affluent markets that HSBC caters to. It is also part of the eight economies in South and South Asia, out of 16 global affluent markets.

"These are the markets that we will prioritize investment and we see these markets grow into potentially future scale markets. So that actually tells us a lot about our commitment to Asia, to Southeast Asia and to the Philippines," she said.

Meanwhile, HSBC Philippines president and CEO Sandeep Uppal said the bank would further strengthen its consumer banking business in the Philippines even as other foreign banks exit the country's retail banking space.

"Clearly, we see a huge opportunity on the retail fronts as you would have seen from some of the investments we made recently into our branches, into the network, and I'm sure there will be more developments over the year or so," he said.

[In a roundtable discussion with reporters, HSBC head of wealth and personal banking of South Asia Kai Zhang said 2024 would be a strong year for the bank.](#)

Document PHSTAR0020240406ek470000f

Supplement 1

HSBC Global Private Bank leverages global reach to grow ultra wealthy segment in Asia

, HSBC Global Private Bank leverages global reach to grow ultra wealthy segment in Asia

1,179 words

3 April 2024

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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INTERNATIONAL connectivity has been a topic of growing importance amid geopolitical and economic uncertainties and the ultra wealthy are paying close attention to this.

HSBC Global Private Banking -- with its global network and full suite of banking capabilities -- is building on its strengths to serve the needs of such clients with tailored solutions that meet diverse needs.

The bank has delivered a strong performance in 2023 with invested assets for the Global Private Bank in Asia growing to US\$166 billion, a record high.

The amount represents year-on-year growth of 18 per cent, with clients from the ultra high net worth segment contributing to over half of the growth.

And HSBC Global Private Banking is looking to build on this momentum, with key hires joining the team to drive growth, with a focus on Asian and international clients as well as entrepreneurs.

Tommy Leung joined HSBC last October and leads the Global Private Banking South Asia unit to support the ambitions of entrepreneurs, ultra-high-net-worth individuals and their families across the region and globally.

The bank has also made other key senior appointments in recent months as it works to become the leading international wealth manager in the region.

In March, HSBC appointed Kerri Lim as the head of ultra high net worth segment for Asia, and also named Pritash Mathur as head of family office coverage for Global India and Global South Asia.

This is following the recent appointment of Edith Wong as head of ultra high net worth segment for North Asia.

Leung said the ultra wealthy segment with investable assets over US\$ 30 million is a key focus for the bank.

"The solutions and services such clients demand go beyond traditional private banking. This could encompass multi generational wealth planning as well as wealth preservation, along with international connectivity. These are key value propositions we have for them," he said.

Global reach with strong Asia footprint

HSBC's network covers more than 60 markets in Europe, the Middle East and Africa, North America and Latin America and of course Asia.

Meanwhile, the global private banking team operates in over 40 markets and 13 strategic booking centres, with dedicated Asia coverage teams in key global wealth hubs.

In Asia, HSBC Global Private Bank has presence in Singapore, Hong Kong, mainland China, Taiwan, India, Thailand and the Philippines.

"In an uncertain world, clients want to diversify, not only from a financial assets point of view, but also in terms of where they book their assets," Leung said.

"It's not uncommon for some of the big clients who have assets in Hong Kong, Singapore or other parts of the world to further spread out their wealth," he added. "Our ability to support these clients with that global reach is another unique advantage that our bank has."

HSBC Global **Private Banking** has a global relationship manager model whereby a single contact point acts and coordinates with other divisions of the bank to deliver a seamless client service internationally.

Indeed, the Global Entrepreneurial Wealth Report by HSBC Global **Private Banking** found that three quarters of the entrepreneurs have businesses operating outside of their home market. They're driven by benefits for their business and in their personal lives and expect further opportunities to emerge in the coming years.

With an international focus, many entrepreneurs value global connections and are keeping a close eye on their next move.

Leung noted that this segment of clients typically has existing business outside their domestic borders and are very international.

Entrepreneur clients also often have varied responsibilities, including being the head of the family as well as the head of the business.

"They have many things on their mind, and they need support from a bank who can support them in these different roles," Leung added.

Universal bank

One of HSBC's strengths lies in its ability to provide diversified services, unlike a pure play **private bank**.

"HSBC has a dominant commercial bank, a strong retail franchise, and of course, the life insurance as well as the asset management business," Leung pointed out. "The scale and breadth of our capabilities enable us to offer a comprehensive one-stop banking experience for our clients."

Leung noted that an entrepreneur client would commonly have children attending schools or living elsewhere in the world.

"There are a few basic things we can already do for them, such as opening a bank account and helping them get a credit card even before they arrive," he said.

Beyond retail banking needs for the family, HSBC can also deliver services for the operating business being run by the entrepreneur.

Leung noted that this may span across financing commercial real estate, advising on merger and acquisitions, and providing services for operating companies.

"Quite often, these entrepreneurs appreciate working with a universal bank with that international presence," he said.

The global reach also means that clients have access to local expertise on exciting investment opportunities, allowing them to build diversification into their portfolios.

"Historically, clients tend to have a home bias. If you're based in Southeast Asia, your preference is to invest in Southeast Asia," Leung noted. But in an uncertain world, clients have learnt the necessity of having a global portfolio for diversification.

"Most clients don't necessarily have the expertise in the US or Europe or different parts of the world, and that's where we come in," he said.

Beyond geographical diversification, many are also exploring other asset classes to meet their investment objectives.

HSBC has also seen a rise in interest in **family offices**, as clients want increased flexibility, oversight, and control over their wealth.

Leung noted that some wealthy individuals that have moved over to Singapore have become interested in setting up their own **family office** in this part of the world.

"We not only advise them on investments, but in the very early stage, also give them advice on how to structure a **family office**," he said. "We have a dedicated team called **family office** advisory that supports clients in this situation."

Apart from ultra wealthy clients, the **private bank** is also keen to grow its relationship with those who are starting on their wealth journey.

This involves clients with between US\$2 million to US\$10 million in investable assets, who are moving from the retail bank to the **private bank**.

"We want to offer them experience and solutions that they normally do not get in the retail bank," Leung said.

Such solutions include discretionary portfolio management, wealth planning and trust services.

As their wealth grows, they truly want a key partner to support them and work with them along this journey, he said.

Key findings of HSBC Global Entrepreneurial Wealth report

About the report: 973 current and former entrepreneurs were surveyed in nine markets (France, Hong Kong, India, mainland China, Singapore, Switzerland, the UAE, the UK and the US.)

Document STBT000020240402ek430028z

Supplement 1

Bringing the power of a universal bank to Asian clients

, Bringing the power of a universal bank to Asian clients

1,149 words

3 April 2024

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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WITH Asia's growing affluent population becoming increasingly international, Foo Tian Ong, Standard Chartered **Private Bank**'s Southeast Asia Regional Head and Singapore Location Head, believes that the **private bank** is in a sweet spot to meet the needs of today's Ultra High Net Worth (UHNW) clients.

Standard Chartered serves clients across the wealth continuum -- from mass retail to affluent, High Net Worth (HNW) and Ultra High Net Worth (UHNW) individuals. Being able to tap on the bank's international wealth presence in 25 markets across Asia, Africa, Europe and the Middle East allows the **Private Bank** to bring unique insights and capabilities to clients with growing cross-border needs.

Recognised for its strong growth trajectory and achievements over the last few years, the **private bank** was recently awarded the 'Best **Private Bank** in Southeast Asia' by the Asian **Private Banker**.

Foo, who possesses over two decades' worth of experience in the **private banking** industry, observed two trends which will shape the industry -- the growing affluence of Asians and digitalisation.

"With the growing affluence of Asians comes increased cross-border wealth and banking needs. We have seen a greater demand for overseas mortgages, access to offshore investments and wealth planning as HNW and UHNW clients are looking for sophisticated solutions to meet their individual needs," he said.

International network advantage and universal banking capabilities

"The strength of the bank's international footprint and its universal banking capabilities have allowed it to fulfil both individual wealth and business needs across borders," Foo said, adding that the bank also has wealth and legacy planning capabilities to fulfil clients' intergenerational ambitions.

He gave the example of an Indian client who is residing in Singapore and managing a regional business.

His family is in India, but his children go to school in the United Kingdom (UK), resulting in a need to finance a UK property.

By engaging with a universal bank such as Standard Chartered, Foo said the client was able to manage the family's private wealth in Singapore and overseas, service the children's education and mortgage needs in the UK, and perform corporate banking transactions.

"Our interconnectedness with our corporate bank provides clients access to corporate banking capabilities, offering a one-bank solution for clients - from cash management to supply chain financing, to capital raising and mergers and acquisitions advisory," he said.

He added that the bank is also better placed to serve the diverse needs of clients through its physical presence and long heritage in these markets.

UHNW clients require special attention when it comes to their investment needs, which Standard Chartered **Private Bank** can fulfil across its network.

The bank's team in Singapore, for instance, provides personalised advisory and bespoke investment solutions to help clients manage their wealth locally and overseas.

Through its proprietary SC Wealth Select advisory framework, clients' short- and longer-term wealth needs can be mapped to a wide range of independent investment products and solutions that best meets their expectations.

This includes access to leading third-party investment managers with diversification by asset class, geography and sector. In addition, clients can take advantage of discretionary portfolio management services.

In the area of private wealth, the bank gives clients access to alternative strategies in private equity, private credit and hedge funds.

Conversations on wealth and legacy planning are becoming common as well, said Foo.

"More and more HNW clients and their families are recognising the importance of protecting their wealth for future generations.

"For many family-owned businesses in Asia, this is the first time family wealth and legacy is being passed from one generation to the next," he said.

Holistic wealth succession plans, detailed wills and structures, family governance solutions and even life insurance policies are just some of the needs that UHNW and HNW families are looking for professional assistance with, he added.

To advise these clients, he said **private bankers** need to have an understanding of demographic trends as well.

"More wealth will be in the hands of older clients, and with fewer children to whom they can transfer their wealth, areas such as philanthropy and the servicing model will become increasingly important priorities," he said.

There is also merit in customising the servicing model for older clients. A senior experienced relationship manager (RM) who understands the life stage and priorities of an older client can bring great value to them through a greater level of trust, empathy and sensitivity in their advisory approach.

Importance of digitalisation

The trend of digitalisation has simplified certain processes and streamlined the way the bank serves its clients, Foo said.

In order to leverage digital benefits, he said **private bankers** have had to relearn, reskill and adopt a fresh mindset towards client engagement.

"I am hugely excited about the potential Artificial Intelligence can bring to enhance the solutions offered to clients and streamline the experience. With the efficiency derived through further digitalisation, we can spend more of our time with clients, helping them tackle their increasingly complex business and personal needs, such as bespoke transactions and legacy planning," he said.

A digital-first approach also enables RMs to be more intentional and tailored when they engage their clients, who will then benefit from solutions that are bespoke to meet their specific needs.

Still, Foo said that a balance needs to be struck between the provision of digital services and the human touch -- especially for HNW and UNHW clients.

ESG investments a growing trend

Foo added that he is also seeing growing awareness of environmental, social and governance (ESG) factors in investors' portfolio. The environmental segment, in particular, is drawing attention from clients.

Standard Chartered's 2023 Sustainable Banking Report showed that 94 per cent of investors in Singapore are interested in climate themes, while eight in 10 investors want to increase capital flows towards furthering climate goals.

"Our solutions help clients better understand their portfolios from a sustainability perspective. This includes looking at ESG risks and how green their portfolios are, determining the proportion of their portfolios in controversial sectors, and aligning it to the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals," he said.

The bank has a range of solutions to help clients meet their sustainable investing goals. These include equities, bonds, mutual funds and structured solutions where ESG factors are embedded. The bank's proprietary wealth management quantitative ranking tool also integrates ESG scores as it ranks companies.

To offer these products, the bank has partnered with industry data experts, such as Morningstar and Sustainalytics, to define its sustainable investing framework.

Investors can also rest assured that ESG-driven investing can produce returns, Foo added.

Research by Morningstar in 2020 found that a sample of sustainable funds outperformed that of non-ESG funds over one, three, five and 10-year time horizons.

Document STBT000020240402ek4300292

Exclusive: Former StanChart PB team head resurfaces at UBP

Priyanka Boghani

251 words

1 April 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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A Singapore-based [former](#) team head at Standard Chartered **Private Bank** has joined Union Bancaire Privee in a similar role, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Ankur Sahni has joined UBP, based in Singapore, where he reports to Eric Morin, region head of Southeast Asia.

A spokesperson from the bank declined to comment.

Sahni joined Standard Chartered in Singapore in 2016. Prior to this role, he was at Barclays and Citibank Singapore. He has also worked at Citi's India branch, as well as at Indian wealth manager Amadeus.

UBP saw a 6.4% [rise](#) in net profits last year, though global assets under management fell marginally. The bank said it was committed to key geographies including Asia, with its global CEO stating that it made 'a number of new hires in 2023' in the region to show its commitment.

Indeed, the bank stood out for its aggressive hiring in 2023, picking up **private bankers** of varying seniority for its Greater China and Southeast Asia desks. The new hires generated over half of the **private bank**'s net inflows in 2023, Asia chief, Michael Blake, [told](#) Citywire Asia in a CEO Captain interview.

The bank also bolstered its investment services team, creating new roles for Hong Kong and Singapore heads in a move to address local investment needs more effectively.

Blake said UBP is now looking to build a strong foothold in the family office sector and bolster its private markets offering.

Document CWIRAS0020240401ek410002t

StanChart global wealth head Van de Walle quits

James Phillipps

209 words

28 March 2024

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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Standard Chartered global **wealth management** boss Marc Van de Walle has quit the bank.

Singapore-based Van de Walle (pictured), who also heads deposits and mortgages, had been at the British lender for nearly four years.

He said he will now 'contemplate the next chapter of [his] career', in a LinkedIn post on 28 March.

A spokesperson from the bank confirmed his departure to pursue other opportunities.

Van de Walle previously spent more than 11 years at the Bank of Singapore, where he was latterly global head of products. Before that, he was head of **wealth management** at OCBC, where he worked for over five years.

In an exclusive interview with Citywire Asia [last July](#), Van de Walle said the bank's business priorities included maintaining a top three **wealth manager** position in Asia and further strengthening its market spot in Africa and the Middle East. He also emphasised the importance of banks digitising their services and offering advisory, rather than just transactional, services.

His departure is in line with a string of leadership changes at **private banks** in Asia in the last few months, including the Asia heads at JP Morgan **Private Bank**, HSBC **Private Banking** and Deutsche Bank.

Document CWIRME0020240401ek3s00003

Two ex-Credit Suisse Greater China team leaders resurface at BoS and DBS

Priyanka Boghani

368 words

27 March 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Two former Credit Suisse Greater China team leaders, who left the bank in Hong Kong amid several [departures](#) during the integration with UBS, have joined Singaporean **private banks**, DBS and Bank of Singapore.

Alex Law has joined Bank of Singapore as its team head for Greater China and Shin-Yi Jeng has joined DBS **Private Bank** as a senior market head.

Law reports to Irene Wat, market head, Greater China, Hong Kong branch, who also joined from Credit Suisse, in February. Jeng reports to Carol Wu, DBS Bank's head of **private banking** in Hong Kong, Macau, mainland China and Taiwan.

Both joined their respective banks earlier this year.

Spokespeople from Bank of Singapore and DBS confirmed the hires.

Law had been with Credit Suisse for over a decade before moving to Bank of Singapore, while Jeng was at the Swiss bank for more than four years. Before Credit Suisse, Jeng worked at UBS Global **Wealth Management** for almost 14 years where she was in various roles, including desk head, China International, and UHNW desk head for Greater China, among others. She had previously spent over six years at Citi **Private Bank**.

Law and Jeng were part of a slew of **private bankers** who left UBS in Hong Kong. They include [Victor Chao](#), who has since joined RBC **Wealth Management** as its North Asia head; Edith Wong, who is now at HSBC Global **Private Banking** and former Hong Kong CEO Rickie Chan, who is Bank of Singapore's new Hong Kong head. Martin Loh, who was a market group head for the Greater China and Taiwan markets, left last year to join BNP Paribas **Wealth Management**.

UBS Global **Wealth Management**'s two Asia co-heads, Amy Lo and Jin Yee Young, [said](#) there were bound to be overlaps between the two markets covered by UBS and Credit Suisse. Young said she has 'allowed dual coverage' when a client of a specific size wants both UBS and Credit Suisse bankers.

The co-heads said the overlap has been in the low double-digits in the UHNW space and minimal in the high-net-worth space.

Document CWIRAS0020240327ek3r0002t

HSBC searches for new **wealth management** tech provider after dropping SEI

Victoria Bell
398 words
27 March 2024
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English

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HSBC is on the hunt for a new technology provider to build a **wealth management** platform for its **private banking** division.

HSBC Global **Private Banking**, which currently uses Avaloq as its core banking technology provider, is seeking a technology partner to work alongside it on a platform across several regions, sources have told Citywire.

The project is the bank's second attempt at building a private wealth platform after it terminated a £150m (\$190m) contract it had with US tech and asset manager SEI in 2019. This resulted in the bank paying SEI an \$88m termination fee to exit the contract in 2022, according to company filings.

HSBC GBP offers a **wealth management** service which includes intergenerational wealth planning, trust administration and access to private assets such as private equity funds.

The original plan was to have a private wealth platform across nine jurisdictions – the UK, Luxembourg, France, Germany, the US, Hong Kong, the Channel Islands, Switzerland and Sweden.

As it stands, these jurisdictions are run out of HSBC's London base, but all of the systems are separate, with no correspondence between each other, a source said.

Additionally, each jurisdiction has a CEO. A new private wealth platform would bring all of them together, as well as introducing a centralised system for client reporting on derivatives, private equity, hedge funds and other investments.

According to one industry source, the project with SEI did not work due to its complexity, partly because it spanned multiple locations.

With Covid-19 hitting shortly after the contract was signed, everything had to be contained within each jurisdiction. Teams could not go to other countries, so the conversations took place online and language barriers caused additional complications.

Another factor, the source said, was that HSBC did not put enough staff on the project. It cut 35,000 jobs globally the same year.

In recent years, HSBC has been rolling out its global **private banking** arm in various countries. Last year, the bank launched the service in India and the previous year, expanded across various cities in China.

It is pursuing a strategy of expansion in Asia – where the bulk of its profit comes from – and in high-margin services including **wealth management** as it sheds under-performing consumer businesses in other parts of the world.

HSBC and SEI declined to comment.

Document CWIRAS0020240327ek3r00002

Euromoney **Private Banking** Awards: Singapore's best domestic **private bank**: DBS

296 words

25 March 2024

Euromoney

EURMY

English

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DBS wins the award for Singapore's best domestic **private bank** for the second consecutive year in recognition of its regional expertise, as well as the strength and sophistication of its wealth management offering.

Private Banking Awards

Full Results

March 22, 2024

DBS wins the award for Singapore's best domestic **private bank** for the second consecutive year in recognition of its regional expertise, as well as the strength and sophistication of its wealth management offering.

This overall strength was shown in many areas, especially family office services and succession planning, where the bank also wins awards this year.

DBS leverages its One-Bank model, allowing clients to draw on its capabilities across capital markets, institutional banking, treasury and markets, and asset management. This collaborative power can lead to innovative solutions to complex client needs. One such was the structuring of trustee and custody solutions for clients keen to trade digital assets on the DBS Digital Exchange. This collaborative power can lead to innovative solutions to complex client needs

Other stand out initiatives for the bank in the past year came in sustainability and investment.

In March, DBS announced the first close of the Asia Impact First Fund, which it launched with Heritas Capital to help scale up innovative social enterprises across Asia. As anchor investor, DBS committed 50% of the initial fund raise, alongside other impact-focused parties and clients, including the Tsao Family Office, IMC Group and the Ishk Tolaram Foundation.

During the broad market volatility of last year, the bank's chief investment office and discretionary team responded by relaunching the CIO Liquid+ Fund, providing clients with a diversified, high-quality and liquid investment portfolio as a safeguard from the turbulence.

Document EURMY00020240415ek3p00006

Euromoney Private Banking Awards: Singapore's best for family-office services: DBS

316 words

25 March 2024

Euromoney

EURMY

English

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DBS wins the award for its strength and innovative leadership in serving family office clients in Singapore.

Private Banking Awards

Full Results

March 22, 2024

DBS wins the award for its strength and innovative leadership in serving family office clients in Singapore.

The bank provides families with a full range of services, expertise and capabilities, a strength which has helped it onboard over a third of all the 700 single family offices set up in Singapore.

Much of this inbound demand has come from families from north Asia, Europe, the US and the Middle East, business which has more than doubled the bank's family office assets under management in the past couple of years. This business also led to new asset injections last year of over S\$1 billion (\$750 million) from trust structures established with DBS Trustee Limited. DBS became the first private bank to launch a multi-family office structuring proposition to leverage Singapore's VCC regime

Expanding its capabilities and demonstrating its innovation, DBS last year became the first private bank to launch a multi-family office structuring proposition to leverage Singapore's Variable Capital Company (VCC) regime. VCCs are a new legal entity structure for all types of investment funds in Singapore. They can be formed as a single standalone fund or as an umbrella fund with two or more sub-funds, each holding different assets.

The exotically titled DBS Multi Family Office Foundry VCC has been established as an umbrella VCC with multiple underlying sub-funds.

At its simplest, it offers affluent families an alternative option to manage their wealth in Singapore, without having to establish their own single family office. Through DBS MFOF, clients are able to access a full suite of investment services – such as investment management, trade execution and custody – via a single integrated platform.

Document EURMY00020240415ek3p00007

Euromoney Private Banking Awards: Singapore's best for succession planning: DBS

205 words

25 March 2024

Euromoney

EURMY

English

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DBS wins the award for its expertise in succession planning.

Private Banking Awards

Full Results

March 22, 2024

DBS wins the award for its expertise in succession planning.

In advising clients on safeguarding legacies and future changes, the bank can draw on expertise from across the group to deliver the best wealth management and corporate finance solutions to clients.

One area of distinction is DBS's ability to incorporate digital assets into succession plans. The bank's trustee subsidiary has been able to capture client demand for this through a pioneering trust solution, enabling private clients to invest, custody and manage their digital assets in a secure way with the backing of a highly regulated institution. One area of distinction is DBS's ability to incorporate digital assets into succession plans

Advising the next generation is another important area of succession planning that DBS is heavily invested in. Its Future Leaders Programme last year, for example, served as a platform for aspiring young leaders to explore trends and connect with their peers.

Some 28 participants from southeast Asia, north Asia and Europe took part in the three-day programme titled Preserving Legacy, Challenging Convention.

Document EURMY00020240415ek3p00008

Euromoney **Private Banking** Awards: Singapore's best for next-gen: UOB **Private Bank**

189 words

25 March 2024

Euromoney

EURMY

English

© Copyright 2024 Euromoney Institutional Investor plc.

UOB **Private Bank** wins this award for its commitment to and investment in supporting next generation clients.

Private Banking Awards

Full Results

March 22, 2024

UOB **Private Bank** wins this award for its commitment to and investment in supporting next generation clients.

At the heart of this is the bank's long running next-gen educational and training programme, which is structured around the themes of entrepreneurship, digital innovation and technology.

The programme is ultimately designed to serve as a strategic and dynamic guide to help support next-gen clients deepen their knowledge and understanding of finance, wealth management, entrepreneurship and innovation, succession planning, and family businesses. At the heart ... is the bank's long running next-gen educational and training programme

As part of this programme, participants can benefit from exclusive internship opportunities with partners such as FinLab, which operates an acceleration programme focused on propelling the growth of innovative fintech and technology companies.

After the programme finishes, participants are enrolled into the bank's growing alumni network, which supports continuous learning and skills enhancement.

Document EURMY00020240415ek3p00005

Straits Times Breaking News

Banking

DBS targets Asia's mass affluent market with digital financial planning

Prisca Ang

1,268 words

25 March 2024

The Straits Times

STIMES

English

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SINGAPORE - DBS Bank is eyeing a larger slice of Asia's burgeoning mass affluent market as it aims to bring its digital financial planning solutions to customers in the region.

Mr Shee Tse Koon, group head of DBS' consumer banking group and **wealth management**, told The Straits Times that the plan is to quadruple the number of mass affluent individual investors who can access the bank's financial advice and solutions in its markets by 2026.

There has been a clear shift of wealth to Asia, which has benefited from a flight to safety amid geopolitical tensions and the recent banking sector turmoil in the United States and Europe, he said.

Investors are also seeking opportunities in the region, where customers are becoming more affluent in line with rapid economic growth.

"It's no longer just about the ultra-high net worth; there are more and more people getting wealthier and wealthier," said Mr Shee, who took on his current role in April 2023 and was previously DBS' country head for Singapore.

The bank's customers here can access its digital financial planning tool, which was previously called Nav Planner, via their digibank app's Plan tab. They can use the app's features to map out their finances in areas such as savings, investments, insurance and retirement planning.

Launched in 2020, the tool leverages artificial intelligence and machine learning to give advice to users based on their financial data and risk profile, and offer personalised suggestions on how to invest and manage their money.

Mr Shee said DBS will soon be rolling out similar digital financial advisory solutions to customers in its overseas markets via the bank's respective apps and platforms there.

Singapore customers can also use the national SGFinDex digital service to pool their financial information from public agencies and other financial institutions, and get a consolidated view of their holdings via DBS' planning tool. Those who engage with the nudges the tool sends out have saved about 80 per cent more than non-users. They have also invested about four times more and are two times more insured, he said.

DBS' wealth planning and relationship managers will get these nudges, which they can use to advise their clients, he said, adding: "We are now at the stage to scale these financial planning capabilities across the rest of the markets."

There are nuances between various markets in areas like macroeconomic developments and regulatory requirements. "But the key is, once we have a tool and the technology, it's a lot easier for us to be able to input (customers' financial data) and let the tool help us with a consistent approach." Mr Shee Tse Koon said DBS will soon be rolling out similar digital financial advisory tools to customers in its overseas markets via the bank's respective apps and platforms there. PHOTO: DBS

Fee income from the **wealth management** business is set to become more crucial for DBS and other banks, which have seen tailwinds from high interest rates fade amid higher funding costs and muted demand for loans.

The US Federal Reserve is also expected to make three rate cuts in 2024, which will eventually lead to a further drop in banks' margins here.

DBS, South-east Asia's largest bank, plans to bring its digital advisory capabilities from Singapore to its other core markets of Hong Kong, Taiwan, India and Indonesia, as well as Thailand, a growing market for the bank. More On This Topic DBS's sustainable financing commitments reach \$70 billion DBS gets licence to underwrite non-financial corporate bonds in China

Mass affluent customers, those generally considered by DBS to have at least \$50,000 a year in assets under management (AUM), present huge opportunities overseas. Such customers contribute to 80 per cent of total wealth in Taiwan, 60 per cent in Hong Kong, and 46 per cent in Thailand and in Indonesia, according to 2021 research by business consultancy Capgemini.

DBS completed its acquisition of Citigroup's consumer banking business in Taiwan in August 2023, becoming the largest foreign bank by assets there. The business contributed \$12 billion in deposits and \$10 billion in loans to DBS in 2023.

Affluent customers usually hold accounts with international banks, besides domestic lenders, which benefits players like DBS.

"Apart from the deposits, we also saw investment AUM upon integration grow to about three times what we used to have," said Mr Shee, adding that bancassurance is another area that has benefited from the move.

"With all of that as a baseline, I don't think it's difficult to guess why we want to bring (our financial advisory capabilities) into Taiwan... this will help our existing customers and those we have acquired through the integration, and at the same time, allow us to tap into the broader Taiwanese market."

Thailand is another market DBS is focusing on. In February, its securities business said it will introduce the bank's hybrid robo-adviser digiPortfolio as part of efforts to expand beyond brokerage services, in areas such as **wealth management** and advisory.

Noting that Thai customers have no lack of options when it comes to brokerages, Mr Shee said: "Our differentiation comes from the fact that... we can use our (financial planning) capabilities to make it more structured for customers. It's not about a product push or inundating of information, but about helping them through this journey."

Besides scaling up its digital advisory tools, the bank plans to expand its network of partnerships to reach more retail customers.

It has grown the consumer finance business in recent years through such partnerships - for example, it works with Chinese e-commerce company JD.com, and South-east Asian "buy now, pay later" platform Kredivo to offer lending solutions to these firms' customers.

Mr Shee said: "We are also trying to leverage this concept of looking for meaningful ecosystem partners to scale our investment agenda."

"In Indonesia, for example, over the next couple of months, we will be launching partnerships where we are embedding our investment products with one of these ecosystem partners to be distributed to a broader group of customers." More On This Topic Piyush Gupta must act fast to cement his legacy at DBS DBS rents Hong Kong shop for 18% less to target rich Chinese

At home, DBS also has its work cut out. Only around 20 per cent or so of customers who are in their first jobs invest in products such as managed solutions, equities and T-bills.

Market uncertainty in recent years could be a reason for this, along with a lack of knowledge on how to invest, said Mr Shee. "It's very important that customers take a structured approach (to investing) rather than a trading approach, and to first understand their overall financial health."

There are also plenty of opportunities for the bank to help customers plan for retirement, he said, noting that in 2025, DBS' markets will make up more than half of the world's "super-aged" nations, where the share of the population aged 65 and above reaches 21 per cent.

He added: "It's more critical than ever, now, for people to start participating in the markets. Of course, it's important to save, but there will be times when interest rates go into a low interest rate environment, and deposits will not be sufficient to tackle inflation challenges."

"At the same time, they are missing out on compounding gains, which is very important for that runway for retirement."

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Bank of Singapore hires former Credit Suisse exec as Greater China COO

Tyler Pathe

203 words

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FinTech Futures News

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Bank of Singapore (BoS) has appointed former Credit Suisse exec Ronnie Cheung as its new chief operating officer (COO) of Greater China, effective 19 March.

[Ronnie Cheung joins Bank of Singapore as COO of Greater China](#)

Operating as the private banking subsidiary of Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation (OCBC) since its \$1.46 billion acquisition from ING Group in 2009, BoS says it has tasked Cheung with heading operations and governance for its Hong Kong branch, which is headed by chief executive Cindy Wong, and helping to drive the company's expansion across Greater China.

She will also be responsible for "spearheading transformation efforts and the execution of key strategic initiatives in the region", according to the bank's latest statement.

Cheung will leverage two decades of industry experience in her new role. She joins the firm from Credit Suisse, where she has been serving as COO of Hong Kong since mid-2021.

Her appointment comes amid a restructuring of the branch's leadership following the appointments of Rickie Chan, also formerly of Credit Suisse, as head of private banking, and Teresa Lee as vice chair of Greater China, which both took effect last month.

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IWD: Standard Chartered WM's global COO talks about the trade-off

Priyanka Boghani

514 words

11 March 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Australian citizen, Singapore-based, with a husband in Hong Kong – Standard Chartered Wealth Management's global chief operating officer Pamela Tseng has made an intentional decision to live like this and make it work, particularly as her priorities and her perspectives have changed over time. She retells her journey, including her risk-taking moments.

Tseng (pictured) has been the British lender's global wealth management division COO for more than three years. Prior to this, she was at Citi, working in various roles at the private bank and consumer group for over a decade.

She said earlier in her career, she was very goal and career-orientated and this was how success was defined for her.

'What you think is success in your early 20s is different to how you define it now,' she said. 'In my early 20s, it was about achieving specific goals, like getting a promotion.'

However, she made a pivotal decision early in her career which taught her to how to handle tough situations and prepared her for the different environments she would experience.

Tseng joined Accenture in Singapore right after college. She learned about technology and transformation and could have continued the path of a management consultant, but she decided to take a risk.

'An opportunity came for me to be in China. In 2002, China was different from the China of today. It meant I had to localise and adapt to a professional environment that was influenced by state-owned enterprises (SOEs). Localising also meant a pay cut and going to live in an unfamiliar place,' she said.

'Many people thought I was crazy, but I stayed incredibly focused. I worked with large SOEs and spent countless hours pouring over the bilingual dictionary. It was a lot of hard work and a big risk, but it taught me to how to be resilient.'

Tseng said her experience trying to succeed in a foreign place helped shape her views of how to handle challenges – something a woman in the workplace is never short of experiencing.

Now, the mother of a nine-year-old and a 10-year-old manages her work and her family time in a balance that works for her. The definition of success, as a result, has changed too.

'I do not define success by my career accomplishments. It's far more holistic, and includes creating a healthy and balanced lifestyle, working with people that you care about and overall creating a more fulfilling role,' she said.

Sometimes, Tseng will miss the window to use the gym or go for a swim in the day, so she will put her children to bed and hit the gym at 10pm sometimes. There are also times when she has to be with her children, especially if it's a school excursion and will therefore not make a work meeting.

'It's a trade-off! You can have it all, but just not all at once,' she said, quoting her favourite line from Oprah Winfrey.

Document CWIRAS0020240312ek3b00003



Business

HSBC woos Asia's ultra-rich to set up **family offices** in Hong Kong with suite of digital and wealth planning services

Enoch Yiu

668 words

11 March 2024

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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* Many ultra-high-net-worth customers from mainland China, Asean and the Middle East are keen to set up **family offices** in Hong Kong, HSBC's Lok Yim says

* HSBC's invested assets from **private bank** customers in Asia rose 18 per cent year on year to US\$166 billion as of end-2023

HSBC, Hong Kong's biggest lender, plans to increase the visibility of its **family office** and digital banking services to attract ultra-high-net-worth clients to its **private banking** unit, according to a senior executive.

"We have seen a strong growth in ultra-high-net-worth customers in the Asia-Pacific region, particularly in mainland China, India, Indonesia, the Philippines and Australia in recent years, who demand wealth management services," said Lok Yim, the newly appointed head of HSBC global **private banking** in Asia-Pacific.

To tap these clients, HSBC will offer a suite of digital solutions to support relationship managers to better serve tech-savvy customers round the clock, Yim said. The bank will also provide investment and wealth planning services for wealthy families and individuals to set up **family offices** in Hong Kong.

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Ultra-high-net-worth individuals have a net worth of at least US\$30 million.

"Many ultra-high-net-worth individuals and families in mainland China, Asean and the Middle East have been showing strong interest in setting up **family offices** in Hong Kong after the government offered a wide range of incentives and promotions to entice them," he said.

"Hong Kong is a natural choice for ultra-high net worth customers to set up **family offices** to diversify their investment portfolio, for succession planning and conducting philanthropy work to pass on their families' legacy."

Hong Kong also has a big talent pool, Yim added.

The government launched the Capital Investment Entrant Scheme on March 1, commonly known as the investment-migration scheme, offering a faster route to residency for people who invest at least HK\$30 million (US\$3.84 million) in stocks, bonds or other assets, excluding residential property.

This was preceded by a tax break in May and a slew of roadshows by top government officials in Asia and Middle East last year to entice wealthy families to set up **family offices** in the city.

Chief Executive John Lee Ka-chiu, in October 2022, set a target to have at least 200 new large **family offices** set up in the city by 2025, to add to the nearly 400 firms already here.

Asian ultra-high-net-worth customers have been the main contributors to the growth of HSBC's **private banking** business. HSBC's invested assets from **private banking** customers in Asia rose 18 per cent year on year to US\$166 billion as of end of 2023, with ultra-high-net-worth customers contributing half.

Yim, a **private banker** with more than 30 years' experience, took over the current role from the outgoing Siew Meng Tan in January. Yim joined HSBC from Deutsche Bank where he spent 16 years, most recently as CEO of Hong Kong. He also held senior roles at Citigroup and has a master's degree in arts from University of Cambridge.

On whether the underperforming stocks markets in Hong Kong and mainland China would affect the city's role as a wealth management hub, Yim said diversification is the key to success.

"Wealthy customers can still use the city to invest in international markets and diversify their portfolio," he said.

"They not only need investment services, but also require HSBC's corporate banking and retail banking services for their businesses, children's education and other needs."

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Companies

HSBC makes key hires to boost growth in ultra-high-net-worth market in Asia

Vivienne, HSBC makes key hires to boost growth in ultra-high-net-worth market in Asia

489 words

9 March 2024

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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HSBC Global **Private Banking** has made two senior hires for a dedicated team serving the bank's ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) clients.

The bank appointed Kerri Lim as head of the UHNW segment for Asia. Her job in spearheading the UHNW growth strategy in the region includes delivering bespoke wealth products, platforms and solutions. Her role takes effect on Monday (Mar 11).

She will report to HSBC's UHNW global head Caroline Kitidis on a functional basis and to Lavanya Chari, the bank's global head of investments and wealth solutions, on an entity basis.

Kitidis said: "We expanded our Asia team to allow us to better nurture long-lasting and rewarding client relationships in this underserved market."

Lim joins HSBC from UBS, where she was most recently head of business development for global family institutional wealth in the Asia-Pacific. She has over 20 years of experience spanning client-relationship management, technology, and programme management with global financial institutions such as Morgan Stanley and Credit Suisse.

HSBC's other senior-level hire is Pritash Mathur, who will be head of family office coverage for global India and global South Asia. Reporting to Lim, he will be responsible for HSBC's UHNW growth strategy in India and South Asia, and work with the bank's market heads in India, the Asia-Pacific, the Middle East and North Africa, and Europe.

He has more than two decades of experience in **private banking** and joins from an extensive stint at HSBC Hong Kong and Singapore, where he played a key role in launching the bank's India **private-banking** business. Before HSBC, he worked at Credit Suisse in Singapore, Zurich and India, where he set up the India onshore **private bank** in 2008.

Lim and Mathur will be based in Singapore, HSBC noted.

Their appointments follow two hires in the fourth quarter of 2023: Edith Wong, head of the UHNW segment in North Asia, and Sam Wong, development manager of the UHNW segment in Asia. Both report to Lim.

Lok Yim, HSBC's regional head of global **private banking** in the Asia-Pacific, said: "We are beyond a **private bank** for ultra-high-net-worth clients and family offices. The strong collaboration across diverse lines of business within HSBC Group enables a comprehensive one-stop banking experience, and this team will play a vital role in capturing growth opportunities in the region.

"Kerri, Pritash, Edith and Sam each offer their deep understanding of client needs, along with strong market acumen and expertise in different aspects of investment, wealth and legacy planning."

The bank has appointed Kerri Lim as head of the ultra-high-net-worth segment for Asia. She will spearhead the growth strategy in the region. PHOTO: HSBC

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StanChart China halts outbound investments via QDII for clients

Priyanka Boghani

481 words

28 February 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Standard Chartered has suspended new investments by its China clients into offshore products through an outbound scheme, Reuters reported.

The Qualified Domestic Institutional Investor (QDII) scheme, introduced in 2006, helps banks, brokerages, and asset managers to bypass China's capital controls and invest abroad. Standard Chartered launched its first QDII product – UBS Global Allocation Index Principal Protected Structure Investment – in December 2006.

'Standard Chartered China has suspended the subscription of relevant products for commercial reasons,' a spokesperson from Standard Chartered confirmed.

The scheme also helps Chinese wealthy and corporate clients invest in offshore funds, bonds and other structured products.

Largely institutional clients tend to participate in QDII facilities via onshore funds, and therefore the suspension is likely to affect the institutional side of the business rather than **private banking** side, one source close to the matter said, on the condition of anonymity.

'This news will not affect the [bank's] **private banking** side that much as the QDII quota is not that big a portion of [the bank's] **private banking** business in Hong Kong,' the source said.

Standard Chartered sent out a note to its clients last week saying it would not accept new subscriptions into offshore-domiciled funds through the QDII programme, the Reuters report said.

'I'm not surprised – it's just another indicator of how unpredictable the investment environment is in China right now,' said a Hong Kong-based asset management head.

Domestic investor appetite for outbound investments has grown due to China's lacklustre stock market performance, a debt-ridden property sector and the yuan's renewed depreciation.

The CSI 300 and the Shanghai Composite indices are down 14% and 8% over the past 12 months, respectively.

QDII quotas

Overseas securities investment by domestic residents through the Hong Kong Stock Connect and QDII channels reached nearly \$100bn, according to a January 2022 press conference held by the State Administration of Foreign Exchange (Safe).

'Investments other than direct and portfolio investments exceeded \$310bn, indicating that domestic entities were relatively abundant in foreign exchange and had increased their deposits and loans overseas,' according to a statement from Safe.

Since September 2020, the Safe has granted a few rounds of quotas to 173 institutions through the scheme, including in 2021 when the country's foreign exchange regulator expanded quotas to meet the growing demand of domestic investors. Around \$10.3bn in quotas was granted to 17 institutions under the QDII programme.

In its latest earnings call, Standard Chartered's Bill Winters spoke about 'seizing the China opportunity', particularly with the reopening of the borders.

'Our strategy is to capture trade, investment and wealth flows and the financial markets activity that derive from this opening of China's economy,' he said, adding that the bank's offshore income is growing at a faster clip than its domestic China income.

Hong Kong stocks

Standard Chartered's Wealth Management Connect (Southbound) products have increased to nearly 550 models

127 words

26 February 2024

GuruClub Live - English

GCLIEN

English

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Guru Club, February 26 | Cross-boundary Wealth Management Connect 2.0 was officially launched today, and Standard Chartered Hong Kong and Standard Chartered China immediately launched multiple new products on "Southbound Connect" and "Northbound Connect" respectively. This includes increasing the number of financial products offered by Southbound to nearly 550, covering medium to high risk and funds primarily invested in the Greater China stock market, as well as low to medium risk bonds. "Northbound Connect" will add RMB deposit products and over 40 publicly offered securities investment funds with a risk level of "R4", covering new economic industries such as new consumption, new energy, new infrastructure, new manufacturing, and new technology.

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Business

Greater Bay Area: HSBC, Standard Chartered increase **Wealth Management Connect products amid drive to promote cross-border investment**

Yuke Xie

752 words

26 February 2024

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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* It comes a month after the PBOC and HKMA announced six measures to strengthen financial cooperation between the mainland and Hong Kong

* Beijing is striving to boost the bay area's financial markets and promote capital flow across borders

Banks in Hong Kong including HSBC and Standard Chartered Bank are rolling out more [products tied to the **Wealth Management** Connect scheme](#) amid a drive by Beijing to boost the Greater Bay Area's financial markets and [promote capital flow across borders](#).

Their moves come a month after the People's Bank of China (PBOC) and the Hong Kong Monetary Authority (HKMA) announced six measures to [strengthen financial cooperation](#) between the mainland and Hong Kong.

One of those was to enhance the cross-boundary **Wealth Management** Connect scheme in the bay area development zone.

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Launched in 2021, the mechanism allows residents of Hong Kong, Macau and nine cities in Guangdong province to invest directly in designated [wealth management products](#) across borders.

New rules took effect on February 26 raising the individual investment quota from 1 million yuan (US\$138,923) to 3 million yuan and adding yuan-denominated deposit products of mainland banks – moves viewed by lenders as creating more business opportunities.

HSBC announced on Monday that it has increased the number of products it offers for both northbound and southbound investments via the scheme to over 400 from 270.

The expanded product offerings include more than 100 mutual funds investing in Asia and global markets, allowing southbound investors – those in mainland China eyeing Hong Kong's capital markets – to diversify their portfolios and tap international assets.

The lender's enhancements, effective from Monday, allow all existing retail investors to invest up to 3 million yuan through the scheme, up from 1 million previously, the bank said in a press release.

"The latest enhancement to the [**Wealth Management** Connect mechanism] has further increased the attractiveness of the scheme, fuelling investments and promoting even deeper integration of the financial sector in the GBA," said Daniel Chan, head of the Greater Bay Area at HSBC.

A recent survey conducted by the lender found that roughly two-thirds of over 2,000 residents in the 11 cities of the bay area believed improvements to the cross-border scheme, including a relaxed entry threshold, more diverse investment options, and the higher individual investment quota, will encourage them to start investing via the scheme or up their existing investments.

Chan said wealth planning and advisory services are key factors in driving retail participation in the scheme.

Hang Seng Bank, a subsidiary of HSBC, announced on the same day that it too will widen its **wealth management** product offerings tied to cross-boundary investment, offering about 320 southbound and northbound investment options. That is roughly double the number available at the scheme's inception in 2021, the lender said in a statement.

"The enhancements to the **Wealth Management** Connect scheme open up new avenues for growth in the **wealth management** sector," said Rannie Lee, head of wealth and personal banking at Hang Seng Bank.

Standard Chartered joined the fray on Monday too, announcing it will expand its product offerings via the scheme, allowing southbound investors to choose from close to 550 products, including medium- to high-risk equity funds in China and low- to medium-risk bonds.

Northbound investors – those living in Hong Kong eyeing the mainland's capital markets – will have access to more yuan deposit products, as well as over 40 mutual fund products covering sectors including consumption, energy, infrastructure and manufacturing, the bank said.

The bay area, with a population of over 86 million and gross domestic product in excess of 13 trillion yuan (US\$1.8 trillion) as of 2022, accounts for more than 10 per cent of China's economic output. It is a core part of the country's economic blue print, with Beijing planning to turn the region into a hi-tech, economic powerhouse by 2035.

By the end of 2023, 67 banks and 69,000 investors in the bay area had joined the **Wealth Management** Connect scheme, with cross-boundary remittances amounting to 12.8 billion yuan, according to official data.

Document SCMCOM0020240226ek2q000b9

Stock in news

India brought more profits to HSBC than China in 2023

Joel Rebello

397 words

22 February 2024

The Economic Times

ECTIM

English

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India has replaced China as the third largest profitable region for Hong Kong and Shanghai Banking Corp Ltd (HSBC) led by strong growth in its global banking and markets division which services large corporations and includes treasury operations. HSBC, Europe's largest bank by assets, said its India profit before tax rose 19% to \$1.51 billion in 2023 from \$1.27 billion a year ago behind Hong Kong and the UK, the bank's two largest business regions, results released on Wednesday showed. China's profit plummeted 89% year on year to \$371 million in 2023 from \$3.40 billion in 2022 due to losses the bank suffered in its wealth management, personal banking and corporate centre verticals.

Profit growth in India was also helped by a fall in expected credit loss provisions year on year which dropped to \$51 million from \$90 million in 2022. The global banking & markets division (GBM) the largest revenue stream for the bank in India reported a strong 24% increase in profit to \$774 million in 2023 from \$622 million a year ago. Commercial banking division, which serves small and medium enterprises (SMEs) was the second largest profit division for bank reported a 31% increase in profit before tax to \$398 million from \$304 million a year ago. The bank's corporate centre division, which provides support services to the bank globally reported a 6% drop in profit before tax to \$289 million in 2023 from \$306 million a year ago. Profit from personal banking and wealth management, the smallest business in terms of revenue in India also increased 24% to \$56 million from \$45 million in 2022. The bank said India and Vietnam are among the fastest-growing economies in the world benefiting from competitive labour costs, supportive policies and changing supply chains. "The positions that we have as a leading foreign bank in mainland China, India, Singapore, the UAE, Saudi Arabia and Mexico – all of which are also well connected to our international network – mean we are well placed to capture opportunities in these fast-growing economies," group executive, Noel Quinn said. HSBC has the largest workforce in India of 42,000 out of the 2.21 lakh full-time employees of the bank at the end of 2023.

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Half of HSBC's net new money in 2023 came from Asia

Cheryl Heng

531 words

21 February 2024

Citywire Asia

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English

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More than half of HSBC's \$84bn of net new invested assets came from Asia, its latest annual results reveal.

This comes as the bank's wealth and personal banking division doubled pre-tax profit in 2023.

The British lender reported profit before tax for wealth and personal banking arm was \$11.5bn, doubling from \$5.5bn in 2022. Meanwhile, customer revenue grew 31% to \$27.2bn.

'Performance in 2023 benefited from rising interest rates and balance sheet growth, including wealth deposits,' the annual earnings report, published yesterday, stated.

'There was also positive growth in wealth, including strong sales in insurance and net new invested assets growth,' it said. Wealth revenue in particular grew by 8% to \$7.5bn.

Its fastest-growing segment in WPB was international customers, which generates three times more income compared to domestic customers. This segment contributed 40% of WPB revenue last year.

The unit now has a total of 6.7 million international clients, a 12% year-on-year rise.

Services include helping customers open an international account digitally pre-departure, credit card access in their new market, and cross-border payment solutions.

Total wealth invested assets in 2023 was at \$1.19tn, up 17% from 2022, while wealth deposits from the Premier, Jade and Global **Private Banking** units stood at \$536bn, a 6% increase from the year before.

Net new money of \$84bn attracted last year follows 2022's \$80bn, and \$64bn in 2021. Asia generated \$47bn of net new invested assets in 2023, a dip from \$59bn in 2022.

Asia wealth strategy

Building the bank's wealth business to meet rising demand, especially in Asia, has been a 'strategic priority', according to the annual report.

The acquisition of Citi's retail wealth management portfolio in mainland China announced in October 2023 has further accelerated its wealth strategy, said Mark Tucker, HSBC group chairman. The acquired business will be integrated into HSBC Bank China's WPB operations.

In Hong Kong, the bank continues to grow its WPB business through its [launch of Premier Elite](#) – customers with minimum balance of \$1m with the bank – while acquiring new customers. New-to-bank customers grew by 36% from 2020 to 634,500 last year.

For mainland China, the Citi acquisition, along with its Pinnacle product – which offers mobile insurance and personal wealth planning service – boosted the market's wealth-invested assets by 53% from the year before.

In India, HSBC launched its onshore Global **Private Banking** last July, tapping into the wealth pools of the Indian diaspora. The bank also set up **private banking** operations in the UAE in 2022.

As for Singapore, the bank recorded a 76% jump in new-to-bank international customers compared with 2022, in part due to the launch of its new customer onboarding journey.

On talent, the bank has expanded its [Accelerating Wealth Programme](#), which focuses on developing talent within their workforce, and hiring those with different career background, to bolster the pool of relationship managers.

It opened up the programme to external applicants in Hong Kong last year, and to internal staff in mainland China, India and Singapore.

Document CWIRAS0020240222ek2I00005

Business

investment - Private funds picked for growth in 2024

422 words

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Bangkok Post

BKPOST

English

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The private fund industry is expected to post continued growth this year as demand surges for wealth management and foreign investment emerges as a trend, say fund managers.

In 2023, the industry expanded 10.6% year-on-year with assets under management (AUM) increasing 204 billion baht to 2.17 trillion, most of which was with institutional investors.

According to the Association of Investment Management Companies (AIMC), as of November 2023, 23 investment management companies offered private fund management services totalling 4,256 funds, an increase of 80 funds from 2022.

In terms of net inflows to private funds, One Asset Management reported AUM surged 43.7% to 62.9 billion baht last year, while Talis Asset Management posted an AUM gain of 42% to 42.8 billion.

Krungthai Asset Management reported AUM increased 39.4% to 63 billion baht, followed by SCB Asset Management, whose AUM rose 20.9% to 648 billion.

UOB Asset Management posted an AUM gain of 25.5% to 55.9 billion baht.

Four asset management firms reported a lower AUM: Bangkok Capital, Xspring Asset Management, Kasikorn Asset Management and Kiatnakin Asset Management, whose AUM fell by 12.8%, 25.4%, 0.77% and 1.9%, respectively.

AIA Investment Management (Thailand) held the highest market share in the private fund industry, with AUM of 730 billion baht, representing a 33.6% share.

Most of the assets were from AIA Thailand, the country's leading life insurer, which included unit-linked life insurance policies.

SCB Asset Management ranked second with AUM of 648 billion baht and a market share 29.9%, followed by Kasikorn Asset Management with AUM of 187 billion and a 8.62% market share.

Krungsri Asset Management ranked fourth with AUM of 118 billion baht and a 5.45% market share, followed by Tisco Asset Management with AUM of 74.8 billion and a 3.45% share.

The AIMC said the increased value of private funds last year was attributed to corporations, government institutions, insurance companies, universities and savings cooperatives.

Personal income tax collection on income from overseas investment transferred back to Thailand, which takes effect this year, is not expected to affect the private fund industry much as not many individuals invest overseas via private funds, said the association.

"The new rule is likely to have a positive impact on the mutual fund business because several groups of investors will opt to invest through mutual funds, which are not subject to the tax," AIMC noted.

Document BKPOST0020240212ek2c00002

Exclusive: DBS Private Bank hires investment specialists for Thailand from CS

Priyanka Boghani

194 words

9 February 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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DBS Private Bank continues to beef up its onshore and offshore Thailand teams, hiring product specialists and relationship managers from Credit Suisse, Citywire Asia understands.

DBS PB Onshore Thailand will bring onboard two senior investment consultants to cover private fund mandates. Snitra Danaitangtrakul and Thomas Wood are joining DBS Private Bank in Thailand from Credit Suisse. They are slated to join the bank in March.

In Singapore, Citywire Asia understands that Petcharat Wee has already joined from Credit Suisse as a relationship manager.

A spokesperson from DBS declined to comment on the hires.

The news comes as Khun Tanit Paochinda and Khun Krittima Leekpai are also going to join DBS Private Bank's onshore Thai team from Credit Suisse this month.

They will report to Edwin Tan, who is set to join DBS Private Bank as a market head, likely covering the Thailand, Vietnam and Philippines markets.

In October, UBS GWM confirmed it was shuttering Credit Suisse's onshore Thailand business. As a result, former Credit Suisse private bankers have been resurfacing at various onshore banks, including BNP Paribas Wealth Management.

Document CWIRAS0020240209ek2900003

Former StanChart managed solutions head resurfaces at Nomura

Cheryl Heng

176 words

5 February 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Nomura International Wealth Management has hired Standard Chartered's Connie Sin as head of managed investments.

Based in Hong Kong, Sin will lead the bank's managed investments teams of specialists across all IWM sites, overseeing sales, advisory services and product development, according to her LinkedIn post on 5 February.

Sin was previously head of managed solutions at Standard Chartered, overseeing its managed investments business across its retail and private banks. She left the British lender in the middle of last year.

Before that, she was at BNP Paribas Wealth Management for about six years, and latterly as a senior investment adviser.

Separately, Nomura is looking to [launch an alternative DPM strategy](#) in the second half of this year, the bank's CIO and DPM head Gareth Nicholson told Citywire Asia in a recent interview.

The bank is also blending its active cash and short-dated bond products into a managed income strategy, dubbed the dynamic fixed income solution, to help clients navigate potential rate cuts next year.

Document CWIRAS0020240205ek2500001

DBS Hong Kong Redefines **Wealth Management Experience for affluent customers in Hong Kong and Mainland China**

Distributed by Contify.com

798 words

2 February 2024

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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DBS Bank (Hong Kong) Limited has opened a new DBS Treasures Centre at 18 Queen's Road Central. The facility aims to provide comprehensive **wealth management** services to high-net-worth individuals in Hong Kong and Mainland China. The centre features a modern and luxurious design and offers smart onboarding, smart appointment, and smart check-in services. DBS Bank is committed to delivering exceptional **wealth management** experiences to its high-net-worth customers and is focused on leveraging modern technology to offer a simple and seamless banking experience. The bank is confident in the growth opportunities in Hong Kong and Mainland China and reaffirms its dedication to these markets.

Key Highlights:

- *DBS Bank (Hong Kong) Limited has opened a new DBS Treasures Centre at 18 Queens Road Central
- * The facility aims to provide **wealth management** services to high-net-worth individuals in Hong Kong and Mainland China
- * The new centre features a modern and luxurious design and is approximately 15,000 sq ft in size
- * DBS Bank is committed to delivering exceptional **wealth management** experiences to its high-net-worth customers
- * The bank is focused on leveraging modern technology to offer a simple and seamless banking experience
- * DBS is transforming its distribution model to become client experience centres
- * The new centre offers smart onboarding, smart appointment, and smart check-in services
- * DBS experienced team of **wealth management** professionals will provide personalized wealth advice to clients
- * The bank is confident in the growth opportunities in Hong Kong and Mainland China
- * DBS Bank reaffirms its dedication to Hong Kong and Mainland China and its commitment to innovative solutions for customers

Original Press Release:

Feb. 2 -- DBS Bank issued the following news release:

- Reimagined DBS Treasures Centre opening at 18 Queen's Road Central

DBS Bank (Hong Kong) Limited today announced the opening of its new DBS Treasures Centre at 18 Queen's Road Central. This world-class facility aims to provide a comprehensive suite of **wealth management** services and solutions to high-net-worth individuals and families in Hong Kong and Mainland China.

"We are excited to unveil our new 18 QRC DBS Treasures Centre, which underscores our commitment to continue delivering exceptional **wealth management** experiences to our high-net-worth customers. This state-of-the-art and purposeful branch allows us to extend advisory beyond wealth and beyond closed rooms," said Ajay Mathur, Head of Consumer Banking Group and **Wealth Management** of DBS Hong Kong. "We have been putting our customers at the centre of everything we do, striving to offer them a simple and seamless banking experience by leveraging modern technology."

Mr. Mathur added, "The bold new banking experience offered at our new **Wealth Management** Centre along with our powerful digital and AI capabilities gives us the confidence to succeed. We are determined in the pursuit of our strategy of gaining share in the region's growing affluence and reiterates our commitment to Hong Kong and the Mainland China."

Maggie Yung, Head of Treasures and Distribution for Consumer Banking Group and **Wealth Management** of DBS Hong Kong, emphasized that banking industry is in a "phygital" era, where banks are merging their physical and digital channels, and DBS is strategically transforming the distribution model from traditional transactional services counters to becoming client experience centres.

"At the new DBS Treasures Centre, we have reimagined our offerings with a prioritization to uplift our customers' journey. With our technology innovation, we ensure our customers seamless O2O experience, such as smart onboarding and smart appointment with smart check-in, and our upgraded facilities and digital capabilities, we enable our customers with borderless engagement. These endeavours exemplify our unwavering commitment to continue enhancing service excellence and exceeding customer expectations throughout their **wealth management** journey with DBS," she added.

This reimagined DBS Treasures Centre is approximately 15,000 sq ft, features a modern and luxurious design and is strategically located at a prime location of Hong Kong's central business district, providing convenient access for all customers.

DBS' experienced team of **wealth management** professionals, with intelligent advisory tools, will be on hand to empower our clients to navigate the complexities of the market, seize opportunities, and achieve their financial aspirations.

Furthermore, a more premium intelligent advisory experience is empowered by data and artificial intelligence technology which enables our relationship managers to offer personalized wealth advice to our customers.

As a leading financial services group, we are confident in the growth opportunities in Hong Kong. The new branch reaffirms our dedication to Hong Kong and the mainland China, and our commitment to bring forward innovative solutions for all our customers.

[Category: Banks, Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Highways & Railtracks, Financial/ Capital Market, Investment Banking & Brokerage, Business Expansion]

Source: DBS Bank

Document ATINBK0020240207ek22000h4

HSBC makes Credit Suisse hire for head of alts EMEA role

Margaryta Kirakosian

279 words

2 February 2024

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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HSBC global **private banking** and wealth has hired Justine Kreis as head of alternatives Europe, Middle East and Africa (EMEA).

Most recently Kreis was at Credit Suisse in Zurich, where she was head of alternative investments for the Swiss bank.

Before that, she worked for UBS Wealth Management in Zurich and BNY Mellon Investment Management in Geneva as head of distribution for the region.

Kreis, who is based in Geneva, will report to Mathieu Forcioli, global and Asia regional head of alternatives, and Karl Faivre, head of investment wealth solutions EMEA and Switzerland.

She replaces Tomislav Culic, who moved to private markets specialist KKR at the end of last year as director of global wealth solutions, Switzerland for the firm.

His appointment was one of multiple wealth and traditional asset management hires big private markets firms have made recently, with Citywire noting 68 of them over the last three years, six coming from HSBC.

Speaking to Citywire at the end of last year, Annabel Spring, head of global **private banking** at HSBC, said she expects more private markets strategies to [make their way](#) into multi-asset portfolios.

Global head of products at the firm, Lavanya Chari, told Citywire last year that [private credit](#) and private equity secondaries are seen as areas of growth for the firm. HSBC **private banking** advises clients on allocations to hedge funds, private markets and real estate.

The bank made several [relationship manager hires](#) in Switzerland last year from UBS, Credit Suisse and Lombard Odier for its EMEA business, which has over 200 relationship managers in the region who look after €153bn in client assets.

Document CWIRME0020240202ek2200002

Standard Chartered presents 2024 market outlook to hundreds of high-net-worth clients

Distributed by Contify.com

987 words

22 January 2024

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Standard Chartered Bank (“the Bank”) recently kicked off its series of market outlook events to share with its clients the myriad economic, political and social factors that can influence global and regional markets, and how clients can navigate them. Over the next few weeks, the Bank will reach out to 5,000 clients with over 20 planned events in markets such as Singapore, Hong Kong, India, Dubai, Bahrain, Kenya and Nigeria across Asia, Africa and the Middle East.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Jan. 22 -- Standard Chartered Bank issued the following news release:

- ESM Goh Chok Tong anchored Singapore event, sharing views on how investors can navigate geopolitics

Standard Chartered Bank (“the Bank”) recently kicked off its series of market outlook events to share with its clients the myriad economic, political and social factors that can influence global and regional markets, and how clients can navigate them. Over the next few weeks, the Bank will reach out to 5,000 clients with over 20 planned events in markets such as Singapore, Hong Kong, India, Dubai, Bahrain, Kenya and Nigeria across Asia, Africa and the Middle East.

Gracing the Singapore event with around 350 clients from its **Private Bank** was ESM Goh Chok Tong, Former Prime Minister of Singapore, who engaged in a lively fireside chat with Steve Brice. ESM Goh shared his views on topics including how geopolitics could play in the markets, and his outlook for Singapore in 2024.

The Bank’s Wealth Management Chief Investment Office (CIO), led by Steve Brice, Group Chief Investment Officer, also presented its house views underpinned by its 2024 Outlook report “Sailing with the wind”.

Against a backdrop of continued challenging economic landscape, the Bank’s CIO recommends investors to build a SAFE foundation:

Secure your yield: With today’s yield levels being one of the big opportunities in 2023, the team is overweight bonds – including government and high-quality corporate bonds – relative to equities and cash.

Allocate to long-term value: The more immediate opportunity in yield levels should be balanced by exposure to longer-term value, which it primarily sees in Asia ex-Japan equity and bond markets. Within Asia ex-Japan, the team is overweight Chinese equities given their inexpensive valuations and positive catalysts. Another attractive asset class is Asia USD bonds.

Fortify against further surprises: A US recession outlook means investors need to be prepared for downside surprises, and high-quality government bonds can be one such mitigant. Cash and gold are also key portfolio ballasts.

Expand beyond the traditional: With the belief that the unusual rise in stock-bond correlations this year is unlikely to last into the next, demand for relatively uncorrelated assets is likely to sustain. Alternative strategies, such as liquid alternative strategies and private asset classes, can help.

Mr Foo Tian Ong, Regional Head of South-east Asia and Singapore Head of **Private Banking** said: “We are thrilled to kickstart the new year with our flagship global market outlook event for our clients as we look for the bright spots in 2024. Expert insights are important for every investment journey, and we thank our clients for making us their trusted wealth advisor as we navigate through turbulent times, identify investment opportunities, and make strategic decisions based on our client’s goals and risk appetite.”

About Standard Chartered Bank

Standard Chartered Bank in Singapore is part of an international banking group, with a presence in 53 of the world's most dynamic markets for more than 160 years and serving clients in a further 64. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

The Bank has a history of 164 years in Singapore, where we opened our first branch in 1859. In October 1999, we were among the first international banks to receive a Qualifying Full Bank (QFB) license, an endorsement of the Group's longstanding commitment to our business in the country.

Singapore is home to the majority of our global business leadership, our technology operations, as well as SC Ventures, our innovation hub. In 2013, the Bank transferred our Singapore Retail and SME businesses to a locally incorporated subsidiary, Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Limited ("SCBSL"). And in May 2019, we fully consolidated our business operations in Singapore through the transfer of our Commercial Banking, Corporate & Institutional Banking and **Private Banking** businesses to SCBSL. SCBSL is one of the highest-rated banks globally: A1/Stable by Moody's Investor Services, A+/Stable by Standard & Poor's and A+/Stable by Fitch Ratings. In August 2020, we were the first and only bank to be awarded the "Significantly Rooted Foreign Bank" (SRFB) status by the Monetary Authority of Singapore. In December 2020, we were granted enhanced SRFB privileges, in recognition of the significantly higher degree of rootedness exceeding the SRFB baseline criteria.

In September 2022, we launched Trust Bank Singapore Limited (Trust), our digital bank venture in partnership with FairPrice Group. Trust offers a wide range of products and features for retail customers, including credit cards, personal loans, savings accounts, insurance and money insights. Within its first year, Trust amassed over 600,000 customers, equivalent to 12% of the Singapore market, making it one of the world's fastest-growing digital banks.

In Singapore, we support both individual and corporate needs to build wealth and drive commerce at every step of their journey. We do this by offering an entire range of financial services across personal, priority and **private banking** as well as our business, and corporate, commercial & institutional banking teams. The Bank has a network which include 11 branches, 4 Priority Banking centres, 1 International Banking and Priority Private Centre and 20 ATMs. For more information, please visit www.sc.com/sg.

Source: Standard Chartered Bank

[Category: Events]

Document ATINBK0020240125ek1m000b9

HSBC ramps up digital offerings for clients and bankers

Priyanka Boghani

529 words

18 January 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC is seeing an uptick in digital channel usage among its clients and has beefed up its internal platforms as part of its overall investment in technology.

On the client side, the bank said around 90% of its retail wealth transactions in Hong Kong between 1 January and 31 October were conducted entirely or partly through digital channels.

'More wealth customers are engaging with us through self-directed digital channels,' said Maggie Ng (pictured below), HSBC Hong Kong's head of wealth and personal banking.

<figure></figure>

The bank has expanded its product suite so investors can access multi-asset investments, mutual funds, structured products, and discretionary mandates as well as activate a Lombard loan facility via digital channels.

In 2023, the bank also rolled out more than 300 new digital features on mobile apps.

The bank has made a slew of additions to its technology platform in Asia over the years.

Last year, it launched an [artificial intelligence-powered structured product](#) for its wealthy clients in Asia. The **private banking** arm's clients were able to invest in a structured product linked to an AI-driven multi-asset index, branded the Artificial Intelligence Powered Global Opportunities index, developed by HSBC and EquBot. Separately, the bank also launched a digital Lombard lending service for its Premier and then Jade customers in Hong Kong.

HSBC also added fixed coupon notes to its online trading platform for mobile users in 2022, as well as HSBC [Prism Advisory](#), which is powered by BlackRock's Aladdin Wealth risk platform, to offer portfolio recommendations and provide investment data and news to clients.

The bank [launched](#) its discretionary digital platform in Asia to allow **private banking** clients to book assets in Hong Kong and Singapore and reallocate their discretionary portfolio via the HSBC GPB mobile apps, in 2022 as well.

Creating an 'internal LinkedIn'

The bank has also made technology investments in AI-powered tools to enhance the learning experience for its bankers, HSBC's global head of HR, wealth and personal banking and global functions, Laura Powell (pictured below) said.

'The internal talent marketplace, available to 200,000 colleagues in the bank, provides the opportunity for employees to develop specific skills by connecting them to different internal projects. It's like an internal LinkedIn,' Powell said.

<figure></figure>

She said one example of how the marketplace has been useful to the **private bank** was when a relationship manager was looking to automate a client factsheet production process. They posted a request on the internal marketplace, which resulted in two software engineers in Pune applying for the job and ultimately what was a 30-day process was reduced to just 15 minutes. She said around 177,000 hours had been saved overall through such advances.

The bank has been exploring ways to recruit internally, given the dearth of **private bankers** in the industry. Recently HSBC [piloted](#) its talent acquisition initiative, accelerating wealth programme, in Hong Kong and

Singapore. It has already received more than 400 applicants for positions in the premier and global **private banking** units, the bank told Citywire Asia in an earlier interview.

Document CWIRAS0020240118ek1i00003



Business

Hong Kong's family office push, investment scheme and US rate cuts to spur demand for yuan assets: Standard Chartered

Enoch Yiu

758 words

11 January 2024

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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* Potential US rate cuts this year will redirect capital flows to markets and currencies in Asia, boost the yuan and create demand for yuan products, John Thang says

* Hong Kong government's efforts to promote family offices and the investment migration scheme will create more demand for yuan-denominated products

The anticipated US interest-rate cuts, the Hong Kong government's measures to attract family offices and the coming investment migration scheme will attract investors to yuan-denominated assets this year, according to a senior executive at Standard Chartered Bank.

The lender, one of the three note-issuing banks in the city, believes the Federal Reserve will start cutting rates from the second half of the year by 75 basis points, which will diminish the lure of US dollar assets and draw funds back to Asia, according to John Thang, managing director and head of financial markets for Hong Kong, Taiwan and the Greater Bay Area.

"Such a trend will support capital markets and currencies in Asia," Thang said at a briefing on Wednesday. "It will also mean deposits, shares, bonds and other investment products denominated in yuan will be more attractive this year."

Do you have questions about the biggest topics and trends from around the world? Get the answers with [SCMP Knowledge](#), our new platform of curated content with explainers, FAQs, analyses and infographics brought to you by our award-winning team.

Thang expects the US rate cut will support the yuan, which will appreciate by about 2 per cent, to 7 yuan per dollar this year. The yuan, currently trading at about 7.18, has depreciated by more than 13 per cent since March 2022, when the US started increasing rates in its latest rate cycle.

The Fed increased interest rates by 525 basis points in 17 months until July last year, attracting fund flows to US dollar assets. The DXY index, which tracks the dollar against a basket of major currencies, surged 14 per cent from March 2022 to 113.29 in October 2023, its strongest level in 20 years. It currently stands at 102.51, a 10 per cent decline from the peak because of rising expectations of a rate cut since the fourth quarter.

"The tide will turn this year," Thang said. "We have already seen more investors showing an interest in yuan investment products in recent months."

He said Standard Chartered has financial products in mainland China and Hong Kong to meet the increasing demand from customers for yuan-related investments.

Thang said the Hong Kong government's push to attract wealthy customers from the Greater Bay Area, Southeast Asia and the Middle East to set up family offices would also bring in capital and create demand for yuan products.

Hong Kong has offered a range of incentives for family offices since hosting the Wealth for Good summit in March 2023. This was followed by a tax break in May and the launch of an investment-migration scheme in December to attract family offices.

These initiatives came after Chief Executive John Lee Ka-chiu set a target to attract at least 200 **family offices** by 2025, on top of the nearly 400 firms already here.

The new Capital Investment Entrant Scheme announced on December 20, better known as the investment-migration scheme, offers a faster route to residency for people who invest at least HK\$30 million (US\$3.84 million) in stocks, bonds or other assets, excluding residential property.

"The **family office** and investment-migration scheme will enlarge the pool of liquidity to invest in dim sum bonds and other yuan assets trading in Hong Kong," Thang said.

He said the connect schemes, which allow cross-border trading of wealth-management products, stocks, bonds and interest-rate swaps, will continue supporting the development of yuan products and solidify the city's status as the largest offshore yuan trading centre.

Another driving force for the investment markets in Hong Kong this year will be green finance, Thang said, noting many companies are keen to add a green element to their financing activities.

Standard Chartered said it plans to help clients issue and invest in green bonds and green loans, whose proceeds are used for projects to cut down carbon emissions and pollution.

"The demand for green bonds and green loans has been on a rising trend in recent years, and this trend will continue this year," Thang said.

Document SCMCOM0020240111ek1b0002w

HSBC Hong Kong rolls out debit cards for private banking clients

Priyanka Boghani

394 words

10 January 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC Global Private Banking has launched a Mastercard debit card and supplementary debit card for customers with rewards and foreign currency payment experiences, the bank said.

The rewards have been catered to private banking clients who require convenient access to their cash when travelling overseas, or making online FX transactions.

The features include a waiver for foreign currency transaction fees and a handling fee waiver for foreign currency cash withdrawals at HSBC group, Mastercard and Cirrus network ATMs worldwide and a 0.5% instant cash rebate on all spending.

The bank said there is a clear need among its clients for debit cards, with a 70% year-on-year increase in the number of debit cards issued in 2023, according to Amy Kam, head of cards and personal lending, wealth and personal banking at HSBC Hong Kong.

Overall debit card spending also surged by 100% year-on-year. For the same period, overseas debit card spending by HSBC customers was also up 120%, reflecting a growing demand for debit card-related services.

'In addition, HSBC Global Private Banking Mastercard debit card holders can easily manage their accounts 24/7 through the HSBC HK app, whether during travelling or supporting their children studying overseas. Clients can adjust spending and cash withdrawal limits, and monitor supplementary card expenditures,' Kam added.

A recent HSBC report shows that 96% of Hong Kong entrepreneurs are actively seeking international business expansion, with more than half exploring global educational opportunities for their children.

To cater to the overseas spending and overseas education needs of clients and their families, the HSBC Global Private Banking Mastercard debit card supports up to 12 designated currencies: AUD, CAD, CHF, EUR, GBP, HKD, JPY, NZD, RMB, SGD, THB and USD.

'As our clients continue to pursue an international lifestyle, we will continue to enhance our services to offer an unparalleled client experience,' said Bryce Wan, HSBC's market head of Global Private Banking, in North Asia.

HSBC claims the supplementary debit card is the first of its kind in Hong Kong.

Separately, private banks in Singapore have been offering premium credit cards that involve lavish perks and lifestyle rewards in the city-state, including Citi's invite-only Ultima Mastercard credit card, American Express Centurion, DBS Insignia and UOB Reserve and Reserve Diamond.

Document CWIRAS0020240110ek1a00002

Stock in news

HSBC picks banking, consumption, IT as top investment themes for 2024

Shivendra Kumar

406 words

10 January 2024

The Economic Times

ECTIM

English

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India is undergoing an industrial renaissance and the country is the most promising structural growth story in Asia over the next decade, an HSBC Global **Private Banking** release said on Wednesday, quoting HSBC's Chief Investment Officer (CIO) James Cheo. Cheo has picked Indian banks, consumer discretionary and IT companies as his top bets in the domestic equity markets. Cheo maintained that the above sectors will benefit from the booming digital economy, consumer spending and service exports. In his view, the rise in India's new economy sectors viz. high-tech services, digital start-up ecosystem and services exports could raise its potential growth to 6.5% in 10 years, up from an average 6% growth before the pandemic. Cheo is CIO for South East Asia and India, Global **Private Banking** and Wealth.

HSBC Global **Private Banking** is a wealth management service, which offers tailored solutions to its clients across the world through a network of experts. "India's strong government spending and private investment growth, robust FDI inflows and booming services exports will continue to power employment, private consumption, and productivity gains," said Cheo, adding that India's 6% GDP growth this year will support robust 18% EPS growth in 2024. The premium valuation of Indian equities at 20X forward earnings is well supported by its high RoE of 16% — well above the 10.7% Asian regional average ROE — the release said quoting the CIO. India has consistently delivered stronger-than-expected growth in manufacturing and service activities throughout 2023, with strong FDI inflows and booming services exports powering employment, private consumption, and productivity gains, Cheo said. Headline index Nifty delivered 20% returns in 2023. Into the second week, Nifty has managed to remain flat witnessing a two-way trade. On Wednesday, the benchmark indices picked up momentum in the last hour of trade amid buying action in heavyweights Reliance Industries and ICICI Bank to close in the green for the second session in a row. While the S&P BSE Sensex settled at 71,657.71, up by 272 points or 0.38, the broader Nifty at 21,618.70, higher by 74 points or 0.34%. (Subscribe to ETMarkets WhatsApp channel)(Disclaimer: Recommendations, suggestions, views and opinions given by the experts are their own. These do not represent the views of Economic Times)

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HSBC Appoints Anthony Hingley as Head of Global **Private Banking**, Channel Islands and Isle of Man

Distributed by Contify.com

666 words

8 January 2024

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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HSBC has appointed Anthony Hingley as the new Head of Global **Private Banking** in the Channel Islands and Isle of Man. Anthony joined HSBC in 1999 and has extensive experience in HSBC's Global **Private Banking** division. Warwick Long, CEO of HSBC Channel Islands and Isle of Man, welcomed Anthony's appointment and acknowledged Kevin Herbert's significant contribution to HSBC over more than three decades.

Original Press Release:

Jan. 8 -- HSBC Bank issued the following news release:

HSBC has appointed Anthony Hingley as its new Head of Global **Private Banking** in the Channel Islands and Isle of Man.

Anthony assumes the role with immediate effect, taking up the position from Kevin Herbert, who has retired from HSBC after a career with the Bank spanning more than 35 years.

In his new role, Anthony will drive the Bank's strategy to grow its **private banking** offering in the islands, aligned with the Bank's Global **Private Banking** business and wider international wealth management strategy.

Anthony joined HSBC in 1999 and has worked in diverse markets, principally within HSBC's Global **Private Banking** division, across the UK, Geneva, Dubai, Qatar, Hong Kong and Singapore, as well as the Channel Islands. Prior to his most recent role as Managing Director, Global India, MENA and Europe for HSBC Global **Private Banking** based in Singapore, he was Head of Trust and Fiduciary Services, Channel Islands and Isle of Man.

Anthony is a Certified Private Wealth Professional through the Hong Kong Securities and Investment Institute, Certified Financial Planner through the UK Chartered Institute for Securities and Investment, and this year he also completed a leadership course from Harvard Business School Online.

Commenting on Anthony's appointment, Warwick Long, CEO, HSBC Channel Islands and Isle of Man, said:

"I'm delighted to welcome Anthony back to the Channel Islands as we continue to focus on growing our **private banking** proposition for both local and international customers. Anthony's global client experience and deep relationship network across our core markets, combined with his knowledge of the local market, will add huge value as we continue to support the growth of our business, which remains strategically important for the Group both across Europe and globally.

"At the same time, I would like to acknowledge Kevin's significant contribution to HSBC over more than three decades. His unrelenting passion to support our people and provide the best possible service for our customers have been impressive and supported the development of our business, and I'd like to extend a special thanks to him."

Anthony added: "We have a fantastic team in place in the islands who continue to deliver exceptional service, and I'm excited by our potential as we look forward to 2024 and beyond. Our focus remains on growing and enhancing our **private banking** proposition in the islands, leveraging our international connectivity and working closely with colleagues both here and across our global network."

About HSBC Bank plc

HSBC Bank plc, registered in England and Wales number 14259. Registered office 8 Canada Square, London, E14 5HQ. Authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and the Prudential Regulation Authority. HSBC Bank plc, Jersey Branch is regulated by the Jersey Financial Services Commission for Banking, General Insurance Mediation, Fund Services and Investment Business. HSBC Bank plc, Guernsey Branch is licensed by the Guernsey Financial Services Commission for Banking, Insurance and Investment Business. In the Isle of Man HSBC Bank plc is licensed by the Isle of Man Financial Services Authority.

HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 62 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,021 billion at 30 September 2023, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations

Source: HSBC Bank

[Category: Banks, Banks, Retail/ Commercial Bank, Management Changes]

Document ATINBK0020240110ek180008f

HSBC's HK wealth and personal banking head: Not enough RMs to meet demand

Priyanka Boghani

585 words

8 January 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Innovative talent acquisition programmes can help banks rely less on external hires in a market where there is a dearth of **private bankers**, HSBC wealth executives tell Citywire Asia.

'In Hong Kong, the reality is there are not enough relationship managers in the industry to meet market demand,' said Maggie Ng (pictured), HSBC's Hong Kong wealth and personal banking head.

'To address this, we're exploring innovative approaches to talent acquisition including our flagship accelerating wealth programme (AWP), which we have successfully piloted in Hong Kong.'

The internal hiring scheme AWP was launched in 2022 and early 2023 in the premier and global **private banking** segments for HSBC, piloting its first phase in Hong Kong and Singapore.

The programme has received more than 400 applicants for positions in the premier and global **private banking** units already.

'There are 500 new wealth roles in Asia and relying solely on external hires may not always be the optimal solution for us, as the market may well not always provide enough supply of the talent we need.'

'Therefore, hiring externally is not always the best option for us,' said Laura Powell (pictured below), global head of HR, wealth and personal banking and global functions at HSBC.

'We've also found that experience on paper is not always the best indicator of job performance. We need to hire for skills and education as well.'

<figure></figure>

Interestingly, half of the first phase of applications was from individuals in non-frontline roles who are looking to upskill and transition to the wealth business.

Powell recalled an individual who had been working in the marketing department for 12 years before she transitioned to a relationship manager role, after obtaining all the necessary financial licenses.

The second phase of AWP has been a success since its launch in late 2023, Powell said, with the additions of internal and external candidates in Hong Kong.

'Candidates hail from diverse backgrounds, with over 50% from non-financial services,' she added.

Wealth continues to grow in the region, with financial assets expected to grow to \$80.8tn in 2027, according to the BCG Global Wealth Report 2023. The report notes that Hong Kong and Singapore rank second and third, respectively, among global booking centres, with Switzerland retaining pole position.

'To keep pace with wealth growth, we've planned to increase the number of new frontline staff under our distribution team by nearly 20% this year. We also are growing to keep pace with the growing wealth in the region, with 20% more frontliners this year,' Ng said.

AWP was also launched internally in India and mainland China last year. Singapore, the Channel Islands and Isle of Man's launch of AWP externally will happen in January 2024 and the third phase of the programme will likely see its introduction in more markets, Powell added.

A popular hiring strategy among **private bankers** has been to poach star bankers or group heads along with their teams, leading to a rotation of senior talent among the top ranks.

Several banks with other divisions have their internal programmes, similar to HSBC's, that look to groom in-house and from other divisions, with the bank, providing a new talent pool for hiring.

Last year saw several senior management changes at the top as well as role reductions, as **private banks** worked on ways to streamline and cut costs following a year of market turmoil.

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StanChart hires from HSBC for Greater China market head role

Cheryl Heng

205 words

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Citywire Asia

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English

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Standard Chartered Wealth Management has hired Sidney Wang from HSBC to take on the role of Greater China market head.

Based in Hong Kong, Wang started on 15 December, reporting to Peter Tung, the bank's regional head of private banking for Greater China and North Asia, according to a note from the bank.

Wang has more than two decades of banking experience spanning commercial banking, credit and risk management and strategy, where 15 years were in wealth management.

He was previously an international manager at HSBC, having worked in the UK and Europe, the Middle East, North and South America and Greater China during his time with the bank.

Wang led the launch of HSBC's onshore China private banking business for HSBC and helped to deliver an international coverage platform for Asia UHNW and family office clients.

Last quarter, StanChart [reorganised its Southeast Asia team](#) and reshuffled its leadership team following the [hire of Foo Tian Ong](#) as regional head, Southeast Asia and Singapore location head.

In November, the bank also announced the [opening of its priority private centre in Shanghai](#), broadening its services offered to high net worth clients in mainland China.

Document CWIRAS0020240103ek1300002



Business

Wealth Management Connect: HSBC, Standard Chartered among top banks eyeing Greater Bay Area sales boost with roll-out of enhancements to cross-border investment scheme

Enoch Yiu

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English

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* The proposed enhancements will allow more residents in the development zone to 'have a greater variety of investment options', HSBC executive says

* Allowing securities firms to sell scheme products is a positive, Hong Kong Securities Association's Katherine Kou says

The soon-to-be-launched enhancements to the cross-border **Wealth Management** Connect scheme are set to boost sales and capital flows between Hong Kong, Macau and the nine mainland Chinese cities in the Greater Bay Area development zone, Hong Kong's biggest banks said.

The People's Bank of China's (PBOC) Guangdong branch completed a 12-day consultation on December 12 on a wide range of relaxations to the scheme, including tripling individual quotas to 3 million yuan (US\$420,745) from 1 million yuan. The new measures will also lower the threshold for mainland investors trading under the scheme, widen product choices and allow securities firms to sell products as well instead of just banks.

The new measures will also relax the sales process, allowing banks and securities firms to introduce product information to investors instead of current practice, where these firms can only execute orders and cannot introduce the products.

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The city's three note-issuing banks – [HSBC](#), Standard Chartered and Bank of China (Hong Kong) (BOCHK) – have all strongly welcomed the enhancements, although the PBOC has not yet named a launch date.

"The proposal is expected to attract more participants to the **Wealth Management** Connect scheme for their cross-boundary investments, thus increasing the scale of the pilot scheme," said David Liao, the Asia-Pacific co-CEO at HSBC. "We are studying the proposal and are getting prepared to seize potential opportunities.

"The proposed enhancements will allow more residents in the Greater Bay Area to have a greater variety of investment options. This provides investors with greater flexibility to adjust their investment portfolios in response to market conditions and their risk appetite."

The scheme, launched in September 2021, is Beijing's first plan tailor-made for the 11 cities in the development zone. It allows 24 banks, including HSBC and Standard Chartered, to sell Hong Kong investment products to residents in the zone's mainland cities through 31 partners.

As of the end of October, the scheme had attracted about 62,900 investors, who had invested 8.66 billion yuan, according to government data. This represented only about 3 per cent of the scheme's total quota of 300 billion yuan.

"There is demand for cross-border sales of fund products, but the scheme currently is too restrictive," said Alson Ho, [Standard Chartered's](#) head of **wealth management** in Hong Kong. "A relaxation of the restrictions would help boost sales."

Sun Yu, chairman of the Hong Kong Association of Banks, who is also the vice-chairman and CEO of BOCHK, also welcomed the enhancements to the **Wealth Management** Scheme.

"Enhancements to the **Wealth Management** Connect scheme will support the development of cross-boundary trading and promote the cross-border flow of the yuan, paving the way for the development of the financial sector in the Greater Bay Area," he added.

Greater Bay Area investors' need to diversify their investments will further boost sales under the scheme, said Sharine Wong, a senior industry analyst at Bloomberg Intelligence.

"China's policies to stimulate economic growth, investors' diversification needs and a widening interest-rate differential between the US and mainland China should fuel demand for financial products," Wong said.

The cumulative value of **wealth management** and fund products held by Hong Kong and Macau investors totalled 227 million yuan at the end of October, largely steady over the past six months. Monthly northbound sales ranged from 15 million yuan to 29 million yuan from the beginning of this year to the end of October, Wong added.

[Bank of East Asia's](#) co-CEO, Adrian Li Man-kiu, said his bank is well prepared to increase sales via the scheme after the relaxations.

"The Greater Bay Area development zone will be a growth engine of our business," Li said. "After the relaxation of the sales process, increasing the quota and adding more product choices, sales via the **Wealth Management** Connect scheme are set to increase in future."

Allowing securities firms to sell scheme products is a positive, said Katherine Kou, chairwoman of the Hong Kong Securities Association.

"However, it is not going to benefit all the about 600 stockbrokers in Hong Kong, as not all of them have the licence to sell mutual funds," she added. "Only brokers that have asset-management licences will benefit from the move."

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BusinessWorld

Special Report

SPECIAL REPORT: Third Quarter Banking Report FINANCIAL RATIOS

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English

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INTERMEDIATION RATIO

Q3' 23 Q2' 23 Q3' 22
P100B AND OVER

BDO Unibank, Inc.	0.7734	0.7846	0.8049		
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	0.5948	0.6045	0.6335		
Land Bank of the Philippines	0.3889	0.3944	0.4097		
Bank of the Philippine Islands	0.7966	0.7979	0.7828		
China Banking Corp.	0.6521	0.6479	0.6748		
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	0.6568	0.6270	0.6596		
Philippine National Bank	0.6572	0.6488	0.7000		
Union Bank of the Philippines	0.7020	0.7222	0.6335		
Development Bank of the Philippines	0.5938	0.6156	0.6101		
Security Bank Corp.	0.8777	0.9008	0.8178		
East West Banking Corp.	0.8132	0.7892	0.7275		
Asia United Bank Corp.	0.6548	0.6982	0.6657		
Citibank NA	0.2387	0.2672	0.2674		
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	0.4293	0.4571	0.4057		
Bank of Commerce	0.6218	0.6523	0.5561		
Robinsons Bank Corp.	0.7073	0.6951	0.7326		
Philippine Trust Co.	0.1435	0.1440	0.1382		
Philippine Bank of Communications	0.7382	0.7848	0.8382		
MUFG Bank Ltd.	0.3930	0.3767	0.5309		
Standard Chartered Bank	0.1748	0.1864	0.1769		
MEDIAN	0.6535	0.6484	0.6466		

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

Maybank Philippines, Inc.	0.6693	0.6420	0.6243		
Mizuho Bank Ltd.	0.3764	0.4157	0.5876		
CTBC Bank	0.8904	0.9054	0.8624		
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	0.0100	0.0065	0.0394		
Philippine Veterans Bank	0.3785	0.3665	0.3549		
Bank of China Ltd.	0.9954	1.0361	0.8493		
MEDIAN	0.5239	0.5288	0.6059		

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	0.3446	0.5381	0.7817		
Deutsche Bank AG	0.5346	0.4449	0.6152		
BDO Private Bank	0.1351	0.1471	0.1416		
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	0.6569	0.6820	0.3706		
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	0.3418	0.3621	0.3979		
Bank of America NA	0.1595	0.1209	0.2320		
KEB Hana Bank	1.4083	1.1287	1.2489		
ING Bank N.V.	1.6559	1.6479	1.2060		
MEDIAN	0.4396	0.4915	0.5065		

P20B AND BELOW

Mega International Commercial Bank	0.6810	0.6717	1.0666
Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	1.6032	2.2705	2.5301
Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	7.0352	3.9413	3.2241
Shinhan Bank	1.2897	1.3363	1.3315
Industrial Bank of Korea	2.1491	2.6304	2.3994
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	83.4905	28.3900	31.3988
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	2.7258	15.8968	5.2635
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	4.2818	5.9085	5.5711
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	347.955	23,490	650.4198
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	4.0606	3.4295	3.2985
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	0.2999	0.3021	0.2913
MEDIAN	2.7258	3.4295	3.2241

GRAND MEDIAN	0.6572	0.6717	0.6748
TOTAL LOANS/TOTAL DEPOSITS	0.6401	0.6459	0.6540

LEVERAGE RATIO

Q3'23 Q2'23 Q3'22

P100B AND OVER

BDO Unibank, Inc.	0.1190	0.1199	0.1164
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	0.1083	0.1120	0.1099
Land Bank of the Philippines	0.0808	0.0779	0.0738
Bank of the Philippine Islands	0.1281	0.1244	0.1229
China Banking Corp.	0.0862	0.0885	0.0975
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	0.1164	0.0965	0.1053
Philippine National Bank	0.1493	0.1492	0.1375
Union Bank of the Philippines	0.1483	0.1526	0.1347
Development Bank of the Philippines	0.0838	0.0841	0.0742
Security Bank Corp.	0.1409	0.1423	0.1469
East West Banking Corp.	0.1454	0.1469	0.1471
Asia United Bank Corp.	0.1315	0.1333	0.1196
Citibank NA	0.0718	0.0579	0.1268
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	0.0772	0.0731	0.0625
Bank of Commerce	0.1276	0.1372	0.1286
Robinsons Bank Corp.	0.1054	0.1062	0.1110
Philippine Trust Co.	0.1199	0.1264	0.1173
Philippine Bank of Communications	0.1254	0.1320	0.1317
MUFG Bank Ltd.	0.1030	0.1064	0.1044
Standard Chartered Bank	0.0768	0.0731	0.0646
MEDIAN	0.1177	0.1159	0.1168

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

Maybank Philippines, Inc.	0.1289	0.1238	0.1267
Mizuho Bank Ltd.	0.1032	0.0998	0.1154
CTBC Bank	0.1483	0.1470	0.1522
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	0.1176	0.1188	0.1196
Philippine Veterans Bank	0.0227	0.0168	0.0121
Bank of China Ltd.	0.1879	0.1925	0.1510
MEDIAN	0.1233	0.1213	0.1232

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	0.2889	0.3042	0.3206
Deutsche Bank AG	0.0660	0.0547	0.0467
BDO Private Bank	0.1855	0.1922	0.1456
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	0.2181	0.2378	0.2214
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	0.1457	0.1282	0.0956
Bank of America NA	0.1739	0.1753	0.1449
KEB Hana Bank	0.2846	0.3000	0.2835

ING Bank N. V.	0.4111	0.4965	0.3540
MEDIAN	0.2018	0.2150	0.1835

P20B AND BELOW

Mega International Commercial Bank	0.2596	0.2906	0.2682
Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	0.5359	0.5361	0.5577
Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	0.3471	0.3609	0.3449
Shinhan Bank	0.4400	0.4416	0.4595
Industrial Bank of Korea	0.4665	0.5432	0.4562
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	0.3240	0.3120	0.3113
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	0.7183	0.8113	0.6713
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	0.5045	0.5240	0.5134
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	0.4732	0.4908	0.4077
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	0.7019	0.6667	0.6070
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	0.0790	0.0863	0.0185
MEDIAN	0.4665	0.4908	0.4562

GRAND MEDIAN	0.1409	0.1372	0.1317
TOTAL CAPITAL ACCOUNTS/TOTAL ASSETS	0.1152	0.1143	0.1125

CAPITAL TO LOANS RATIO

Q3'23 Q2'23 Q3'22

P100B AND OVER

BDO Unibank, Inc.	0.1908	0.1895	0.1818
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	0.2440	0.2411	0.2361
Land Bank of the Philippines	0.2349	0.2231	0.2059
Bank of the Philippine Islands	0.2010	0.1954	0.1959
China Banking Corp.	0.1860	0.1873	0.1916
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	0.2477	0.2095	0.2189
Philippine National Bank	0.3037	0.3049	0.2698
Union Bank of the Philippines	0.3315	0.3370	0.3278
Development Bank of the Philippines	0.1791	0.1734	0.1619
Security Bank Corp.	0.2649	0.2725	0.2583
East West Banking Corp.	0.2351	0.2411	0.2572
Asia United Bank Corp.	0.2428	0.2318	0.2174
Citibank NA	0.4947	0.4093	0.9437
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	0.2656	0.2230	0.2137
Bank of Commerce	0.2591	0.2648	0.2875
Robinsons Bank Corp.	0.1929	0.1957	0.1912
Philippine Trust Co.	0.9587	1.0115	0.9663
Philippine Bank of Communications	0.2291	0.2321	0.2177
MUFG Bank Ltd.	0.3806	0.3715	0.2549
Standard Chartered Bank	0.7443	0.6911	0.8528
MEDIAN	0.2458	0.2366	0.2275

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

Maybank Philippines, Inc.	0.2829	0.2964	0.3258
Mizuho Bank Ltd.	0.3430	0.3145	0.2920
CTBC Bank	0.2519	0.2462	0.2468
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	15.3156	24.8626	4.3854
Philippine Veterans Bank	0.0645	0.0492	0.0361
Bank of China Ltd.	0.3451	0.3322	0.3329
MEDIAN	0.3130	0.3055	0.3089

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	1.2345	0.8703	0.6630
Deutsche Bank AG	0.2123	0.1976	0.1209
BDO Private Bank	2.2450	2.0699	1.5798
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	0.5002	0.5250	0.8101
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	0.6223	0.6374	0.7212
Bank of America NA	1.5129	2.0230	0.8428

KEB Hana Bank	0.3971	0.4731	0.3852
ING Bank N. V.	1.2106	1.2050	1.2030
MEDIAN	0.9165	0.7539	0.7656

P20B AND BELOW

Mega International Commercial Bank	0.9112	1.1710	0.7115
Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	0.8322	0.7733	0.7399
Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	0.8154	0.8009	0.6693
Shinhan Bank	0.7143	0.7059	0.7229
Industrial Bank of Korea	0.9045	0.9726	1.0078
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	0.6981	0.6663	0.6835
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	0.9545	1.1875	1.1067
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	0.6470	0.6434	0.6059
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	1.3412	1.3302	0.9205
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	1.0103	1.1099	1.0160
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	0.3037	0.3335	0.0681
MEDIAN	0.8322	0.8009	0.7229

GRAND MEDIAN	0.3451	0.3370	0.3278
TOTAL CAPITAL ACCOUNTS/TOTAL LOANS	0.2353	0.2305	0.2260

Based on Solo and Consolidated Balance Sheets as of September 30, 2023

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Business Times Breaking News

Levelling up client services: How Insead training and advisory tools are reshaping wealth management

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Standard Chartered's robust training programme helps its investment advisors understand customers' needs and plan suitable strategies

IN A realistic virtual reality setting, senior investment advisor Joey Ng witnesses an intense negotiation between a veteran banker and his prospective employer over a pay package. The tension is palpable as each party lays out their argument in an attempt to come out on top in the back and forth.

This training session, which was held at the main campus of leading business school Insead at Fontainebleau, France, is designed to help participants get a deeper understanding of negotiation dynamics. Ng was there as part of a training programme for Standard Chartered's **wealth management** professionals conducted by Insead.

"The VR session transformed the whole learning experience and gave us a different perspective of how negotiations are carried out. After the session, we discussed how we should advise the employee in the negotiations and how he should devise a win-win strategy for both the employer and himself," says Ng, who has been at Standard Chartered Bank for 12 years.

In her current role as an investment advisor, she works closely with relationship managers to service Priority and Priority Private banking clients, providing specialist knowledge to help them with building up their clients' investment portfolios. Investment advisors like Ng essentially act as a liaison between the bank's Chief Investment Office and its clients, helping them understand the impact of market developments on their investments.

Comprehensive training

To help Ng and her fellow team members perform their roles more effectively, Standard Chartered has, in recent years, invested significantly in its training initiatives aimed at supporting its affluent banking business.

This programme involves collaborating with digital learning platforms and Insead to provide relevant market content and training tools.

Training stints at Insead are just one aspect of Standard Chartered's comprehensive **wealth management** training programme for its relationship managers and investment advisors, as well as wealth, treasury and insurance specialists.

The bank's robust learning platform, which has been enhanced over the years, is accessible round the clock and allows staff to learn at their own pace. This platform offers a wealth of content, ranging from IT skills to financial technical knowledge and interpersonal capabilities.

Ng is among the top Insead trainees in Singapore who are given the opportunity to go to the university's main French campus. She credits classes on behavioural finance and investment biases at Insead for helping her develop a more customer-centric mindset, enabling her to better align client interests to help them achieve their financial goals. Standard Chartered senior investment advisor Joey Ng honed her client-centric skills through behavioural finance and investment bias courses at Insead. PHOTO: STANDARD CHARTERED

For example, she advised a client who had most of her funds invested in fixed deposits to invest in high-quality bonds that were relatively low risk, but would offer higher potential returns in the long term.

"As the client did not have the time to actively invest since she was busy shuttling between Singapore and the UK, we proposed a five-year investment grade bond that would offer regular income, and the potential to be sold for a gain after two to three years, since it is now trading below par," Ng explains.

"By taking into account the client's risk profile and financial goals, we can better understand their requirements and propose suitable solutions that match their needs at that point in time," she adds.

Harnessing technology

Ng also employs a range of innovative tools and technologies to enhance her ability to craft investment solutions for clients. One key resource is Standard Chartered's Wealth Select, the bank's advisory promise. This unique framework guides advisors in planning client portfolios with a "Today, Tomorrow, and Forever" mindset, considering immediate financial needs, future aspirations and legacy planning.

Another tool in Ng's arsenal is the MyWealth Advisor, a dynamic investment advisory tool that integrates the latest market outlooks with a range of investment solutions. This enables advisors to customise portfolios to meet their capital growth or income goals, or choose from a well-curated model portfolio. This approach empowers clients to actively shape their financial future with the bank's expert guidance.

She uses another resource, Market Analyst - an in-house tool that integrates market data, production information and CIO views - that gives her access to insights and market information, which she can use when presenting proposals to clients.

"We can easily show clients the latest performance of certain products that they may be interested in, and also do comparisons to substantiate our proposals," she explains.

Staying ahead in an evolving market

Despite the growing use of technology, Ng makes clear that a human touch is necessary in offering value beyond what any algorithm can provide. While algorithms can provide a snapshot of current financial situations, they lack the capacity to understand the nuances of a client's dreams, objectives and lifestyle aspirations.

She noted that the rise of AI-driven robo-advisors, which offer services at lower fees, has led to increased competition and changing client expectations. Rather than viewing artificial intelligence (AI) as a competitor, however, Ng sees it as a complementary tool. Case in point: Platforms like MyWealth Advisor provide a foundation upon which human advisors can build, offering tailored advice based on a client's unique needs and objectives.

In light of the changing **wealth management** landscape, Ng emphasises the importance of continuous learning and staying abreast of market trends to navigate the often volatile financial landscape. This mindset ensures that advisors like her remain equipped to offer relevant and timely advice in the face of market fluctuations.

Says Ng: "There's a reason why people go to doctors and not just to the pharmacy to get medicine. Doctors can understand your specific medical condition and give you the assurance of what needs to be done. Like doctors, investment advisors also take the time to understand your situation and give you the assurance you need. A robot can't do that."

For more information, visit [Standard Chartered](#).

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DBS sees India overtake China for Singapore family office enquiries

James Phillipps

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DBS Bank said India has overtaken Greater China as its biggest source of enquiries on setting up a single family office in Singapore after the city-state's authorities tightened rules governing the sector.

The Southeast Asia lender said it is also now seeing a higher proportion of new SFO clients opting for the bigger ticket, the so-called enhanced tier tax incentive scheme, which has a S\$50m (\$37.3m) threshold.

The Monetary Authority of Singapore toughened the requirements for visas and tax incentives through a series of measures this year. The regulator also said it was upping surveillance of the market after it was linked to the country's S\$2.8bn money laundering scandal.

The more stringent rules, including the need for minimum assets of S\$20m and annual spending of S\$200,000, have led to a shakeout of the brokers trying to use the scheme to secure residency for clients.

DBS said it has since seen a decrease in the number of enquiries from China.

'A lot of small advisers, many of these were from China, were just peddling [SFO] structures as quick fix programmes for someone who wants an employment pass in Singapore. These applicants have fallen away,' Lee Woon Shiu, the bank's group head of wealth planning, family office and insurance solutions, told Citywire Asia.

'In terms of new enquiries and China clients, it is somewhat slowing down a bit. The Indian market is the fastest-growing market for us in the second half of 2023.'

Ray Shankar, head of law firm Oon & Bazul's private wealth and family office practice, has also heard many companies across the wealth management market reporting slowdowns in SFO enquiries from China.

The drop in numbers following the 'opportunistic ones being weeded out' has similarly resulted in a geographic tilt from North to South Asia.

'I've seen a shift of the influx, which were historically coming in from North Asia, and China in particular, to South Asia,' he said. 'We're looking at a lot more interested parties coming from India and the Indian subcontinent.'

Precise figures are difficult to determine. The Singapore government does not publish a breakdown of SFO applicants' nationalities or country of origin.

A spokesperson for MAS said: 'The growth of family offices in Singapore is in line with the growth of family offices globally in the past few years. There is a mix of Asian families, and an increasing number of non-Asian families coming to Singapore to set-up offices to support their investments in the region.'

Focus on quality

The increase in the proportion of clients opting for the enhanced, or Section 13U exemptions, reflects the market shakeout being concentrated in Section 13O exemptions, where the requirements are less onerous.

On top of the higher minimum assets requirement for Section 13U, compared to Section 13O, funds also must meet a higher S\$500,000 annual spend and employ three, rather than two, investment professionals.

China remains a significant driver of new business, however, and DBS continues to see interest from 'serious' ultra-high net worth individuals, who Lee said are 'here to stay'.

The bank has noted the MAS taking longer over SFO applications, as has been previously reported, with the regulator poring over them more closely following the city's ongoing money laundering case and working through its backlog. The number of SFOs ballooned to 1,100 at the end of 2022, up from 700 at the 2021 year-end.

Lee said overall SFO enquiry volumes at the bank have remained at a roughly similar level throughout the year.

Asia pivot

DBS's **family office** unit has been increasing its focus on fast-growing Asian markets, but the pivot to Indian clients also brings its challenges. Like China, the country imposes restrictions on capital flowing out of the country, though many wealthy individuals and families have been able to move money offshore.

'Whether that wealth is bankable is a different question because there can be tax avoidance, so that's something that needs to be scrutinised at the point of engaging with the bank,' Shankar said.

The Indian government imposes an offshore investment cap of \$250,000 per person via its Liberalised Remittance Scheme. However, earlier this year, the authorities allowed **family offices** to be set up in GIFT City through a family investment fund, enabling them to access international investment opportunities.

Private banks have been increasing their focus on the fast-growing \$2.8tn India wealth sector, which is underpinned by rapid economic expansion and a strong stock market.

Piyush Gupta, DBS CEO, told analysts its Indian business rose by about 20% in the first three quarters of the year, in an earnings call earlier this year. Meanwhile, HSBC returned to the Indian private banking sphere in July after an eight-year hiatus and Standard Chartered has been building its domestic branch network.

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Exclusive: UOB PB names new Indonesia market head

Priyanka Boghani

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CWIRAS

English

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UOB **Private Bank** has hired from DBS **Private Bank** to bolster its Indonesia desk, Citywire Asia has learnt.

Stanley Puah has been named market head of Indonesia, reporting to Wein Khoo, regional market head for Southeast Asia.

A spokesperson from the bank declined to comment.

Puah was most recently a team leader at DBS **Private Bank** for more than a decade.

UOB **Private Bank** recently underwent a [rebranding](#) exercise, which included a new brand-supporting film and a new logo and regional slogan 'doing right by you.'

The need for a rebranding effort has arisen not only from the rapid expansion of Asian wealth but also the heightened value of the 'Singapore premium,' UOB **Private Bank**'s managing director and head of private wealth Chew Mun Yew told Citywire Asia in an earlier conversation.

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Business

HSBC looks to mergers to expand footprint, serve wealthy customers in Asia, bank chief says

Enoch Yiu

1,016 words

13 December 2023

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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* HSBC Asset Management agreed to buy Singapore-based SilkRoad Property Partners this week to enter into real estate business

* The lender's Asia-Pacific head said its acquisitions, including that of Citigroup's unit, signal HSBC expansion's in **wealth management**, family businesses

[HSBC](#) said it may buy financial businesses and shed unprofitable units around Asia to expand its footprint for [serving wealthy customers](#), as Hong Kong's largest bank looks to fine-tune its growth strategy to deliver the best returns for shareholders.

"While organic growth will continue to be a core expansion strategy for HSBC, mergers, acquisitions and disposals will be a key strategy to expand in new markets and to strengthen our existing business lines," the bank's Asia-Pacific co-CEO David Liao said in an interview with the Post. "We will only conduct a deal when the targets can be fully integrated into our existing businesses. At the same time, we will dispose of businesses in markets that do not have the scale or growth potential."

The focus on shareholder returns partly reflects HSBC's new strategy to deflect last year's [break-up call](#) by its largest stakeholder Ping An Group.

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The bank, [founded in 1865 in Hong Kong](#) and Shanghai, this week added to its shopping basket the Singapore real estate manager SilkRoad Property Partners, with US\$2 billion of assets under management. The bank bought Citigroup's retail **wealth management** business on the mainland [in October](#), taking over a portfolio with US\$3.6 billion in assets and deposits, with customers in 11 Chinese cities.

The shopping spree is consistent with HSBC's plan to grow its **wealth management**, family office and private banking business across the "fastest-growing" region worldwide, Liao said.

"Many entrepreneurs have established their businesses for decades and accumulated much wealth," he said. "HSBC has developed a range of private banking, family office, **wealth management** and insurance services to capture these growing opportunities."

HSBC will also double down on its investments in Asia, particularly in its mainland ventures. The bank raised its stake in [HSBC Qianhai Securities](#) to 90 per cent last year from 51 per cent, and took full ownership of [HSBC Life China in 2020](#).

"This reflects HSBC's commitment to expand on the mainland as we believe the country will continue to open up its financial services sector, and the future growth will be huge," Liao said.

HSBC [swooped in on the UK unit of Silicon Valley Bank](#) (SVB) for a nominal £1 (US\$1.23) in March when the US lender went into a liquidity crisis. The acquisition has attracted "billions" of deposits inflow and gave a clear signal that HSBC "wants to be heavily involved in the tech in the innovation sector," CEO Noel Quinn said during an interview.

The bank, which has been shedding units in North America, will continue to dispose of non-productive businesses. HSBC will complete the sale of its Canadian unit to the Royal Bank of Canada in the first quarter of 2024 after selling its Greece and Russia businesses in the first half of this year. It reached revised terms to sell its French retail business in June.

HSBC sold its retail and business bank in Mauritius to the Absa Group last month, and wound down its personal banking unit in New Zealand in June. Wholesale banking will continue in both markets, giving HSBC a footprint of 18 markets across Asia-Pacific.

These disposals form part of Quinn's plan to streamline the bank's operations and shift capital from underperforming businesses in the West to the growing Asia market.

HSBC operates in 62 countries and territories, but most revenue and profit are from Asia, particularly Hong Kong and the mainland. Hong Kong contributed to 29 per cent of the bank's third-quarter earnings, when pre-tax profit rose 20 per cent to US\$2.23 billion.

The bank moved its headquarters from Hong Kong to London to comply with the UK's banking law after it acquired the Midland Bank in 1992. That had been a sore point for many HSBC's shareholders, especially after the bank gave in to the UK regulator's call in 2020 to preserve its capital and [cancel its dividend payout](#), a vital source of income for many long-term, retail shareholders.

The bank, which reviews the location of its headquarters every few years, concluded in 2016 that it would keep its address in London. It has since dispatched [several senior bankers to Hong Kong](#) to follow through on Quinn's focus on Asia.

"We take the Hong Kong market very [seriously] and we will continue to invest here, [with] various schemes to support the local economy," Liao said, adding that the bank's philanthropy for supporting the city includes the HSBC Hong Kong Community Festival, which kicks off this Sunday in Central.

"Hong Kong will continue to be the focus of [our] expansion, as the city plays an important role in the [Greater Bay Area](#), with strategic roles in Asia as a whole," he said.

HSBC, which opened in Shenzhen in 1982, now operates in all 21 prefecture-level cities in Guangdong province. It will open the 25-storey new HSBC office tower in Qianhai next year.

Liao himself is actively taking part in Hong Kong's push to be what Chief Executive John Lee calls the ["value-added superconnector"](#) between [China, Southeast Asia](#) and the [Middle East](#).

"HSBC has a big operation in the Middle East with over 4,000 staff, and we are the trustee for the first Saudi ETF that listed in Hong Kong," he said. "We have big operations in Singapore and India to help promote trade finance, wealth and other Southeast Asian businesses."

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Business

Standard Chartered says investor participation in ESG fund sales surges amid climate change focus

Enoch Yiu

887 words

11 December 2023

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English

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* Standard Chartered banker says it is not just the young investors buying ESG funds, investment interest exists across all age groups

* Border reopening helped boost sales of insurance and **wealth management** products, as 23 million travellers visited the city in the first 10 months

Standard Chartered Bank, one of Hong Kong's three note-issuing banks, reported a 40 per cent increase in the number of customers buying ESG (environmental, social and governance) funds in the first 10 months of this year, reflecting growing investment interest in products focused on pollution and climate change.

"It is not just the young investors, but we found investors in all age groups are interested in buying our ESG products," said Alson Ho, Standard Chartered Bank Hong Kong's head of **Wealth Management**, at a media briefing on Friday.

"If there are two fund products with similar structure and past performance, investors tend to choose to invest in the fund with an ESG theme and not the one without such features."

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He believes this is a result of ESG advocacy efforts made by many governments and regulators with Standard Chartered itself having promoted ESG investment as a strategy in recent years. Standard Chartered now sells about 90 funds, including those issued by other fund houses, with ESG investment features.

The lender joins another one of Hong Kong's note-issuing bank Bank of China (Hong Kong), French fund house Amundi and German fund company Allianz Global Investors, in promoting ESG funds in Hong Kong after sales exploded in recent years following the worldwide pandemic, global wars, and natural disasters, which have sharpened the focus on ESG.

Hong Kong's government and regulators have been promoting the development of the city into a hub for green and sustainable finance, serving mainland and global firms.

Green and sustainable debt issued in the city, including bonds and loans, increased by more than 40 per cent year on year in 2022, to US\$80.5 billion, accounting for a third of such debt sold in Asia in that period, Hong Kong government data showed.

Besides ESG funds, Standard Chartered's Ho said sales of other **wealth management** and insurance products also picked up this year, thanks to the reopening of the border between Hong Kong and China and the rest of the world in January.

In the first nine months, more than 23 million travellers visited the city, including more than 18.7 million from mainland China, according to figures from the Hong Kong Tourism Board. Last year a mere 604,564 people visited the city.

"The reopening of the border has brought the mainland tourists back, which benefits the sales of insurance products," Ho said.

Standard Chartered's revenue arising from its **wealth management** business posted double-digit growth in the first 10 months this year compared to a year ago, Ho said.

The lender's insurance sales to mainland customers in the first 10 months are 20 per cent higher than in 2019 before the pandemic struck, with medical and protection products in different currencies being the most popular, he said.

Hong Kong insurance industry's sale of life policies to mainlanders aggregated HK\$46.8 billion (US\$6 billion) in the year to September, compared with HK\$1 billion a year earlier, according to data from the Insurance Authority. It accounted for nearly a third of the policies sold in Hong Kong during the period.

The bank's revenues from sales of structured products linked with interest rates and having capital preservation features, have risen 80 per cent in the first 10 months compared with a year ago, while fixed income product sales rose 90 per cent. Ho believes these products would continue to be popular in 2024 on account of the elevated interest rate levels.

Ho says the strong demand outlook for **wealth management** services has encouraged the bank to push ahead with a plan to introduce a mobile phone app, My RM, which will allow better communications with customers and a streamlined sales processes for funds, bonds and structured products.

Standard Chartered Bank has been selling its mutual funds via the **Wealth Management** Connect scheme, allowing Greater Bay Area residents to buy cross-border fund products since September 2021.

Fund sales via the scheme have been slow due to various restrictions in the scheme. The People's Bank of China and Hong Kong Monetary Authority on December 1 have started a market consultation process to collect views as to how to enhance the scheme. Proposals include raising the individual quota to 3 million yuan (US\$420,369), from 1 million yuan currently, as well to broaden the range of products to be sold under the scheme.

"We believe this enhancement for the **Wealth Management** Connect scheme would be positive to the development of this cross-border scheme," Ho said. "There is demand for cross-border sales of fund products, but the scheme now is too restrictive. A relaxation of the restrictions would help boost sales."

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Indonesia hopes global investors will follow the carmakers

Mercedes Ruehl

1,127 words

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The south-east Asian country has the potential to develop **wealth management** offerings if per capita income improves

With the world's fourth largest population, a flourishing middle class, a digitalising economy and five of the seven critical minerals for making electric batteries, Indonesia has long been considered a sleeping giant of great potential.

At a conference held by UOB Asset Management in March, Colin Ng, head of Asia equities for the financial services group, called Indonesia, a "sitting jackpot". "When you invest in Indonesia, you are basically investing in the future," he said.

For Indonesia's economy — the largest in south-east Asia — the global shift to producing electric vehicles has provided a strong tailwind. The country has abundant reserves of nickel — a key mineral for creating batteries — and is aiming to become a hub for the new energy supply chain.

Investor interest has followed that of the major carmakers. The number of investors in Indonesia's capital markets has grown from 1.1mn at the end of 2017 to almost 12mn at the end of October 2023, according to Trimegah Asset Management, a major asset management business in Indonesia — a 10-fold increase in just six years.

"The majority of growth [was] driven by the availability of digital financial platforms that made it easy for people, especially the younger generation, to invest," explains Antony Dirga, chief executive at Trimegah.

Among these investors are wealthy individuals from around the world, who have opened banking facilities in the country. According to government data, as of the quarter ended September 2023, total deposits in Indonesia had reached 8,203tn rupiah (\$529bn) — a 35 per cent increase from the end of 2019. And the number of accounts increased by 77 per cent, from 301mn accounts to 535mn.

Vera Margaret, executive director and head of deposit and **wealth management** at UOB Indonesia says the number of customer information files — electronic records of bank customers — has grown fourfold in the past three years, after it launched digital banking in the country.

But she believes Indonesia must do more if it wants to lure more wealthy individual clients away from global family offices or big private banks in Hong Kong or Singapore. That will mean offering a greater variety of financial products, as well as making such services more accessible to middle-income clients, Margaret says.

So far, fund inflows have been disappointing. Although **wealth managers** and supply chain executives agree on the potential of Indonesia, the country of 277mn people has struggled to translate that interest into broader, international investment.

The local fund management industry had 508.19tn rupiah (\$32.5bn) of assets under management (AUM) at the end of 2022, a 12.4 per cent decline from 579.93tn rupiah (\$37.1bn) in 2021, according to figures from the Financial Services Authority of Indonesia. In addition, AUM stood at about 4 per cent of GDP, compared with 25 to 30 per cent in Malaysia and Thailand.

"The tax and administrative situation here is not at all conducive to the establishment of domestic family offices and **wealth management** infrastructure," argues Eugene Galbraith, director at mobile phone tower company PT

Protelindo, and a longtime observer of Indonesian business. However, the more mass affluent, that is to say high end-focused **wealth management** businesses have seen “some growth”, he adds.

Some of the problems holding back Indonesia's manufacturing sector help to explain the difficulties that **wealth managers** encounter.

“Indonesia has been fantastic at attracting investment in tech start-ups, for example, thanks to its large domestic market,” says Steven Westervelt, Singapore head of global investigations firm Nardello & Co. “There are many businesses filling and creating the needs of Indonesian people. But, in terms of making products and selling them to the global market from the US to Europe, they have not been as successful.”

High costs, unclear tax regulations and opaque bureaucracy have dogged Indonesia's attempts to persuade more multinationals to build domestic factories and provide a broad boost to its economy, beyond its mining sector, experts say.

High tech companies such as Apple, Sony and Samsung have picked neighbouring countries over Indonesia to expand in, and to manufacture their goods, as they diversify away from China.

Indonesia has not been able to compete effectively. At 22 per cent, its corporate tax rate is not much higher than Vietnam's 20 per cent, notes Thomas Hansmann, head of operations practice for south-east Asia, at consultants McKinsey & Company. “But Vietnam offers tax breaks and incentives like tax free periods,” points out Hansmann. As a result, a company like Samsung, in effect, pays about 5 per cent in tax in Vietnam.

Even Indonesia's individual taxes can be difficult to navigate — a factor that many high net worth individuals and wealthy investors take into account, says Galbraith.

Logistics and skilled labour are the other economic hurdles. Despite huge investment by the Joko Widodo government in upgrading ports, toll roads, airports and other infrastructure, logistics costs remain high.

“Logistics costs in Indonesia as a percentage of GDP are 26 per cent,” calculates Vivek Luthra, a managing director specialising in supply chain and operations at Accenture. “Most other south-east Asian countries are around 15 per cent.”

Qualified staff can be hard to find, too. Much of Indonesia's large labour force lacks the skills that international corporations need. There is an “education gap” compared with countries such as Vietnam and Malaysia, says Westervelt, which is why so many high-tech companies have gone elsewhere.

Such entrenched problems have held back the development of the financial services sector in Indonesia's economy — such as capital markets and **wealth management** — experts conclude.

But improvements in per capita income offer some hope. The World Bank estimated that Indonesia's gross national income (GNI) per capita was \$4,580 in 2022 — higher than India but lower than Malaysia or Thailand. Cleaning up Indonesia's economy and becoming more attractive to foreign groups could help lift the country out of this so termed middle-income trap in which it has been stuck for years.

“When the country's GDP per capita exceeds \$5,000, people tend to have excess savings available for investments after paying for basic necessities such as food, clothings, mortgages and auto loans,” explains Dirga.

This year, Indonesia's GDP per capita is predicted to finally reach \$5,000 — which Dirga thinks could give the **wealth management** industry the potential to reach \$150bn to \$200bn AUM within the five to seven years.

“[This is] still small in a global context, but Indonesia will probably be among the few countries whose **wealth management** sector will achieve high double-digit growth in the coming years,” he predicts.

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Asia's entrepreneurs need a wealth succession plan, says HSBC

Cheryl Heng

525 words

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Citywire Asia

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English

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More than one-third of entrepreneurs globally are planning to exit their businesses within the next five years, according to the HSBC Global Entrepreneurial Wealth report. Yet in Asia, a wealth plan is yet to be discussed among family members.

Hong Kong has the highest proportion of business owners considering an exit (45%), based on the report published on 6 December.

This compares to lower figures in mainland China (26%) and Singapore (22%). Notably, one fifth of entrepreneurs in India intend to sell their business within the next two years, compared to the global average of 11%.

Potential exits spell opportunities for wealth managers. About 33% of those looking to exit in the next 5 years are looking to start a relationship with a **private bank**, while another one-third are considering to expand their **private banking** relationship.

The top priority for business owners remains to be ensuring family wellbeing (53%), and taking legal advice (41%), when considering their next action after an exit.

The HSBC report surveyed 973 current and former high-net-worth entrepreneurs across nine markets, namely France, Hong Kong, India, mainland China, Singapore, Switzerland, UAE, UK and US.

Difficult conversations

Most Asian entrepreneurs prefer to transfer their business to the next generation, according to the HSBC study.

Yet, about 70% of those surveyed across Singapore, Hong Kong and mainland China have yet to speak to their families about their wealth succession plan. At least 6% never intend to do so, based on the study's findings.

Henry Lam, regional head of wealth planning and advisory for Asia Pacific at HSBC Global **Private Banking**, said while entrepreneurs are aware of the importance of wealth succession, many have yet to prepare their heirs.

'Deciding how to deploy family wealth or who will drive the family business in the future is a time that can lead to stress, high emotions and uncertainty,' said Lam.

Almost half of former entrepreneurs surveyed globally said they would have consulted their family more if given the chance to exit differently.

Currently, over 40% of entrepreneurs globally have a formal business and/or wealth succession plan in place. About 36% of respondents have a will in place, followed by a trust structure (34%) and a family governance structure (27%).

Deploying family wealth

Entrepreneurs globally want to preserve their wealth for the next generation, according to the report.

Apart from that, almost a third of business owners in India, Hong Kong and Singapore intend to invest in businesses - either their own or others.

There is also a strong desire to deploy family wealth purposely. Entrepreneurs in India (70%) and mainland China (58%) are particularly keen to use their wealth for philanthropic causes or sustainable/impact investing.

Lam noted that philanthropy can be a natural and effective way to involve the next generation in the family business and educate them on family values.

Lam told Citywire Asia in a separate interview that he has noted [a surge in interest from wealthy clients](#) on wealth planning services amid a greater push for family offices via initiatives in Hong Kong and Singapore.

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Business Times Breaking News

Bespoke and bilingual financial services help ease hotelier's move to Singapore

1,155 words

6 December 2023

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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OCBC's combination of banking, insurance and investment solutions, plus its regional presence in Asean and Greater China, caters to the diverse needs of foreign customers like her

WHEN hotelier Fiona Lu came to Singapore earlier this year to explore investment opportunities, one of the first things she needed was a local bank account. However, the native Mandarin speaker was initially concerned about the difficulties she might face due to the language barrier.

Her worries faded away quickly as the OCBC Digital app's bilingual interface allows a seamless switch from English to Mandarin.

"Being able to conduct my banking in Mandarin makes setting up my banking needs in Singapore so much easier, and the app is very easy to use," says the 31-year-old general manager of her family's luxury hotel in Ningbo, China.

While technology has clearly transformed banking in the digital age, what makes the 91-year-old bank stand out is the real-world human-to-human connections. A friend had recommended OCBC to Lu, citing the bank's long history of presence in the Chinese mainland market.

Lu still remembers vividly her first visit to OCBC Singapore's Chulia Street head office, where various artworks of Chinese painting and calligraphy are displayed, showing a deep appreciation of Chinese culture.

"Walking into the office for the first time, I immediately felt a sense of familiarity," she recalls.

Bespoke **wealth management**

At OCBC, premier foreign clients like Lu looking to move to Singapore for work or to invest in the region are supported by a dedicated relationship manager (RM) and a team of experts including an investment advisor, an FX specialist and an insurance specialist, to meet their individual needs. Besides the seamless digital banking experience, Lu is won over by the thoroughness and reliability of her RM Sam Meng.

"When discussing my **wealth management** needs, Sam didn't just push products. Instead, he took the time to understand my plans, both personal and corporate, as well as my short- and long-term arrangements, which made me feel at ease," she says.

Even though the OCBC Digital mobile banking app allows global citizens like Lu to perform daily transactions on-the-go and check her accounts and investments in real-time, her RM goes the extra mile by helping her to keep tabs on the dynamic changes in the financial world, no matter which part of the world she is in. Customers can perform banking services in both English and Mandarin via the OCBC Digital app. PHOTO: GETTY IMAGES

Meng himself relocated to Singapore a decade ago, which explains why he can understand and anticipate his clients' needs well. "Besides helping clients navigate financial complexities regionally, I build good relationships with them so they feel safe to share their thoughts and needs," he says.

Almost every week, Meng provides a value-added service of helping Lu keep track of market-moving events and monitoring the movements of pre-selected currency pairs so that Lu can lock in favourable FX rates.

Lu, who regularly shuttles between China, Singapore and Australia, uses an OCBC debit card that links to both a Singapore dollar account and a multi-currency account, enabling her to store and transact up to 10 major foreign currencies.

"I travel to many places and This saves me time and effort as I don't have to worry about carrying multiple cards or handling different currencies," she says.

Convenience under one bank

Whether it's expanding the family's hotel business or investing in property in Singapore, Lu appreciates OCBC's regional presence and holistic approach to supporting her multifaceted needs.

Be it personal, corporate or even **private banking**, which I'll be considering in the future, I like that all my needs can be served by OCBC under one group. Fiona Lu, 31, hotelier and OCBC customer

She says: "OCBC offers a lot of meta-services in the Asia-Pacific region, eliminating the need for me to split my needs across different banks. Be it personal, corporate or even **private banking** which I'll be considering in the future, I like that all my needs can be served by OCBC under one group."

Such synergy arises from OCBC's distinct competitive edge as the only local bank with an insurance arm, Great Eastern Holdings, and is bolstered by various **wealth management** subsidiaries such as **private banking** under Bank of Singapore, investment products under Lion Global Services and brokerage services under OCBC Securities.

As Meng puts it: "At OCBC, we view our clients' needs holistically, across all their life needs, and not just investments. This allows us to understand them better and deepen the client relationship."

"OCBC is expanding its presence in Asia-Pacific, which is similar to the vision I have for my company. Its regional presence also allows me to be conveniently served in the areas I need to be," Lu adds.

Beyond regular financial services, the bank also assists customers with their lifestyle needs. OCBC Premier Banking RM Janeane Ng shares that RMs may even go beyond the call of duty to support clients in unique ways. For instance, she once helped the son of a Japanese client secure a job in Singapore upon knowing that the young man was looking to relocate here.

Ng says: "It gives me great satisfaction when I'm able to connect with individuals and provide them with the right financial solutions. This builds trust among our clients, giving them peace of mind that their needs are well taken care of."

Having enjoyed the convenience of banking with OCBC, Lu says: "Since starting my journey with OCBC this year, I've referred their services to my best friend and will continue to refer them to others in my network."

Elevating the premier banking experience OCBC Premier Connect: Beyond customised **wealth management** solutions, the bank also provides prospective customers with help and information on healthcare, education and living in Singapore. Comprehensive **wealth management** offerings: Digital wealth solutions including FX, equities trading, gold and silver trading, unit trusts, blue-chip investments, insurance and robo-investments with 38 portfolio options are available on the OCBC Digital app. Live chat option: If clients have any pressing queries or banking needs, they can click the live chat button in the OCBC Digital app, which instantly links them up with the RM and a back-end team. Biannual investment seminars: These invite-only events for Premier and Premier Private Client customers focus on market outlooks on topics such as asset allocation and investment strategies. Exclusive networking events: Held at OCBC Premier Centres, these intimate networking and information sharing events offer insights into various lifestyle topics such as travel, legacy planning, property market outlook and loans.

Visit this website to find out how OCBC can help you achieve your **wealth management** aspirations in Singapore and the region.

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We've appointed Daniel Furer as Head of Discretionary Portfolio Management & Asset Allocation

Distributed by Contify.com

438 words

30 November 2023

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Standard Chartered has appointed Daniel Furer as Head of Discretionary Portfolio Management & Asset Allocation. Furer joins the Bank from Credit Suisse and will report to Steve Brice, Global Chief Investment Officer. In his new role, Furer will oversee the Bank's Chief Investment Office Fund and Flagship Portfolios business, as well as drive the adoption of portfolio strategies through frontline and client engagement. Furer's appointment is expected to strengthen Standard Chartered's position as Asia's trusted international **wealth manager**.

Key Highlights:

- * Steve Brice stated that Daniel Furer's experience and leadership will help strengthen Standard Chartered's position as Asia's trusted international **wealth manager**

- * Standard Chartered is a leading international banking group with a presence in 53 markets

- * Standard Chartered is listed on the London and Hong Kong Stock Exchanges

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Nov. 30 -- Standard Chartered issued the following news release:

Standard Chartered ("the Bank") has appointed Daniel Furer as Head of Discretionary Portfolio Management & Asset Allocation. He joins the Bank today and reports to Steve Brice, Global Chief Investment Officer.

In this new role, Daniel will oversee the Bank's Chief Investment Office Fund and Flagship Portfolios business, customised mandates and asset allocation solutions. He will also drive the adoption of portfolio strategies through frontline and client engagement. Daniel will be based in Singapore.

Daniel joins the Bank from Credit Suisse, where he held various roles within Asset Management and Investment Management from 2007. In his last position as Head of Investment Management Singapore and Business Development Asia, he successfully led the team in delivering discretionary asset management services to private banking and institutional clients in Asia.

Steve Brice said, "Daniel's wealth of experience and demonstrated leadership will help Standard Chartered strengthen its position as Asia's trusted international **wealth manager**. He will play a key role in enhancing our portfolio management strategies and deepen our capability in providing clients with wealth advice that matters."

Standard Chartered

We are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 53 of the world's most dynamic markets and serving clients in a further 64. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong Stock Exchanges.

For more stories and expert opinions please visit Insights at sc.com. Follow Standard Chartered on Twitter, LinkedIn, Instagram and Facebook.

Source: Standard Chartered

[Category: Banks, Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Financial/ Capital Market, Management Changes]

Exclusive: Julius Baer's Greater China deputy market group head exits

Priyanka Boghani

137 words

30 November 2023

Citywire Asia

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English

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Julius Baer's deputy market group head for Greater China has left the bank, Citywire Asia has learnt.

Ming was at the Swiss pure-play for more than two years.

Before this, he worked at UOB Asset Management as a North Asia market head for almost five years. He also previously spent more than a decade at Credit Suisse as a team leader for the Greater China market.

Julius Baer recently named [three](#) new Singapore-based market heads. Yee Kim Tan, Shui Wei Ho and Kunal Sumaya are all taking on expanded roles in a second round of changes, following a reshuffle announced last month upon the news Rahul Malhotra is becoming head of emerging markets.

A spokesperson from Julius Baer declined to comment.

Document CWIRAS0020231130ejbu00001

Search Summary

Text	
Date	04/08/2023 to 04/08/2026
Source	Group: All Pubs Excluding Wires
Factiva Expert Search	Wealth Management (English)
Author	All Authors
Company	DBS Group Holdings Limited Or United Overseas Bank Limited Or Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Limited Or HSBC Holdings PLC Or Standard Chartered PLC
Subject	All Subjects
Industry	All Industries
Region	Asia
Language	English
Results Found	666
Timestamp	4 August 2026 16:44